SATURDAY
October 10, 2026

CHENNAI
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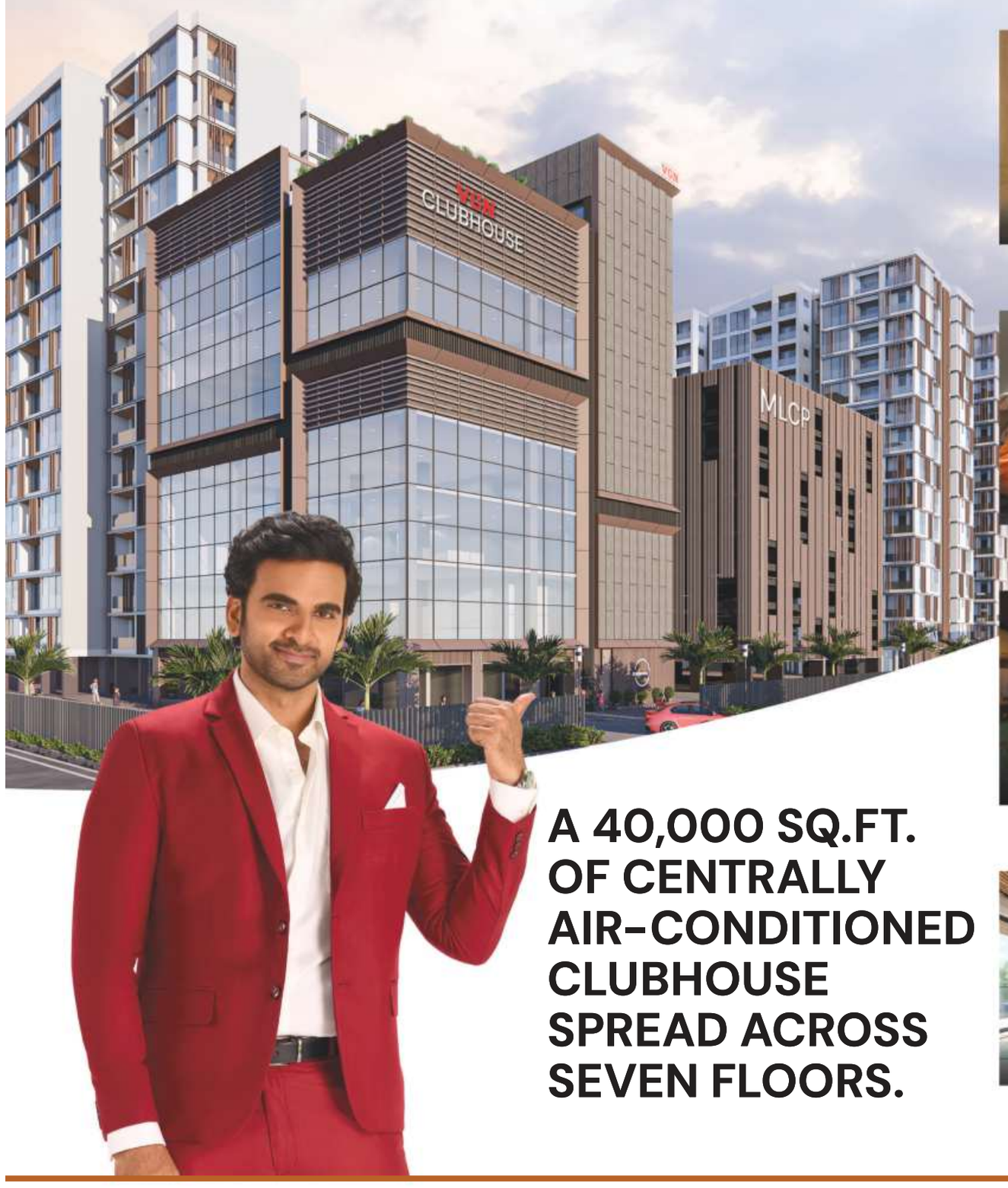


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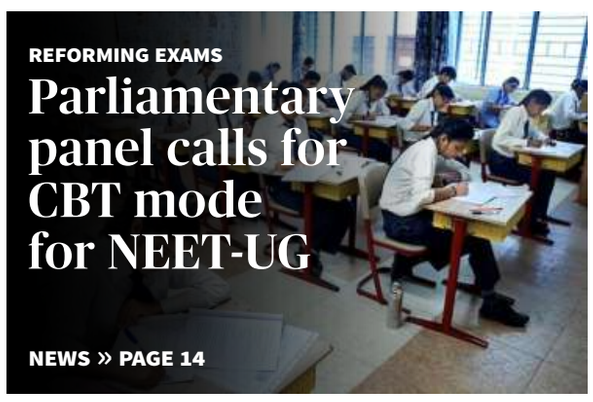
LEGAL CEILING

**SC rejects A.P. plea to restore 34% BC quota**

SOUTH » PAGE 8



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A FUTURE ON HOLD

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*MPSC aspirants seek accountability and fair recruitment*

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**Hope hits hundred as Windies level series**

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# Trains cut, Internet down: Delhi turns a fortress ahead of protest

Police deny permission for the CJP protest at Jantar Mantar; Home Ministry directs States, Union Territories to prevent protesters from entering capital; around 13,000 additional Central security personnel deployed amid heightened security

**Vijaita Singh**
NEW DELHI

The Delhi Police on Friday denied permission to the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) to hold its proposed protest at Jantar Mantar on Saturday, citing alleged violations of conditions agreed upon for an earlier demonstration, even as authorities rolled out an extensive security plan across the national capital.

Despite the denial of permission, the CJP released a poster that says "Final Call To Save Democracy", asking its supporters to reach Jantar Mantar at 10 a.m. on October 10 as they look to go ahead with the protest demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar and the rollback of the special intensive revision of electoral rolls.

Authorities have taken several measures ahead of the protest, including internet curbs in parts of Delhi, the shutting down of markets and Metro stations, and the cancelling of dozens of trains bound for the capital.

The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) directed all States and Union Territories (U.T.s) to coordinate with the Delhi Police and take preventive measures to stop the movement of protesters towards Delhi. In a communication sent to Chief Secretaries and Directors General of Police (DGP), Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan drew attention to the "grave law-and-order and public-order implications" arising from the proposed protest.

The letter noted that the Delhi Police had categorically rejected the CJP's request to hold the gathering. The communication further said the CJP and supporting organisations had a "documented history of non-compliance with lawful directions" during previous mobilisations, adding that earlier protests involving participants travelling from different States had resulted in significant disruption to public order and damage to public property, the letter, seen by *The Hindu*, said.

The letter cited intelligence inputs as indicating that the CJP and its supporters intended to defy statutory restrictions and attempt entry into Delhi from various States and U.T.s.

"To pre-empt any breach of public tranquility and to safeguard critical infrastructure," the Home Ministry directed States to "immediately operationalise preventive measures in coordination with the Delhi Police and within the framework of law".

The Ministry emphasised continuous, real-time intelligence-sharing among State intelligence agencies, transit authorities and the Delhi Police to ensure coordinated action. The Ministry called for the strict implementation of the directions to uphold the rule of law.

Around 6,000 additional security personnel – 40 companies of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) and 20 companies of Sashastra Seema Bal (SSB), the primary border-guarding forces along the border with China and Nepal, respectively – were deployed in Delhi for "law-and-order duty" on the instructions of the Union Home Ministry. This deployment is in addition to the 7,000 Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) personnel pulled from Chhattisgarh and West Bengal, as well as personnel of the Delhi Police.

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**Under wraps:** Glass panels at a Metro station are covered ahead of Saturday's Cockroach Janta Party protest near Jantar Mantar in New Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

## Repeal all State polls: INDIA bloc

**Sobhana K. Nair**
NEW DELHI

The INDIA bloc on Friday urged President Droupadi Murmu to "repeal" all Assembly elections held over the last two years, saying they have "incontrovertible proof" of "vote *chori*" (theft).

Before their meeting with the President, the Opposition leaders gathered at the central hall of Samvidhan Sadan, where, according to sources, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi claimed that the government is "rattled" and that if the Opposition continues its campaign, the government could fall without completing its full term.

FULL REPORT ON » PAGE 13

## Blanket transit ban in capital 'over-reaching', says top court

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday found the Delhi Police's move to shut down free movement to and within the national capital ahead of the protests on Saturday "over-reaching". The court told the Union government and the Delhi Police that a "distinction exists between total 'prohibition' and the 'regulation' of Metro and other train movements".

A three-judge Bench drew an assurance from Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta that he would "impress upon the authorities to reassess the travel prohibitions".

Choosing gentle persuasion over a legal showdown in the courtroom, the court pressed for the operation of Metro and other rail services in the national capital in a "suitable and regulated manner". "We clarify that although there shall be no outright prohibition on the movement of Metro trains, a prudent decision may be made to permit the operation of Metro trains and other rail services in a suitable and regulated manner. Such a decision should be widely publicised to prevent further inconvenience," the court directed in a four-page order.

The Bench, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, did not expand on what it exactly meant by a "suitable and regulated manner", but indicated the restrictions must be proportionate.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

## Ruling parties win big in T.N., Puducherry

**Celebration time:** TVK workers celebrate the lead established by party candidate Maragatham Kumaravel in the Madurantakam bypoll, the result of which was declared on Friday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

**T. Ramakrishnan**
CHENNAI

The ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), which came to power in Tamil Nadu exactly five months ago, passed its first electoral test in Tamil Nadu on Friday, bagging the Madurantakam and Dharapuram (Reserved) Assembly constituencies. In Puducherry, the ruling All India N.R. Congress (AINRC) retained Thattanchavady.

Both in Madurantakam and Dharapuram, TVK nominees Maragatham Kumaravel and P. Sathyabama were elected with comfortable margins of 20,040 votes and 9,471 votes respectively. They won from these constituencies in April-May 2026 as AIADMK candidates and then defected to the ruling party after resigning as MLAs.

**AIADMK placed third**

This time, they defeated the nearest rivals, I. Paranthamen and S. Suganya, of the DMK. S. Kanitha Sampath and K. Banumathi of the AIADMK finished third.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 6

## BJP wins bypolls in West Bengal, Assam

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The BJP won the byelections to two Assembly constituencies in West Bengal and the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat in Assam.

The ruling party won both Nandigram and Rejinagar Assembly seats in West Bengal by a huge margin.

In the Nagaon Lok Sabha seat, civil servant-turned-politician Devasish Sharma won by over 1.4 lakh votes. In Nandigram, BJP nominee Hasi Rani Rath won by a record margin of over 1.22 lakh votes. The margin of victory of BJP candidate Shankharavh Sarkar at Rejinagar in Murshidabad district was over 75,000 votes.

Welcoming the results, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said it showed yet again that the people have a deep-rooted connection with the BJP-NDA's good governance agenda.

The results also pointed towards the success of the BJP's efforts to reach out to minority voters, as about 70% of the electorate in Rejinagar and 27% of voters in Nandigram are Muslims. Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said the BJP received the support of 80% of Muslims in Nandigram and over 60% in Rejinagar.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 12

NEARBY

### Tamil Nadu Home Secretary transferred

CHENNAI
Tamil Nadu Home Secretary K. Manivasan has been transferred and posted as Commissioner of Land Administration in the rank of Additional Chief Secretary, while ADGP Prem Anand Sinha has been posted as Director of DVAC. » PAGE 7

### Two SC men fall at villagers' feet after burial row

ERODE
Allegations of caste discrimination have surfaced at Perumbali village in Erode district, after two members of a SC community reportedly fell at the feet of members of a Backward Caste community amid opposition to burial in a common cemetery. » PAGE 7

### Disqualification proceedings: SC backs Speaker

NEW DELHI
The Supreme Court on Friday declined to intervene in the Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker's decision to close disqualification proceedings against a group of AIADMK legislators who had supported the TVK government led by C. Joseph Vijay during a trust vote in May. » PAGE 7

### Ex-Minister seeks bail in lakebed excavation case

CHENNAI
Former Minister E.V. Velu of the DMK and his son E.V. Kumaran have filed anticipatory bail petitions before the Madras High Court in a lakebed excavation case. » PAGE 7

METROPLUS WEEKEND » 8 PAGES
PROPERTY PLUS » 16 PAGES

## Govt. is against monopolies: Minister on Musk's remarks

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Union Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia said on Friday that India "does not allow a monopoly in any sector", referring to SpaceX chief executive officer Elon Musk's allegations that "oligarchs" were blocking Starlink service's availability in India. Starlink is a satellite Internet service operated by SpaceX.

"For us in the Department of Telecommunications [DoT], we are technology agnostic," Mr. Scindia said. "Our job is to be able to provide the bouquet of services to every single customer. It is for the customer to choose, in a free market, which service he or she prefers."

Jyotiraditya Scindia

Mr. Scindia reiterated the DoT's statement asserting that all three satellite Internet licence applicants, Starlink, Jio and Bharti-backed OneWeb, were at the same stage. "Once the revenue charges system is finalised – once each one of these parties, party A, B and C, all three individually, based on their achievement of milestones with regard to security concerns and prerequisites, have fulfilled the requirements – then obviously they can start operations," he said.

On why the revenue charge system – the key step before Starlink can operate on top of the security clearance – was delayed, Mr. Scindia said, "You say something in a snap, and DoT quickly announces it, and then six months later we will be asked why we announced it in such a hurry."

RELATED REPORTS ON » PAGE 12

## International jurist Navi Pillay wins Nobel Peace Prize

**Associated Press**
OSLO

Navi Pillay, a South African-born jurist and former UN human rights chief, won the Nobel Peace Prize on Friday for her efforts to promote international law as it comes under attack.

Her win is sure to be seen as a high-profile rebuke to U.S. President Donald Trump and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, who have both rejected the findings of the UN commission she led on Gaza.

On the 125th anniversary of the prize's inception, the Norwegian Nobel Committee sought "to remind the world that the rule of law, national and international, underpins the system we have set up to ensure peace and resolve conflicts nonviolently. Peace requires justice," committee Chairman Jørgen Watne Frydnes said.

Judges "guard the thin red line between order and chaos," and the world needs jurists "of courage, vision and determination, qualities that Navi Pillay demonstrates in her work on the bench".

In places such as Israel and in apartheid-era South Africa, she and peers took on some of the world's most painful and sensitive legal issues and most vulnerable populations.

**A voice for human rights**

Born to parents of Tamil descent under apartheid in South Africa, Navi Pillay rose to become a prominent jurist and advocate of international law and human rights

- Challenged discrimination, **segregation**, and exclusion in apartheid-era South Africa
- Held **judicial posts** in South Africa's High Court, the Rwanda tribunal, and the International Criminal Court
- Led the UN's human rights office as **High Commissioner** and chaired its inquiry into the Occupied Palestinian Territory
- Currently serves as a judge at the **International Court of Justice** in the genocide case against Myanmar

Ms. Pillay, 85, received the news while attending a forum in Nuremberg, Germany, where the trials of Nazi war criminals helped lay the foundations of international law.

She said efforts to weaken international criminal justice "endanger the progress painstakingly made since Nuremberg, and they risk returning us to a world in which power, rather than law, determines whose suffering matters."

Ms. Pillay chaired the Commission of Inquiry on the Occupied Palestinian Territory and Israel, which was created by the UN-backed Human Rights Council. The commission a year ago concluded Israel was responsible for genocide in Gaza with a specific intent to destroy Palestinians in Gaza.

Gaza was among Ms. Pillay's first comments on Friday after hearing she had won. "What's happening there is genocide," she said.

The commission last year also found that the Israeli President, Prime Minister and former Defence Minister "have incited the commission of genocide." Israel has strenuously denied the accusations.

Ms. Pillay has repeatedly rebuffed critics who accused her of antisemitism or turning a blind eye to the Hamas attacks in Israel. Under her leadership, the commission also issued reports accusing Hamas of war crimes and violations of international humanitarian law during its October 7, 2023, attack.

## INBRIEF

### Lions Clubs International conducts service projects

Lions Clubs International District 3241F conducted various service projects, including medical camps, tree plantation, hunger relief, and aids distribution to underprivileged people at 15 places across the city, in view of World Service Day, on Thursday. A press release said Lions District governor Uma Anilkumar distributed spectacles to beneficiaries at the medical and eye screening camp held at K.K. Nagar Sivan Park. Udayakumar, club's district cabinet secretary, Sivakumar, cabinet treasurer, and Gopinath, district chairperson for the welfare of persons with disabilities participated.

### Metrowater to hold open house meetings today

Chennai Metrowater will hold open house meetings in all its area offices on Saturday between 10 a.m. and 1 p.m. to address consumers' grievances. A press release said such meetings were held every second Saturday of the month to redress complaints.

**Spotlight**
Read longform articles from our regional editions

- **Andhra Pradesh:** When childhood feels unsafe: POCSO cases in A.P.'s Rayalseema **newsth.live/unsafechildhood**
- **Delhi:** Tested by mud and water, in Bundelkhand **newsth.live/bundelkhand**
- **Karnataka:** Crawl, stop, repeat: The rough road to school in Bengaluru **newsth.live/roadtoschool**
- **Keralam:** Carers uncared for: Lack of regulations make home nurses vulnerable in Keralam **newsth.live/caregivers**
- **Telangana:** Untying the knot in Telangana, one childhood at a time **newsth.live/childmarriage**

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# Artisans begin restoration of Golu dolls for Navaratri

An artisan in Mylapore says that people come to his shop for restoring their Golu idols, as they hold a lot of sentiment. Another seller says it is challenging to make a profit from selling dolls

**Sahana Mira S**
CHENNAI

As much as buyers await the Navaratri season, artisans and vendors also spend the year waiting for their dolls to finally find a home. While many Golu enthusiasts are browsing new dolls from these vendors in Mylapore, some artisans are busy restoring the idols of deities even if they are decades old, in the bylanes of the neighbourhood.

S. Paramasivan, who runs Jayamaruthi Manual, has been restoring idols for the past 22 years. His paintbrush is dipped in deep red as he works on a tall idol, while his son-in-law Murugesan P. is busy restoring another doll beside him.

**Festival makeover:** S. Paramasivan has been restoring idols for the past 22 years at his shop in Mylapore. J. JOHAN SATHYADAS

"While people are flocking to buy new dolls, we have been seeing many come to us to restore their old ones, which hold so much sentiment to them. I still remember how a mother-daughter duo came crying to us with one of their broken dolls. It holds a special bond for people, which is why we are focused on restoration," says Mr. Paramasivan.

As the sun dips, the work gets busier for these restorers. Praveen Babu, an antique collector from Andhra Pradesh was getting his clay Andal idol, that was made about 40 years ago, restored. "I am not focused on buying the newer papier-mache dolls. Look at the detailing of the old dolls made in hand, it is absolutely stunning! You don't get the same detailing in the market now," he says.

On North mada street, Bhuvaneshwari G., is dealing with the Navaratri rush. Her cart is swamped with customers asking for specific idols of Hindu deities.

"We have been getting dolls from Kancheepuram, but even there, they have increased the price by 300 rupees for every doll. Then how will we make a profit from the sales," she says.

# MMA to hold students' convention

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The Madras Management Association, one of India's premier management associations, is organising the 25th MMA All India Management Students' Convention 2026 - Silver Jubilee Edition, on October 12 at the Valluvar Kottam Auditorium in the city. The theme of this year's convention is 'Future-Ready Leadership: Reinventing Management for a Changing World', with a focus on preparing management students and emerging professionals to navigate technological advancement, economic volatility, changing workforce expectations, sustainability priorities, and global uncertainty. The Hindu Group is the media partner for this event.

**'Highly relevant'**

Speaking about the convention, Vijay Kumar, convention chairman, executive director and group CFO, Sify Technologies Ltd, said, "It is a matter of great pride and honour for us to organise the Silver Jubilee, 25th edition of the MMA All India Management Students' Convention. The theme this year is highly relevant to young management students who will soon enter a business environment being reshaped by technology, AI, changing workforce expectations, and global uncertainty."

The chosen theme and the business sessions are designed to help students understand how leadership itself is being redefined. The Convention will feature the Grand Finale of 'Chanakya - The Mastermind', MMA's flagship competition to identify the Best Management Student of the Year 2026. Ten finalists will compete on stage following a rigorous selection process comprising an online quiz, presentation, telephonic interview, behavioural assessment, group discussion, communication, and critical-thinking rounds. The winner will receive a cash prize of ₹1,00,000.

### ISDR meet to explore trends in dental science

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The 36th annual international conference of the Indian Society for Dental Research (ISDR), focussing on translating scientific discoveries into improved patient care, began at Sree Balaji Dental College and Hospital, an institution of Bharath Institute of Higher Education and Research, in Chennai on Friday.

Inaugurating the conference, Tamil Nadu Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar called for making quality dental care accessible and affordable, particularly in rural areas, through outreach programmes and rural healthcare mechanisms.

The conference, themed- Translational Dental Research - Bridging Science and Care- will feature lectures, symposiums, paper presentations and awards.

Ritu Duggal, president, ISDR; J. Srinisha - chairperson, SBDCH and organising chairman of 36th ISDR Conference, S.M. Balaji, secretary, ISDR and director, Balaji Dental and Craniofacial Hospital, and Elamaran, managing director, SBDCH were among those present at the event.

## CINEMA ❖ ARTS ❖ EVENTS

### MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

**Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan,**
East Mada Street, Mylapore, Chennai-600 004
SOOPER PRESENT
"Multi-Lingual Theatre Festival" from October 5 to 10, 2026 daily at 6.30 P.M. Today: 10th Oct: English "Animal Farm" by Alchemy Bengaluru. High Tea at 6.00 pm. Tomorrow: "Navarathri Music Series" from 11th Oct to 20th Oct 2026. All are Welcome.
Powered by : Nalli

**Goethe-Institut/Max Mueller Bhavan Chennai**
Invites you to MULBERRY QUINTET | 16 OCTOBER 2026, 6:30 PM | GOETHE-INSTITUT CHENNAI, 4 Rutland Gate, 5th Street, Chennai. An Evening of Western Classical Music — featuring works by Bach, Mozart, Beethoven & Brahms, alongside Indian compositions.. All are welcome!

**Hamsadhwani 97909 09567**
TODAY 6.15 pm: Kalaigalil Ilaya Bharatham - Theme: Navarathri by SAKTHI MURALIDHARAN & DHANUSH ANANTHARAMAN- VOCAL with Haritha Narayanan, Suriya Nambisan, Sai Subramaniam at Youth Hostel, 2nd avenue, Indira Nagar, Adyar. All Are Welcome..

**Kartik Fine Arts 24997788 / 9840326022**
Today 6pm at Narada Gana Sabha Mini Hall Bharathanatyam by Vaishnavi (Disp. of R. Muralidharan & Chitra Muralidharan) 7.30pm Sahana Bharadwaj (Disp. of Jayanthi Subramaniam). All are welcome.

**Mahalakshmi Temple & Kalyanamandapam Association No. 11, Park View Street, R.A.puram, Chennai-600028. Ph: 9941130700**
Navaratri Special Program from 10.10.2026 to 19.10.2026 daily 5pm Onwards. Inauguration by K.V.S.Gopalakrishnan IPS (Retd). Today 5pm Special Upanyasam on "NAVARATRI NAYAGIGAL" by Master Rishi Student of Kalaimamani Smt Vishakha Hari & Sri U.Ve.Dushyanth Sridhar. All are Welcome.

**Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar. Ph: 24348964.**
Navarathri Music Concerts, Today 5 p.m Chenkottah Sri Giridharan - Vocal, Kedar Vignesh, Sriram Srinivasan, 6.30 p.m Maharajapuram S Ganesh Viswanathan Vocal, R. Rahul, B Ganapathy Ram, Tiruchy Sri S. Krishnaswamy. All Are Welcome.

**Mudhra Navarathri VAIBHAVAM**
9 days festival - Concerts based on Theme : DEVI
11th October to 19th October 2026
Daily @ PaalamTV & mudhrabhaskar YouTube Channel
Daily @6.00pm(IST)
Harikatha On Goddess Durga, Lakshmi & Saraswathi by Madurai Shri.T.N.Seshagopalan
Concerts daily @ 7.00 pm(IST)

| | |
|---|---|
| 11-10-2026 | Parur M.S.Anantha Shree |
| 12-10-2026 | Lavanya Vaidhyanathan |
| 13-10-2026 | Dr. Aalepey Lakshmi Vinayak |
| 14-10-2026 | Ramya Kiranmayi |
| 15-10-2026 | R.Ratipriya |
| 16-10-2026 | Anjana P.Rao |
| 17-10-2026 | Dharini Veeraraghavan |
| 18-10-2026 | Sarvepalli Sisters |
| 19-10-2026 | Mahathi Ambareeshan |

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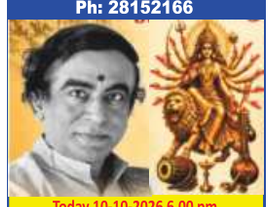
**Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam**
10.10.2026 – 7.00 pm- Nama Sangeerthanam by Sengottai Sri Harihara Bhagavathar & Group

**SRI THYAGA BRAHMA GANA SABHA (VANI MAHAL) Ph: 28152166**

Today 10-10-2026 6.00 pm
"JAYA JAYA DEVI"
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**Tom Mediaas/Bharat Kalachar**
TODAY - OCTOBER AALAPANAI 2026 @ YGP AUDITORIUM, T.NAGAR. 5:30 PM: M. Oviya, Guru: Dr. Himaja Athul Kumar (B/N). 6:30 PM: K. Roshika, Guru: Smt. Archana Mahesh - Sri Gyana Mudra (B/N). 7:30 PM: Students of Narthanam School of Performing Arts, Guru: Smt. Gayathri Kalyan (B/N). All are Welcome.

### MISCELLANEOUS

**Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar. Ph: 24348964.**
Navarathri Mahotsavam 2026 Commencing Today, 8.00 a.m Mahabhishekam for Moolavar Sri Saradamba,10.30 a.m Aradhanai of H.H.Jagadguru Sri Sri Candrashekara Bharati Mahaswamigal, PadukaPooja, 12 Noon Mahadeeparadhanai, Pushpanjali, Mahaprasadam, 5.00 p.m Jagatprasutika Alankaram, 8.30 p.m MahaDeeparadhanai, Ashtavadhana Seva. All Are Welcome.

**Sringeri Bharathi Vidyashram, T. Nagar. Ph: 24348964.**
Navarathri Mahotsavam 2026 Pooja Commencing Tomorrow Till 21.10.26, 5 a.m Ganapathi Homam, 7.30 a.m Daily Sevakartha Sankalpam, Vedaparayanam, Sapthasathiparayanam, Laksharchani.( Upto 19.10.26), 11.00 a.m Suvasini,Kanya Pooja, Mahadeeparadhanai, Mahaprasadam. Eve 5.00 p.m Special Alankaram for Goddess Sharadamba, 8.30 p.m Maha Deeparadhanai, Ashtavadhana Seva. All Are Welcome.

**Sri Sringeri Jagadguru Sankara Math (Branch), Krupasankari Street, West Mambalam**
10.10.2026 - 9.00 am Sri Ganapathy Homam, Moola Vigraha Abhishegam to Sri Ganapathy, Sri Sharadambal & Sri Navaneetha Krishnar; Sri Jagadguru Chandrasekara Bharathi Swamigal Aradhanai; Chandi Parayanam, Veda Parayanam, Sahasranama Archanai, Suvasini & Kanya Pooja; 12.30 p.m –Annadhanam; 6.30 pm - Jagatprasuthika Alankaram

**Tattvaloka Auditorium, 76 Eldams Road, Teynampet, Chennai 18. Tel: 24328125/ 265, Mobile: 9042765660**
Ancient Temples of Tamilnadu An illustrated lecture by Dr. Chithra Madhavan (Historian) Today 6:00 pm. All are welcome

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CORRIGENDUM TO TENDER NOTICE NO. 1 for Tender No.KOTA/SNT/SIG/2025/27/R1. Following tender, which was invited vide (NIT No. of Signalling Tenders KOTA/SNT/SIG/2025/27/R1 dated: 26.09.2026), due to administrative reason the opening date of these tenders are modified as per table given below. **Tender No.:** KOTA/SNT/SIG/2025/27/R1 **Name of work:** Kota Divn: Enhancing the system redundancy by provision of Digital Axle Counters in parallel with Track circuits at Stations yard on Main Line in Kota-Mathura Section. **Old Last Date & Time of submission and opening of tender:** 15:00 Hrs. on Date 01.02.2027 **Modified Last Date & Time of submission and opening of tender:** 11:00 Hrs. on Date 26.12.2026.
(SD.)
Sr. DSTE/Co., WCR, Kota Division
स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

**CORRIGENDUM NO. 01 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. CON/2026/SEP/04**
Corrigendum- 01 for **Tender No. CE-CON-ANJ-EPC-2026-02** has been published. For details please visit **www.ireps.gov.in**
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**CORRIGENDUM NO. 01 AGAINST TENDER NOTICE NO. S&T_CON_2026_01 DATED: 06-10-2026**
Corrigendum- 01 for **Tender No. DYCSTE_CON_SCL_2026_01_01** has been published. For details please visit **www.ireps.gov.in**
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**I, Muthu** kumaran, S/o: Kuppusamy, R/o: 199 8th street Ganesh Avenue, Shakthi Nagar, Porur, Chennai – 600116, have changed my name to Muthukumaran for all purposes
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## 'MSMEs are grappling with rising costs'

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

MSMEs play a critical role in employment generation, exports, and inclusive economic growth, and strengthening them is essential for achieving the vision of a $1.5 trillion Tamil Nadu economy, said S. Vasudevan, president of Tamil Nadu Small and Tiny Industries Association (Tanstia) in Chennai on Friday.

The Micro and Small Enterprises across the country are undergoing an extremely challenging phase as the continuous increase in production and operational costs, due to the war in West Asia, have placed tremendous pressure on the sector, he said at the Vettri Tamil Nadu MSME Summit 2026 organised by FICCI.

P.N. Vasudevan, Managing Director, Equitas Small Finance Bank, pointed out that small-scale trading units are not covered by government schemes.

# Visakhapatnam man arrested for cheating private school owner

Unidentified persons impersonated him on WhatsApp and made the school's accounts manager transfer ₹38 lakh from the owner's account

CRIME FILE

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The Cyber Crime Police arrested a man in Visakhapatnam for allegedly cheating the founder of a private school in George Town of ₹38 lakh through impersonation.

According to the police, unidentified persons used the school founder's photograph as their WhatsApp profile display picture and impersonated him. They sent a message to the school's accounts manager from a mobile number, posing as the founder, and instructed him to transfer ₹38 lakh to a bank account.

Pentha Gowri Shankar

Believing the message, the accounts manager transferred ₹38 lakh from the school founder's bank account to a bank account in Visakhapatnam.

After realising that he had been cheated, a complaint was lodged with the police. The investigation revealed the money was credited to a newly opened current account in Visakhapatnam in the name of Sri Sai Ganapathi Logistics, and was immediately transferred to other bank accounts.

The police identified the current account holder as Pentha Gowri Shankar, 45, of Madhurawada, Visakhapatnam.

Investigators found that he had allegedly maintained a fake 'mule' bank account and received money from fraud victims in return for a commission.

The police team camped in Visakhapatnam and arrested Gowri Shankar on October 2. Mobile phones, SIM cards, and a bank cheque book were seized from him.

## 3 arrested for work-from-home job fraud

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

The Anna Salai Police have arrested three men for allegedly cheating job seekers by offering work-from-home opportunities and collecting advance payments.

The police said a 26-year-old woman from Kolathur was allegedly cheated by a woman who promised her a work-from-home job. On May 20, 2026, the victim visited a commercial complex in Royapettah, where she came across the woman who introduced herself as an HR executive of a private company.

The latter subsequently contacted her over phone and offered her a job in the company. The victim was asked to pay ₹4,500 in advance to install a software in her laptop for working from home.

However, no further information about the job was provided after payment. Despite several attempts, she could not contact the company's owner Aaron. Later, she learnt that several others had allegedly been cheated in a similar manner.

Based on her complaint, the Crime Branch of Anna Salai police police arrested the prime accused, Aaron, 31, of Vilankadupakkam, on Tuesday. ₹2.49 lakh and a mobile phone was seized from him. The police also nabbed Gokulnath, 26, of Madhavaram, and Ajmal Basha, 32, of Kodungaiyur on October 7.

Preliminary investigations revealed that the gang maintained offices in different parts of Chennai. They contacted job seekers over phone, promised employment, and collected money as 'advance payments' and 'registration fees'. Further probe is under way.


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Venue : The Tamilnadu Dr. MGR Medical University Auditorium.
69, Anna Salai Guindy, Chennai-600032.
Date : 10th October 2026.
Time : 4.00 to 6.00pm.

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Dr. C.SABARIGIRINATHAN
PRINCIPAL
RAGAS DENTAL COLLEGE & HOSPITAL

# Five-tier security in place for PM's visit to Chennai

The arrangement includes 15,000 officers and personnel. City Police Commissioner A. Amalraj chairs review meeting. Corporation Commissioner inspects preparatory works across the city

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

In view of Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Chennai on Sunday, the Greater Chennai Police have put in place a five-tier security arrangement involving 15,000 officers and personnel.

A review meeting chaired by Greater Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj was held at the Police Commissioner's Office in Vepery on Friday to discuss the security arrangements.

Extensive security measures have been put in place at Chennai airport, Porur Bypass Metro station, IIT campus in Kotturpuram, Chennai Trade Centre in Nandambakkam, Lok Bhavan in Guindy, and their surrounding areas.

Security has also been strengthened along key routes the Prime Minister is scheduled to take, with intensive checks and surveillance under way.

**Taking stock:** Greater Chennai Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran reviewing the preparatory works at the IIT-Madras campus ahead of the Prime Minister's visit. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The police are conducting inspections at lodges, guest houses, star hotels and other accommodation facilities to identify suspicious individuals. Intensive vehicle checks are also being carried out on major roads in the city.

In addition, elaborate security arrangements have been made at railway stations, Metro Rail stations, and bus terminals across Chennai, with the police maintaining heightened surveillance.

The police have also declared areas around Meenambakkam, Guindy, Kotturpuram, Porur, and Nandambakkam, and the routes to be taken by the Prime Minister during his visit, as 'Red Zones', prohibiting the flying of drones and other unmanned aerial objects.

Greater Chennai Corporation Commissioner G.S. Sameeran inspected preparatory works at Mount Poonamallee High Road, the Porur Metro area, and the IIT-Madras campus on Friday.

# Governor stresses on efforts to take medical facilities to remotest villages

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

Governor of Tamil Nadu Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar on Friday said research should be directed and technology harnessed to take medical facilities to the people living in the remotest villages of the country

Taking part in the inauguration of "NAMSCON 2026", the 66th annual conference and convocation of the National Academy of Medical Sciences (India) hosted by SRM Medical College and Research Centre and SRM Institute of Science and Technology (SRMIST), Chennai, he elaborated on how medical facilities can be taken to the reach of needy people in villages and remote places and how dependency on medicines can be reduced.

Efforts such as work happening in laboratories and research should be directed towards them, he said. Noting that India is set to become a developed country by 2047, he told the medical professionals gathered at the conference that they have enough time to deliberate on how this can be done. Use all technology to take medical facilities to them, he added.

Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar being felicitated by T.R. Paarivendhar, founder-chancellor, SRM Institute of Science and Technology, at the 66th annual conference and convocation of the National Academy of Medical Sciences on Friday. V. UMESH KUMAR

Abhijat Sheth, chairman, National Medical Commission, said, "medicine, what we are practising today was not medicine of yesterday. Today, medicine has become more imaging and laboratory dependent, while yesterday it was purely bedside manners and tomorrow, medicine is going to be more precision-based and personalised." Everything will change in a few decades and everyone should keep themselves prepared for change, he added.

P. Sathyanarayanan, pro-chancellor (Academics), SRMIST, stressed the need to bring together hospitals, which face challenges, universities, which have solutions, and industries, which know how to take them to those who need them, ensuring last mile connectivity.

Digambar Behera, president, NAMS, noted that Continuing Medical Education (CME) is at the heart of what the academy does, and this year, it has supported 57 CME programmes across the country. Among the challenges being faced are antimicrobial resistance, which is threatening to undo decades of progress, air pollution, increase in lifestyle diseases and an ageing population. Artificial Intelligence and new technology is changing diagnosis, treating and learning of medical science, he said, adding that the academy has launched new courses including One Health and air pollution.

T.R. Paarivendhar, founder-chancellor, SRMIST, and Shekar C. Mande, president of INSA, spoke on the occasion.

R. Jayanthi, dean, SRM Medical College Hospital and Research Centre and organising chairperson, said the event was a comprehensive scientific programme on contemporary topics in medical education, practice and research.

The four-day event, which is centered on the theme "Synergy of Science and Technology in Healthcare for a Healthier Tomorrow", has over 1,000 participants, a press release said.

# 'Reel culture to blame for bike stunt incident involving youths'

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

'Reel culture' is becoming so popular among Gen Z that many are ready to risk their lives under the pretext of taking a video or a photograph, B. Shamoondeswari, Additional Commissioner of Police (Traffic), Greater Chennai Traffic Police said here on Friday.

While speaking at the 'Tamil Nadu Road Safety Conference 2026: From Mission to Action' organised by the Citizen consumer and civic Action Group (CAG) she highlighted a recent bike stunt incident in the city, in which many youths were involved. "We took action, secured a lot of people and seized several two-wheelers without number plates," she said.

"The 'reel culture' had led to last week's incident – the bike racing or bike stunts," she said. She added that technological advancements were in place to monitor traffic congestion in the city.

**Flagging a danger:** Dignitaries at the Tamil Nadu Road Safety Conference held in Chennai on Friday. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

K. Phanindra Reddy, retired IAS officer and chairperson of the Tamil Nadu Real Estate Regulatory Authority, said that nearly 35% of the accidents occured on the State Highways, and 30% on the National Highways.

"It is important for these agencies to ascertain the reasons for these accidents," he added.

Saroja S., executive director of CAG, said that the announcement of the Tamil Nadu Road Safety Mission by the State government recently signals the State's desire to prioritise road safety.

Venkatesh Balasubramanian, Professor, Department of Engineering Design, and Head - RBG Labs & Centre of Excellence for Road Safety, Indian Institute of Technology-Madras, also spoke.

**Timings**
**CHENNAI**

| | |
|---|---|
| **SATURDAY, OCT. 10** | |
| RISE 05:59 | SET 17:54 |
| RISE 05:28 | SET 17:34 |
| **SUNDAY, OCT. 11** | |
| RISE 05:59 | SET 17:53 |
| RISE 06:19 | SET 18:14 |
| **MONDAY, OCT. 12** | |
| RISE 05:59 | SET 17:52 |
| RISE 07:10 | SET 18:55 |

| Chennai Weather | max | min |
|---|---|---|
| Tiruvallur | 36 | 25 |
| Chennai Airport | 36 | 28 |
| Chennai City | 35 | 28 |

**Chennai Airport Today**
**35°C** The weather will be warm with an uneasy afternoon. The night will be uneasy. A spell of light to moderate rain and thundershowers to occur.

**Chennai Airport Tomorrow**
**36°C** The weather will be dry. The day will be very warm and uneasy. The night will be comfortable.

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THE HINDU
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# HC seeks govt. report on disciplinary action against erring officials

**The Hindu Bureau**
MADURAI

The Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court on Friday directed the State government to file a comprehensive report on the disciplinary proceedings initiated against erring government employees, the status of the proceedings, and the action taken.

A Division Bench of Justices P. Velmurugan and K.K. Ramakrishnan took a serious view of the delay in appointing an inquiry officer to conduct a departmental inquiry against erring government officials in a case pertaining to misappropriation of funds sanctioned for the welfare of Adi Dravidar Hostel students in Sivaganga district.

The court was hearing a public interest litigation petition filed by A. Sakthivel of Karaikudi with regard to a scam committed by government officials, involving more than ₹2.35 crore sanctioned for the welfare of Adi Dravidar Hostel students.

The sanctioned amount was for the essential requirements of the students such as hair oil, soap, and washing powder. From 2017 to 2023, the amount sanctioned by the government was swindled by the officials and the staff in charge, and no amount had been credited to the accounts of the students, he said.

Following a complaint lodged by Boominathan, an activist, the Sivaganga Town Police had registered a case, which was later transferred to the Sivaganga District Crime Branch. The investigation revealed that eight tahsildars were involved in the misappropriation of funds, he said.

**WESTERN RAILWAY**
**OUTSOURCING OF OPERATION, MAINTENANCE WORK**
Chief Engineer, Western Railway, Churchgate invites, **E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: W641-22-26-08, dt. 05.10.2026. Description Tender**: Outsourcing of Operation, Maintenance and other allied activity for track machines for a period of two years (24 months) in Western Railway. **Total Tender Value**: ₹ 27,97,74,504.88 (All incl.). **Bid Security Money**: ₹ 55,95,500/-. **Date of Closing of e-Tender**: 02.11.2026 at 11:00 Hrs. For further details please visit our website **www.ireps.gov.in** 0674
Like us on : facebook.com/WesternRly

Govt. of Bihar
**समाहरणालय, नवादा**
**(मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद विभाग)**
**अल्पकालीन आम नीलामी सूचना**

एतद् द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि नवादा जिलान्तर्गत विभिन्न थाना काण्डों/उत्पादवादों में राज्यसात किये गये निम्नलिखित वाहनों को बिहार मद्य निषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 के सुसंगत प्रावधानों के तहत् आम नीलामी (Public Auction) दिनांक **27.10.2026** को समाहरणालय, नवादा में 11:00 बजे पूर्वाहन से की जायेगी। नीलामी योग्य वाहनों की सूची निम्नवत है :–

| क्र. सं. | थाना का नाम | थाना काण्ड संख्या | वाहन का प्रकार | निबंधन संख्या | निबंधन का वर्ष | इंजन संख्या | चेचिस संख्या | मूल्यांकित राशि | अग्रधन की राशि | वाहन की अवस्थिति | वाहन मालिक का विवरणी |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | उत्पाद थाना, नवादा | 396/25 | PASSION PRO MOTORCYCLE | TN70B/1701 | 14-Jul-10 | HA10EDAGF44066 | MBLHA10AHAGF49732 | 9720.00 | 2500.00 | शराब डिपो | आरूल चार्ल्स, पिता–मुथप्पा, ग्राम–साल्यपुरम सरगापल्ली, थाना–काट्ई टी के कृष्ण नगर, (तमिलनाडु) |

विशेष जानकारी के लिए कार्यालय अधीक्षक मद्य निषेध, नवादा से सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है nawada.bih.nic.in पर देखा जा सकता है।

(कृते समाहर्त्ता, नवादा)
अधीक्षक मद्यनिषेध, नवादा

PR- 013385 (Excise) 2026-27
For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

**नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार**

## OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

### DEATH

MUKUND H.ADHIA
14th May 1932 – 08 October 2026

*Children*
*Sheela & Late Ketan Adhia*
*Ketki & Naresh Shah*
*Nandi & Ranvir Shah*

*Grandchildren*
*Kim & Kushal*
*Maniti*
*Kosha & Sohil*
*Rajul & Savya*
*Dixitha & Pratham*
*Rukmani & Prasan*
*Prakriti*

*Great-Grandchildren*
*Samyak, Vandit,*
*Svara, Sarvam & Svaraj*

### DEATH

With profound sadness, we announce the peaceful passing of our beloved
**Vasundhara Kannan (Amma)**
(April 7, 1949 – October 9, 2026)
at 6:05 PM in Chennai.
*She served Bank of Baroda with dedication from November 13, 1967, until her retirement on Dec. 31, 2001.*
**Survived by** her husband V. Kannan; children Gopikrishna, Murali Krishna & Gayathri and their spouses Subha, Sushmitha & Prakash.
Loving grandchildren: Jishnu, Dishita, Tejas, Hrishi, Pragya and Prayag.
Her love and memories will remain in our hearts forever
**Om Shanti**
**9940280418**

### DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

**FIRST YEAR ANNIVERSARY**

**Mrs. VASUKI DEVI C, M.A, B.ED**
**17.09.1968 - 10.10.2025**
**W/o. Mr. A.J. Thangadurai**
**D/o.Late Mr.& Mrs. Murasoli Chellam**
**Deeply Cherished, loved and missed by family & friends**
**Contact:91-9843282355**

### DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

**Fondly Remembered**

**P Nalini Haridasan**
**11th Anniversary**
**3/04/1948 - 6/10/2015**

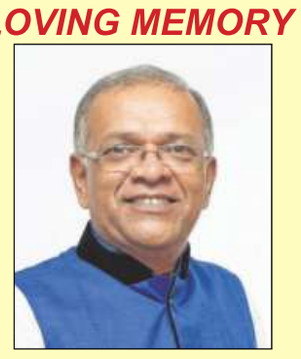
### IN LOVING MEMORY

**SMT. LATHA SUNDARA RAMAN**
*1954-2026*

Wife of Shri K. Sundararaman, Retd. AGM, State Bank of India, left for heavenly abode in Chennai on 9th October 2026. She leaves behind her loving husband, sons, daughters-in-law, granddaughters and a host of friends and relatives.

**FUNERAL RITES**
**Date: 11th October 2026**
**Time: 10:00 AM**
**Contact: 9789246039**
*– the bereaved family*

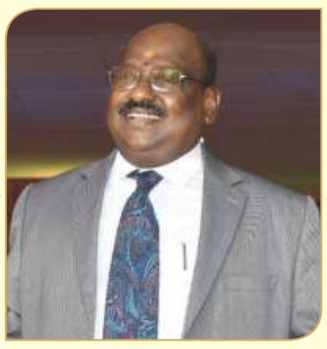
### IN LOVING MEMORY OF



**JITENDRA CHANDRAKANT SHAH**
**08.11.1959 - 08.10.2026**
WITH PROFOUND SORROW WE WISH TO INFORM THE PASSING OF JITU BHAI (NOVELTY).
A MAN FULL OF LOVE AND SERVICE.
HE WILL REMAIN FOREVER IN OUR HEARTS.
PRARTHANA
SATURDAY, 10.10.2026
8 P.M. – 9 P.M.
C U SHAH BHAVAN
RITHERDON ROAD, VEPERY, CHENNAI 600007
RUSHIT: 9884370475 : PANKTI: 9789932431
(NOVELTY TEA HOUSE FAMILY)

### DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

**In ever-loving memory of our Eternal and Beloved**



**Shri. K. Ravi Ramachandran I.R.S**
**Retd. Principal Commissioner, Income Tax Dept., Chennai.**
**05.07.1965 to 22.09.2025**
First year Varushabdhikam Ceremony in Rameshwaram on 10.10.2026
உறங்கு வதுபோலுஞ் சாக்காடு உறங்கி விழ்ப்பது போலும் பிறப்பு. (குறள்: 339)
*"Death is like a slumber deep*
*And Birth, like waking from that sleep."*
Thirukkural Verse 339

**IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES**
To dedicate a space in this section,
Please contact: **044-28576300** from 10.00 a.m. to 6.00 p.m.
**Toll Free: 1800 102 4161** from 10.00 a.m. to 10.00 p.m.
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**DONATE EYES - GIFT SIGHT**

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ISSN 0971 - 751X

## INTEGRAL COACH FACTORY, CHENNAI - 38

**TENDER Notice No. ICF/EL/Cons/2026-27 dt. 10.10.2026**

For and on behalf of The President of India, The Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/ Maintenance/Shell, Integral Coach Factory, invites E - Tender for the following works.

| Tender No. | Name of the Work | Approx. Value in Lakhs Rs. | EMD (Rupees) | Tender Closing Date and time |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| (1) | (2) | (3) | (4) | (5) |
| 2026245212360 | **EL-W-942** Provision of Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) for Power backup for Climatic Chamber | 873.20 | 17,46,400/- | 06.11.2026 at 15.30 hrs. |
| 2026245212361 | **EL-W-943** Electrification of construction of 2000 Sq.m shed with 15 meter clear height with 300 nos. pallets, in Furnishing Division. | 54.88 | 1,09,800/- | 04.11.2026 at 15.30 hrs. |
| 2026245212317R | **EL-AMC-2026-27-28** Annual Maintenance Contract of Heavy-Duty Roof Extractor Fan installed at shell, Furnishing & LHB division for a period of three years. | 64.07 | 1,28,200/- | 04.11.2026 at 15.30 hrs. |

**Website for submission of offer : www.ireps.gov.in**
Hindi version of the above tender notification is available in:
**www.icf.indianrailways.gov.in**

## GOVERNMENT OF INDIA MINISTRY OF RAILWAY RESEARCH DESIGNS AND STANDARDS ORGANISATION, MANAK NAGAR, LUCKNOW- 226011.

### EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

Ministry of Railways, Research Design and Standards Organization (RDSO), Lucknow, India is interested in developing specification for Rail cum Road operable Track Cleaning Vehicle for Indian Railways. Firms interested in developing and supply of said item are requested to see the details on RDSO website **rdso.indianrailways.gov.in** under 'EOI'.

## CSIR-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute

Nagpur- 440020, Maharashtra (http://www.neeri.res.in)

**Advertisement No: CSIR-NEERI/1/2026 (RECRUITMENT NOTICE)**
**Date of commencement of Online Applications:** 16/09/2026(10:00am)
**Last date for receipt of Online Applications:**15/10/2026(05:00pm)

CSIR-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI), Nagpur, a constituent laboratory of Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR), an autonomous body under the Ministry of S&T, Govt. of India, invites online applications from Indian Citizens for the following positions:

| Designation/ Post Code | No. of Posts and Reservation | Pay Matrix Level (as per 7th CPC) | Approx. Emoluments per month in Nagpur (as Per 7th CPC - Inclusive of Basic Pay, DA, HRA, TA, etc.) | Minimum age limit not below 18 years and Upper Age Limit as on Closing date of Online application |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Technical Assistant (TA-01) | No. of Posts:01 (EWS-01) | L-6 | Rs.69,480/- | 28 years |
| Technical Officer (TO-01 to TO-08) | No. of Posts:12 (UR - 06, EWS - 01 OBC (NCL) - 02 SC - 02, ST - 01) | L-7 | Rs.86,580 /- | 30 years |

**Note:** Out of 13 vacant posts, 01 post is reserved for PwBD - Category (a)
For detailed advertisement, Terms & Conditions and to apply ONLINE, please visit official CSIR-NEERI website https://neeri.res.in under HRD - Recruitment - Permanent Staff. All further announcement/details pertaining to this process/ updates /corrigendum/addendum etc. will be published/ provided only on CSIR-NEERI official website from time to time.

CBC 36213/11/0002/2627

**Controller of Administration**
**CSIR-NEERI, Nagpur**

THE HINDU
Air Surcharge as applicable:
New Delhi - Rs. 15/-;
Port Blair - Rs. 20/-

## KOLKATA MUNICIPAL CORPORATION e-TENDER

**ABRIDGED NIT**

**The Director General (Planning and Development Department), KMC** invites e-tender online expression of interest of lower bidder for following work:

**NIT No. : KMC/D.G.(P_D)/C/02/2026-2027**

Name of the work: **Balance work of Construction of Storm Water Pumping Station at Northern Park including its Network.** Estimated Value: **Total value of work - ₹ 30,04,10,887.00, Civil work - ₹ 21,05,09,025.00, Electro-Mechanical work including Operation of Pumping Station for 1 year - ₹ 8,99,01,862.00.** Earnest Money: **₹ 10,00,000.00.** Period of Completion: **9 months.** Date & Time of Pre-bid meeting: **28.10.2026 - 3.30 P.M. (Place of meeting: Office of the Director General (P&D), KMC, 19, Nellie Sengupta Sarani, Kolkata-700087).** Bid submission start date (online) on: **02.11.2026 at 3.30 P.M.** Last Date and Time of submission of Bid: **27.11.2026 at 3.30 P.M.** The bid forms and other details are available on and from **13.10.2026 (3.30 P.M.)** from the website: **https://etender.wb.nic.in** (610/26-27)

## KARNATAKA INDUSTRIAL AREAS DEVELOPMENT BOARD

(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
No.2, 2/1 and 2/3, Kalidasa Marg, 1st Main Road, Gandhinagar, Bengaluru-560009. Phone No. 080-22265383, Website: www.kiadb.in

**No. IADB/ENGG/ETND-EP-39/1726/2026-27** **Date: 08.10.2026**

### SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

**(Through GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Only)**

Item Rate Tenders under two cover bid system are invited as per the Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and Rules 2000 through electronic procurement from eligible Contractors who have got adequate financial resources, state of the art technology, suitable construction equipments, technical man power & sufficient past experience for the work of :

**Name of the Work:** Formation of Asphalt Roads including Construction of RCC side drain and water supply pipeline from Rane Madras Road to Plot No. 267-H-P-7 in Hebbal Industrial Area, Mysuru Taluk & District.

The last date and time of receipt of tender is : **27.10.2026** upto **4.00 pm.**

Applicants May Download Bidding Documents from the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.**

DIPR/CP/3161/SMCL/2026-27

**Sd/-**
**Engineer in Chief, KIADB, Bengaluru**

GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
## MINISTRY OF ROAD TRANSPORT AND HIGHWAYS
National Highways Act 1956 (48/1956) Section 3E(1)

### PUBLIC NOTICE

Announcement of Award for acquisition of land for construction of National Highways for Land Owners/ Persons Interested therein Kind attention of all land owners/ interested persons is invited to the Notification issued under Section 3A of the NH Act, 1956 for acquisition of land and building for formation of National Highways and the Notification issued under Section 3D of the NH Act, 1956 as noted below:

Above Notifications are published in the following newspapers: 3A(1) (Fourth Additional) Notification, 1.The Hindu (English / Dated.03.01.2026), 2. Dinamalar (Tamil / Dated.03.01.2026) & 3D (1) (Fourth Additional) Notification, 1.The Hindu (English / Dated 03.03.2026), 2. Dinamalar (Tamil / Dated 03.03.2026).

**Chengalpattu District**

| Sl. No. | Name of village | 3A(1) Gazette Date | 3A(3) News Paper Date | 3D(1) Gazette Date | 3D(3) News Paper Date | Award No. | Award Date |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Thirukalukundram Taluk** | | | | | | | |
| 1 | Pudupattinam (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 71/2026 | 09.06.2026 |
| 2 | Vittilapuram (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 74/2026 | 19.05.2026 |
| **Cheyyur Taluk** | | | | | | | |
| 3 | Kottaikadu (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 94/2026 | 22.05.2026 |
| 4 | Vembanur (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 93/2026 | 15.05.2026 |
| 5 | Panaiyur (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 99/2026 | 01.06.2026 |
| 6 | Mudaliarkuppam (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 92/2026 | 08.05.2026 |
| 7 | Paramenkeni (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 90/2026 | 06.05.2026 |
| 8 | Kadalur (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 65/2026 | 13.05.2026 |
| 9 | Mugaiyur (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 61/2026 62/2026 | 28.04.2026 07.05.2026 |
| 10 | Gangadevankuppam (4th Additional) | 29.12.2025 | 03.01.2026 | 24.02.2026 | 03.03.2026 | 91/2026 | 06.05.2026 |

It is informed that the undersigned authority has announced the Award in respect of the said land under Section 3G of the NH Act, 1956 vide order dates as mentioned above. The Land Acquiring agency (MoRTH/ NHAI/NHIDCL) has placed the requisite amount of compensation at the disposal of the undersigned. Notices have also been issued to the concerned landowners/interested persons as required under Section 3E of the NH Act, 1956.

Accordingly as per provisions of the section 3E(1) of the National Highways Act, 1956, all the concerned land owners / interested persons are hereby informed/notified through this additional Public Notice that the claimants entitled to receive the Compensation Amount may collect their amount of compensation from the office of the undersigned on any working day between 10.00 AM to 05.45 PM within a period of 60 days on surrender or deliver the possession of the subject land to the undersigned, failing which the possession of subject land will be taken with police assistance on expiry of the period of 60 days. If not action will be taken as per section 3E(2) (a) (b) of National Highways Act 1956.

R.C.35/2025/NH/CALA

**Sd/- M. Gunasekar**
**Special District Revenue Officer (LA)**
**National Highways,**
**Chengalpattu.**

## INDICATIVE NOTICE

**For recruitment against Cultural Quota for the year 2026-27 (Open Advertisement)**

**Employment Notice No. RRC/SER/Cultural Quota/2026-27 dated: 10.10.2026**

South Eastern Railway invites online applications from the eligible candidates for recruitment against Cultural Quota for the year 2026-27. The last date for submission of Application(s) is **16.11.2026.** Application must be submitted **through online mode only.**

**IMPORTANT DATES**

**● Opening date of Application: 17.10.2026 ● Closing date of submission of Application: 16.11.2026 at 23.59 Hrs.**

| Pay Band | Pay Level as per 7th CPC | Grade Pay | Discipline | Vacancies |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5200-20500 | Level-2 | ₹ 1900 | 1. Classical Dance – Bharatanatyam, Kathakali, Kathak, Manipuri, Odissi and Kuchipudi | 01 |
| | | | 2. Instrumental Music – Flute, Violin, Veena, Sitar and Sarod. | 01 |

Detailed Notification has been published on Railway Recruitment Cell/South Eastern Railway website **(www.rrcser.co.in)** and will be published in the Employment News on 17/10/2026. Desirous and the eligible applicants are advised to go through the detailed Employment Notice No. RRC/SER/Cultural Quota/2026-27 dated 10/10/2026 thoroughly before filling up the ONLINE application. Candidates should visit Railway Recruitment Cell/South Eastern Railway's website for accessing the link for submitting online applications.

Corrigendum/addendum if any and Important notices related to the aforesaid recruitment shall be issued time to time on the websites of Railway Recruitment Cell/South Eastern Railway.

*"BEWARE OF TOUTS, BROKERS AND JOB RACKETEERS"*

(PR-814) **Chairman, Railway Recruitment Cell**

**South Eastern Railway**
We serve with a smile

## JHARKHAND INSTITUTE OF CRAFT & DESIGN (JICD), Ranchi

(A Govt. of Jharkhand undertaking)
Udyog Bhawan, Ratu Road, Ranchi-834001

Advertisement No. …… Dated ……

### RECRUITMENT NOTICE

Jharkhand Institute of Craft & Design (JICD) invites applications for selection on contractual basis for the following posts for running four years degree courses in 04 various courses in craft design and design entrepreneurship education, research and development-

| Sl.No. | Name of Post | No. of post |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | Director | 01 |
| 2. | Associate Senior Faculty ( Textile & Apparel faculty) | 01 |
| 3. | Faculty ( Textile & Apparel faculty) | 01 |
| 4. | Associate Senior Faculty (Craft & Culture faculty) | 01 |
| 5. | Faculty (Craft & Culture faculty) | 01 |
| 6. | Associate Senior Faculty (Craft Management & Entrepreneurship faculty) | 01 |
| 7. | Faculty (Craft Management & Entrepreneurship faculty) | 01 |
| 8. | Associate Senior Faculty (Communication and performing art) | 01 |
| 9. | Faculty (Communication and performing art) | 01 |
| 10. | Senior Technical Staff( for Textile workshop) | 01 |
| 11. | Senior Technical Staff( for IT) | 01 |
| 12. | Senior Technical Staff( for Industrial Design workshop) | 01 |
| 13. | Senior Technical Staff( for Communication Design workshop) | 01 |
| 14. | Head Admin | 01 |
| 15. | Head Accounts | 01 |
| 16 | Head Academics | 01 |
| 17. | Account staffs | 01 |
| 18. | Centre Assistant (for resource centre library) | 01 |

The requisite qualification and experience along with application format are available on the **Website:http://jharsericulture.jharkhand.gov.in**
**Last date for submit the application form is 12.11.2026**
**How to apply**: Applicant need to fill the prescribed application form online and upload self attested copies of proof of age, qualification, experiences and other required doucments.
**E- mail:jicd.ranchi@gmail.com.**

PR 391440 (Directorate of Handloom Sericulture and Handicraft) 26-27 (D)

**Sd/-**
**Director**

## WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY

**E-TENDER NOTICE**
**OPEN TENDER NOTICE NO. WCR-CRWS-TOILETUP-25-32R1**

E-tenders are invited from experienced contractors on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work- **Name of work:** Up-gradation of Toilets of LHB NON-AC Coaches at CRWS, Bhopal. **Cost of work:** ₹ 27,53,59,032.00 **Cost of tender form:** ₹ 0.00 **Earnest money:** ₹55,07,200.00 **Time of completion:** 24 Months. **Online Bidding Start Date/Online tender closing Date and time:** 15.10.2026/ 29.10.2026 Upto 16.00 hrs. **Date and time of opening of Tender:** 29.10.2026 Upto 16.30 hrs. Detailed information about tender and tender format is available at website **www.ireps.gov.in** and tender notice at notice board of CWM, CRWS, Bhopal's office.

**(SD.)**
**Chief Workshop Manager**
**CRWS, Nishatpura, Bhopal**

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान
एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

## S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER

DRM/ENGG/CKP acting for & on behalf of The President of India invites E-Tenders against Open Tender. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. **Sl.No.** 1, **Tender Notice No. CKP-WEST-26-27-29, Name of Work:** Creation of Store Steel Yard (Phase-II) at ROHS/BNDM under CKP Division. **Tender Value (In ₹):** 13280231.21; **EMD (In ₹):** 265600.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 28.10.26; **Sl.No.** 2, **Tender Notice No. CKP-WEST-26-27-30, Name of Work:** Construction of 18 units type II quarters in replacement of condemned quarters (Rajgangpur (GP) - 6 units & Bondamunda (BNDM) - 12 units). **Tender value (In ₹):** 44133148.12; **EMD (In ₹):** 882700.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 28.10.26; **Sl.No.** 3, **Tender Notice No. CKP-WEST-26-27-31, Name of Work:** Construction of 4 units type II quarters at Bamra (BMB). **Tender value (In ₹):** 9981072.11; **EMD (In ₹):** 199600.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 28.10.26; **Sl.No.** 4, **Tender Notice No. CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-46, Name of Work:** Provision of Height Gauge and Provision of rubberized surface under the jurisdiction of DEN Central CKP. **Tender Value (In ₹):** 8878135.25; **EMD (In ₹):** 177600.00; **Cost of Tender form (In ₹):** 0.00; **Date of Opening:** 30.10.26. The tender can be viewed at Website **http://www.ireps.gov.in**. The tenderer/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering.

(PR-880)

## OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, NATIONAL HIGHWAY CIRCLE, KEONJHAR

Email :- senhkeonjhar@gmail.com
Letter No.1707, dt.05.10.2026

**1st Corrigendum Notice to NIT**
**Bid Identification No. CCE NHC KJR-04/2026-27/1641 dt.30.09.2026**

**Name of the Work :-** Construction of Twin E-Type (G+1) Quarter at Baripada under NH Division, Baripada for 2026-27.
Bid Identification No.CCE NHC KJR -04/2026-27/Letter no.1641

**Description of Corrigendum**

1. The bidding amount for the total Cost shall be considered as Rs.153.57 Lakhs (excluding GST), instead of Rs.183.94 Lakhs as indicated in the NIT. The BOQ to be uploaded in the e-procurement portal has been prepared excluding GST.
2. The Bid documents will be available in the website **www.tendersodisha.gov.in** from **11:00 Hours of 12.10.2026 to 16:00 Hours of 28.10.2026** for online bidding.
3. Bids shall be received only **"On-line"** on or before **16:00 Hours of 28.10.2026.**
4. Bids received "On-line" shall be opened at **11:30 Hours on 29.10.2026.**

The authority reserves the right to cancel any bid without assigning any reason.
All other terms and conditions contained in the NIT and Bidding Document remain unchanged.

**Chief Construction Engineer, N.H.Circle, Keonjhar.**

34001/974/2627 OIPR-34001/34048/1/26-27/0002

Website:ouat.ac.in; Email-registrar@ouat.ac.in; registrarouat@gmail.com
Ph.: 0674-2397818/919, Fax-0674-2397424

2026

ଓଡ଼ିଶା କୃଷି ଓ ବୈଷୟିକ ବିଶ୍ୱବିଦ୍ୟାଳୟ,ଭୁବନେଶ୍ୱର,ଓଡ଼ିଶା
**ODISHA UNIVERSITY OF AGRICULTURE & TECHNOLOGY**
**Bhubaneswar - 751003, Odisha**

No.E-II-II-07/2013/Part/ 16218 / UAT Dt. 09th October, 2026

**INDICATIVE ADVERTISEMENT**

In revision to the advertisement No.6092/UAT, dated 18.04.2023, applications are invited from the eligible candidates for recruitment to the following vacant posts on contractual basis in different Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVKs) under OUAT.

**A. Farm Manager –08 nos**
**B. Programme Assistant- 12 nos**
**C. Stenographer- 05 nos**

The detailed advertisement with information sheet containing number of vacancies, reservation of posts in different category, prescribed application form, application fee & mode of payment, qualification experience, scale of pay, age, selection procedure and other required conditions in respect of the vacancies as well as general information and instructions to the candidate can be downloaded from University website: **www.ouat.ac.in**

**Last date of receipt of application: 12.11.2026 up to 5.00 P.M.**

**BY ORDER OF THE VICE-CHANCELLOR**
**REGISTRAR**

1001/175/2627 OIPR-1001/1533/1/26-27/0026

## Bhubaneswar Development Authority

**Bhubaneshwar Development Authority**
**Akash Shova Building, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar, Odisha - 751001. Ph.:+91-0674-2392801**

**INVITATION FOR BIDS**

**Bid Identification No.830/EE-II/BDA/2026-27** **Date: 07.10.2026**

Executive Engineer, Division-II, BDA on behalf of the Secretary, Bhubaneswar Development Authority, Bhubaneswar invites following item rate bids on QCBS method in double cover system in **ONLINE MODE** from eligible bidders as mentioned below:

| Sr. | Particulars | Details |
|---|---|---|
| 1. | Name of Work | Selection of an Event Management and Placemaking Agency for Conceptualization, Design and Execution of Integrated City Activations for 19th Urban Mobility India Conference and Expo 2026, Bhubaneswar |
| 2. | Cost of Bid Documents | INR 10,000.00 + 18% GST = INR 11,800.00 (Online Mode) |
| 3. | Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) | INR 2,00,000.00 (Online Mode) |
| 4. | Availability of Tender | From 07.10.2026 to 05.00 PM of 13.10.2026 |
| 5. | Last date and time of submission of Tender | 05.00 PM of 13.10.2026 |
| 6. | Date and time of opening of Tender | 06.00 PM of 13.10.2026 |
| 7 | Place of opening of Tender | O/o - Executive Engineer, Division-II, BDA, Bhubaneswar. |

Further details can be seen from the website: **https://tendersodisha.gov.in.** Any addendum / Corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

**Executive Engineer, Division-II, BDA, Bhubaneswar.**

13001/2127/2627 OIPR-13001/13033/1/26-27/0155

## DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION

**Viniyamak Bhawan, C-Block, Shivalik, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi - 110 017**
**Telephone No:. 41080416, 41080417**

### RECRUITMENT NOTICE

DELHI ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION (DERC) invites applications from eligible candidates for filling up the following vacant positions on Deputation or Contract basis, as indicated against each post:

| S. No. | Name of the Post | No. of Posts | Pay Level (7th CPC) | Pay Scale | Mode of Appointment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Advisor (Finance)** | 1 | Level-13 | ₹ 1,23,100-2,15,900 | Contract |
| 2 | **Junior Law Officer** | 2 | Level-8 | ₹ 47600-151100 | Contract |
| 3 | **Private Secretary** | 1 | Level-8 | ₹ 47600-151100 | Deputation/ Contract |
| 4 | **Personal Assistant** | 4 | Level-7 | ₹ 44900-142400 | Deputation/ Contract |
| 5 | **Steno-cum-Computer Operator** | 4 | Level-7 | ₹ 44900-142400 | Deputation/ Contract |
| 6 | **Clerk-cum-Computer Operator** | 3 | Level-4 | ₹ 25500-81100 | Deputation/ Contract |
| 7 | **Lower Division Clerk** | 1 | Level-2 | ₹ 19900-63200 | Deputation/ Contract |

For further details, such as eligibility, qualifications, experience and other terms & conditions of appointment including compensation, facilities etc. please refer to DERC website link: https://www.derc.gov.in/regulations/management-and-development-human-resources regulations and for submitting the application https://www.derc.gov.in/app/home/openings

**The last date for submission of application is 10.11.2026**

**(Prashasti De)**
**Dy. Director (Pers.)**

**DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0246/26-27** **Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission**

From Page One

## Ruling parties win big in T.N., Puducherry

The candidates put up by the CPI and the CPI (Marxist) in Dharapuram and Madurantakam, as part of the Left bloc, fared miserably; so did the nominees of the Naam Tamilar Katchi (NTK). All the four contestants forfeited their deposits. The NTK, which came fourth in both constituencies, secured 2.92% and 1.46% of the votes polled, while the CPI got about 0.6% in Dharapuram and the CPI(M) 1.07% in Madurantakam.

With the victory in the two constituencies, the TVK's strength in the Assembly rose to 108, excluding the Speaker. Five seats are still vacant.

The State is known for favouring the party in power in byelections. However, the Madurantakam and Dharapuram byelections, held in five months of the TVK capturing power, were watched closely. Leaders of the three major contenders were deeply involved in the campaign.

TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay campaigned two days each in the two constituencies, as it was done by AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami. As for the principal Opposition DMK, its leader M.K.Stalin, former Deputy Chief Minister Udhayanidhi Stalin, and Thoothukudi MP Kanimozhi Rajathi Karunanidhi canvassed votes for the party nominees. Amma Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam (AMMK) founder T.T.V. Dhinakaran and Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam (DMDK) general secretary Premallatha Vijayakant campaigned for the nominees of the AIADMK and the DMK respectively.

While the TVK saw the byelections as a chance for popular endorsement of its rule, the DMK accused the ruling party of being immature in the manner in which it had been conducting the administration and the AIADMK, alluding to its former members fielded by the ruling party, called upon the electors to reject the "traitors".

In Thattanchavady, the AINRC's Ashok Anand outsmarted his immediate challenger, E. Vinayagam of the Congress, by 8,482 votes, almost double the margin recorded by Chief Minister and AINRC founder N. Rangasamy in the April Assembly election. As the Chief Minister was also elected from Mangalam and chose to retain it, the vacancy arose in Thattanchavady. This time, Mr. Anand netted 13,358 votes and Mr. Vinayagam polled 4,876 votes.

The AINRC is being supported by the BJP and the AIADMK, whereas the Congress is being backed by the TVK. Tamil Nadu Minister for Public Works Adhav Arjuna spoke at an indoor meeting there. The DMK, the CPI, the NTK, and six other contestants forfeited their deposits.

# AIADMK likely to face another crisis after decline in vote share

Following its setback in the bypoll, detractors may raise questions about EPS' leadership around the time of the party's Foundation Day on Oct. 17

**T. Ramakrishnan**
CHENNAI

Edappadi K. Palaniswami

With yet another electoral setback in the byelections to Madurantakam and Dharapuram Reserved Assembly constituencies, the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK) is lurching towards another challenging phase, perhaps the worst in its 54-year history.

Possibly, around the AIADMK's Foundation Day (October 17), critics, within and outside, of the party's general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami will launch another salvo against him. They will point out how the organisation, once a dominant force in State politics, is getting weaker day by day. For quite sometime, the talk has been doing rounds in political circles that the AIADMK's general council, when it is expected to be convened in a few months, will witness a major showdown between supporters of Mr. Palaniswami and his detractors.

On the face of it, the AIADMK's performance was not that bad, as the party had secured close to one-fourth of votes polled – say, around 25% – in the two constituencies. In Madurantakam, the Dravidian major was handicapped by the neutral stand of the Pattali Makkal Katchi (PMK), which was its ally in the Assembly polls five months ago. As a result, it did not get the advantage that it would have secured otherwise. This could be seen from the fact that during the 2024 Lok Sabha polls, when the AIADMK's position was as good as what it is now, the party's vote share was 37% whereas it has gone down to 25.61% this time.

When the party retained the seat in the April-May election, its score was 32.58%, which was lower than what the party had secured in 2024, in spite of the alliance with the PMK. However, the presence of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) in the scene early this year changed the contours of the electoral battle, making it a fierce triangular contest.

In Dharapuram, the erosion of the AIADMK's vote share was quite noticeable, as it fell from 32.37% in 2024 and 40% in 2026 (April-May) to about 25% now. The party had won the seat seven times. The TVK, which had a vote share of about 29% five months ago, seems to have grown at the cost of the AIADMK, as the ruling party has got close to 37%.

Former Minister "Pollachi" V. Jayaraman, who worked for the party in the constituency, says the results have shown that the people have not yet come out of "the web of illusion" of the ruling TVK. He expects them to realise the reality sooner rather than later and hopes that under such circumstances, his party will bounce back.

Asked whether the ruling TVK will intensify its efforts to woo the cadre of the AIADMK, the party's deputy general secretary M. Anandan says there is no need for his party to do so.

Asked about the impact of the dissidents' non-cooperation on the results of the byelections, Mr. Jayaraman says: "One thing is certain: I am like many others who will follow the path being shown by Mr. Palaniswami." At the same time, there is a view that the rebels' camp have no leader who can match Mr. Palaniswami. Needless to say, the coming weeks are going to witness several events for the AIADMK.

# DMK retains much of its vote bank, reinforces position as the principal rival of TVK

**B. Kolappan**
CHENNAI

The outcome of the byelection to the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Reserved Assembly constituencies has reinforced the DMK's position as the principal alternative to the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK).

M.K. Stalin

The DMK's second-place finish in both constituencies suggests it has retained much of its vote base. This is significant given that the party contested without most of its erstwhile allies, suggesting that an united alliance could improve its electoral prospects. The Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam (DMDK), which joined the DMK-led alliance ahead of the Assembly election in June, was an exception.

In Dharapuram, the DMK's vote count fell to 57,370 from 64,373 in the Assembly election but one needs to account for the declined voter turnout in the constituency as well compared to April 2026. Besides, the decline could be attributed to the absence of its former allies, including the Congress, the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK), the Communist parties, and the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML).

However, the TVK failed to match the vote count secured by the AIADMK in the general election, despite the defection of the former AIADMK legislator and the shift of the DMK's erstwhile allies to the ruling party. P. Sathyabama, who won the seat as an AIADMK candidate in the Assembly election, securing 81,100 votes. Contesting on the TVK ticket in the byelection, she polled 66,841 votes, suggesting that she was unable to retain the entire AIADMK vote base (even after adjusting for the lower voter turnout).

In Madurantakam, AIADMK candidate Maragatham Kumaravel, who contested the byelection on the TVK ticket, secured 74,048 votes, more than 5,000 above her tally in the Assembly election. This was despite the TVK's candidate, Ezhil Katherine, having secured 62,090 votes in the Assembly election. The increase notwithstanding, the result raises questions about the extent to which the AIADMK's vote base remained with Ms. Kumaravel after her defection to the TVK.

The DMK's vote count, too, declined. I. Paranthaman, a well-known party face but an outsider to the constituency, secured 54,008 votes, against the 59,838 polled by the party's candidate, S. Amulu Ponmalar, in the Assembly election. The decline could partly be attributed to the absence of allies such as the VCK, which has a substantial presence in the constituency. The Pattali Makkal Katchi's (PMK), decision to remain neutral in the election may have divided its Vanniyar support base. The party had contested the Assembly election in the company of the AIADMK.

DMK president M.K. Stalin said the combined votes polled by the parties that contested against the ruling TVK showed that the government had been rejected by a majority of voters.

A senior DMK leader and former Minister described the result in Dharapuram as an "honourable defeat", pointing out that the constituency was in the Kongu region, considered an AIADMK stronghold, and that former Chief Minister Edappadi K. Palaniswami remained a well-known political figure in the area.

"In Madurantakam too, we have retained our vote bank even though our allies have switched camps. We need to concentrate on the section of young voters who have grown fond of the TVK and the screen-crafted charisma of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay. We will evolve a strategy to overcome the shortcomings," he added.

# Maragatham Kumaravel romps home in Madurantakam, this time on TVK ticket

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

**Big win:** TVK Madurantakam (R) candidate Maragatham Kumaravel receiving the winning certificate on Friday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Maragatham Kumaravel, two-time AIADMK MLA from Madurantakam (R), retained her seat, contesting this time on a TVK ticket, as the byelection result was declared on Friday. She defeated her nearest rival, I. Paranthamen of the DMK, by a margin of 20,040 votes. Mr. Paranthamen polled 54,008 votes, followed by S. Kanitha Sampath of the AIADMK with 47,450 votes.

The byelection was necessitated by Ms. Kumaravel's resignation from the Assembly barely three weeks into her second term. She, along with three other AIADMK MLAs, resigned and joined the ruling TVK. As counting progressed, Ms. Maragatham built up a gradual lead, working up a margin of at least a thousand votes at the end of every round. Halfway into the process, she already had a lead of well over 11,000 votes.

She received he winner's certificate from Returning Officer K.R. Narendran, Revenue Divisional Officer, Madurantakam, late in the evening. Ms. Maragatham said she quit the AIADMK after she noticed certain elements colluding with the rival DMK after the general election results favoured the TVK. "This goes against the principles the party stood for. So, I left," she told reporters. She felt the people have given a suitable answer to the "vicious campaign" launched against her by the two Dravidian parties surrounding her resignation. As news of her initial lead tricked out, TVK supporters began gathering outside the counting centre at the Integrated Training Institute for Social Empowerment in Aathur village. With whistles in their mouths, the red-and-gold brigade began celebrations early, chanting slogans in support of their '*thalapathy*' (Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay) and the 'winning candidate'.

*For the full story, visit: https://newsth.live/Madurantakam*

# P. Sathyabama elected in Dharapuram, defeats DMK candidate by 9,471 votes

**The Hindu Bureau**
TIRUPPUR

**Close contest:** TVK Dharapuram (R) candidate P. Sathyabama receiving the winning certificate on Friday. S. SIVA SARAVANAN

From fighting a neck-to-neck battle in the initial rounds in Dharapuram (R), the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) candidate P. Sathyabama went on to establish decent leads and romped home by a margin of 9,471 votes, defeating her immediate rival S. Suganya of the DMK in the bypoll on Friday. Interestingly, at one point, the AIADMK candidate K. Banumathi had secured a slender lead and emerged as the frontrunner. However, she slipped in subsequent rounds.

The vacancy was caused by the resignation of Ms. Sathyabama, who had resigned her Assembly membership after winning on an AIADMK ticket in May and joined the TVK.

As counting of votes began in the morning, Ms. Banumathi, after the very first round, took a a slender lead of five votes over Ms. Sathyabama by polling 2,639 votes. In the fifth round, the TVK candidate turned the tables by establishing lead of 724 votes, and gradually consolidated the lead there on. In the 11th round, the DMK candidate came second and held on to the spot.

The counting, which began at 8.30 a.m., wrapped up a little after 4 p.m.

The verdict has proven that the people are in favour of the TVK-led government, and they had dismissed "propaganda" that the opposition had spread about her, Ms. Satyabhama told mediapersons after receiving the winning certificate from Returning Officer and Revenue Divisional Officer of Dharapuram Division Felix Raja.

Questioning the newly-elected MLA's contention, the NTK candidate charged that the ruling party had used money power to win the election, and that there was no level playing field. The AIADMK candidate said she accepted the people's verdict.

*For the full story, visit: https://newsth.live/Dharapuram*

# It is a victory for the people and political decorum: Chief Minister

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

C. Joseph Vijay

Chief Minister and Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) president C. Joseph Vijay on Friday said the party's victories in the Madurantakam (comfortable lead as of 5.45 pm) and Dharapuram Assembly bypolls is a victory for the people and "political decorum", and thanked voters for their support.

In a statement on X, Mr. Vijay claimed the TVK had won without distributing money to voters or resorting to inducements. He said the results demonstrated that Tamil Nadu was a stronghold of people's power rather than corrupt forces.

He criticised those who had alleged political deals had taken place and mocked his two-day campaign in each of the constituencies, saying voters had given them a fitting response through the results. He also claimed the party could have achieved a different outcome in the April Assembly election had the DMK government allowed him to campaign across the State.

Mr. Vijay thanked voters in both constituencies for electing the TVK candidates: Maragatham Kumaravel in Madurantakam and P. Sathyabama in Dharapuram.

He also thanked alliance partners, along with party functionaries and cadres, for their work during the campaign.

He said the victory was neither a personal achievement for him nor one solely for the TVK, but a response to "derogatory remarks against women", personal attacks and the betrayal of leaders and their supporters.

# 'An endorsement of govt.'s performance'

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI/TIRUCHI

Leaders of the parties in the ruling alliance have welcomed the TVK's victories in the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly byelections, contending that the results were an endorsement of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and the government's stand on coalition politics.

VCK president Thol. Thirumavalavan said the victories of TVK candidates Maragatham Kumaravel and P. Sathyabama in the two constituencies reflected public recognition of the Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance.

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee president B. Manickam Tagore said the results reflected public support for the Vijay-led government.

Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan (Congress) said the victory in both constituencies reflected the people's recognition of the TVK-led government's performance.

MDMK general secretary Vaiko also congratulated Ms. Kumaravel and Ms. Sathyabama. He added that voters had expressed confidence in the Vijay-led government and thanked the electorate.

Speaking to reporters in Tiruchi, IUML president K.M. Kader Mohideen said the bypoll win was an endorsement of the TVK's good governance.

# Bypoll results only a temporary win for politics of betrayal: Stalin

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Friday described the outcome of the byelections to the Dharapuram and Madurantakam Assembly constituencies as a "temporary victory for the politics of betrayal", but said the "fall of the politics of false image has begun".

In a social media post, he said the votes polled by the parties that contested against the ruling TVK showed that it had been rejected by a majority of voters. "What is important is the votes polled by the parties that contested against the betraying force, the TVK. It has been rejected by a majority of the people," he said. He thanked the DMK cadre for ensuring a tough contest and instilling fear in the ruling party.

> What is important is the votes polled by the parties that contested against the betraying force, the TVK. It has been rejected by a majority of the people
>
> **M.K. STALIN**
> DMK president

**Misuse of power: EPS**

AIADMK general secretary and former Chief Minister Edappadi K. Palaniswami termed the TVK's victory in the byelections a "temporary victory" and alleged that the ruling party had misused its administrative machinery and money power to win the polls. In a statement, he alleged that the byelections were necessitated by the TVK's attempt to convert its minority government into a majority one by engaging in "horse-trading" of AIADMK MLAs.

AMMK general secretary T.T.V. Dhinakaran termed the TVK's victory temporary, and said rising prices of essential commodities, power cuts, farmers' distress, murders, sexual crimes, and drug proliferation had pushed Tamil Nadu into a crisis.

## INBRIEF

### Suspended DSP arrested on charges of harassing wife

The Crime Branch-CID (CB-CID) arrested Jaffar Siddiq, a suspended Deputy Superintendent of Police (DSP) of Paramakudi, after his wife accused him of physically assaulting her. Siddiq was arrested after eight hours of questioning. He was produced before the Vellore Special Court for cases under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act and remanded in judicial custody on Thursday. His wife lodged a complaint on August 4 alleging that he had been involved with several women and had assaulted her when she questioned him about it. Based on the complaint, the Vellore CB-CID police unit registered a case against Siddiq. He was suspended from service on August 21, pending further proceedings.

### Annamalai hails Navanethem Pillay's Nobel Peace Prize win

Former BJP leader and founder of the 'We The Leaders' movement K. Annamalai on Friday hailed South African jurist and former United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights Navanethem "Navi" Pillay on being selected for the Nobel Peace Prize. From humble beginnings in Durban, Ms. Pillay, whose parents were of Tamil descent, and whose grandfather was brought to South Africa to work in sugar plantations, pursued a lifelong crusade against apartheid, gender discrimination, and systemic injustice, Mr. Annamalai said. "From serving as a fearless human rights lawyer and the first non-white woman judge of South Africa's High Court, to providing stellar leadership as the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights, she has shown unwavering dedication to the marginalised," he said.

# Two Scheduled Caste men fall at BC villagers' feet after row over burial in cemetery

BC community members object to the burial of a 90-year-old SC man at the common cemetery, and threaten the SC community not to approach the dominant caste for any work in the future

**The Hindu Bureau**
ERODE

Allegations of caste discrimination have surfaced in Perumbali village in Madathupalayam panchayat near Perundurai in Erode district, after two members of a Scheduled Caste (SC) community reportedly fell at the feet of members of a Backward Caste (BC) community amid opposition to burial in a common cemetery.

More than 100 people belonging to the SC community live in the village. They faced difficulties burying their dead in the local cemetery owing to opposition from members of the dominant BC community and have had to take bodies to Thingalur, about five kilometres away.

Following a survey, the Perundurai Tahsildar had declared the burial ground common to all communities.

**SC members threatened**
On October 5, Chenni, a 90-year-old inhabitant belonging to the SC community, died of age-related ailments.

When members of the SC community took his body to the cemetery, they allegedly faced opposition from members of the BC community, leading to an argument.

During the argument, members of the SC community were allegedly threatened and told not to approach the other community for any work in the future.

Following this, two members of the SC community fell at the feet of the members of the BC community.

According to the district police, the burial was conducted under the protection of police and Revenue Department officials.

**Caste conflict:** The district police said the burial was conducted under the protection of police and Revenue Department officials.

**Case registered**
The police said a case had been registered at Thingalur police station on Thursday night based on a complaint lodged by the Perundurai Revenue Inspector.

Provisions of the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, were invoked against two persons in connection with the incident. An investigation is under way.

**Outrage over incident**
Video footage of the incident, including the alleged humiliation of the SC community members, was circulated on social media, triggering condemnation and demands for action against those responsible.

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) State Coordinator for the Western Zone P. Eswaran alleged that members of the BC community had violated the rights of people belonging to the SC community by opposing their use of the common burial ground.

Mr. Eswaran said the alleged threat that they would be denied work if they used the cemetery amounted to caste oppression.

He also condemned the alleged exploitation of their economic vulnerability to force them to fall at the feet of members of the other community.

Mr. Eswaran questioned the role of the police and Revenue Department officials present at the spot and demanded action against those who opposed the burial and the officials who allegedly failed to prevent the humiliation.

# T.N. Home Secretary transferred, Prem Anand Sinha posted as Director of DVAC

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

K. Manivasan

Tamil Nadu Home Secretary K. Manivasan has been transferred and posted as the Commissioner of Land Administration in the rank of Additional Chief Secretary.

Dr. Manivasan was appointed Home Secretary by the Election Commission of India ahead of the 2026 Assembly election. He held the portfolios of Home, Excise and Prohibition.

He has been replaced by A. Karthik, Chairman and Managing Director of the Tamil Nadu Small Industries Development Corporation.

Senior IPS officer and Additional Director-General of Police (ADGP) Prem Anand Sinha has been posted as ADGP/Director of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Directorate (DVAC), Tamil Nadu. He was the Tambaram Police Commissioner.

The post had fallen vacant following the transfer of another IPS officer, A. Arun, in July 2026.

Inspector General of Police C. Mageshwari was given the additional charge of Director.

ADGP/Commissioner of Police of the Greater Chennai Police A. Amalraj has been given the additional charge of Commissioner of Tambaram City Police until further orders.

**TNEB Chairman**
Rajesh Lakhoni, Commissioner of Land Administration, has been posted as the Chairman and Managing Director of the Tamil Nadu Electricity Board (TNEB) and the Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd. (TNPDCL).

In another key transfer, V. Arun Roy, Chairman and Managing Director of TNEB and the TNPDCL, besides being the head of the State's green energy, transmission and power generation corporations, has been posted as Secretary, Finance (Expenditure). He succeeds N. Venkatesh.

Mr. Venkatesh has been appointed as the Agriculture Production Commissioner and Secretary to the Agriculture-Farmers Welfare Department, the portfolios additionally held by N. Subbaiyan.

# Faeces in school water tank: two boys behind the act, but no malicious intent, says SP

**The Hindu Bureau**
DINDIGUL

**Faeces was found in the drinking water tank of the Manoor Panchayat Union Primary School near Palani in Dindigul district on October 5**

A day after it was brought to light that faeces was found in a drinking water tank of a government school at Manoor near Palani in Dindigul district, Dindigul Superintendent of Police S. Jeyakumar on Friday said two 11-year-old boys were behind the act. The officer claimed that they had no malicious intent.

Addressing journalists in Palani, Mr. Jeyakumar said a special team, led by Palani Deputy Superintendent of Police Devaraj, was formed to investigate the incident. The team questioned over 40 persons in connection with the case.

"Preliminary investigation revealed that two 11-year-old boys from the same locality were behind the act. There was no malicious intent and it was done in a playful manner," he said.

The officer said it was common for boys in the locality (including the two suspects) to play Kabaddi on the school premises.

Faeces was found in the water tank of Manoor Panchayat Union Primary School located within Keeranur police station limits on October 5, after the quarterly examination break. The headmaster got the water tank cleaned.

The issue was raised during the Parent-Teacher Association and the School Management Committee meeting held at the school on Wednesday.

Enraged by the incident, parents staged a protest and accused the school administration of negligence on student safety. The SP then visited the school and inspected the water tank on the premises.

Acting on a complaint lodged by the headmaster, the Keeranur police registered a case under the provisions of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. District education officials also visited the school and held meetings with parents and school authorities.

# Supreme Court backs T.N. Speaker's decision to drop disqualification proceedings against AIADMK MLAs

**Aaratrika Bhaumik**
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday declined to intervene in the Tamil Nadu Assembly Speaker's decision to close disqualification proceedings against a group of AIADMK legislators who had supported C. Joseph Vijay's TVK-led government during the trust vote in May. The court observed that the Speaker's decision could not be challenged by an "interloper".

A Bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana dismissed a plea filed by advocate P.V. Selvakumar, while observing that the sanctity of the constitutional mandate under the Tenth Schedule, which contains the anti-defection law, must be preserved.

"We are fully with you that the sanctity of constitutional mandate must be preserved. But we must understand the workings of a democratic system," the Bench said.

Mr. Selvakumar approached the Supreme Court after the Madras High Court rejected his petition challenging the Speaker's June 9 decision to drop the disqualification proceedings against the AIADMK legislators.

**Party leader's letter**
The Speaker had acted on a May 27 letter from the party's general secretary seeking withdrawal of the proceedings. The High Court had held that Mr. Selvakumar, being a third party to the dispute, had no *locus standi* to interfere in the internal affairs of the AIADMK.

Advocate Nina Nariman, appearing for Mr. Selvakumar, argued that once the Speaker had entertained the disqualification petition, the proceedings ought to have been taken to their logical conclusion. The legislators, she submitted, had defied the party whip by supporting the government in the confidence vote.

The court observes that the Speaker's decision cannot be challenged by an 'interloper'.

The Bench, however, drew a distinction between defection and differences that may arise within a political party in a multi-party democracy. "We have a multi-party system. One can say I prefer party C to be in power than party B. If the party had made an application, we could appreciate. But here, it appears you are at best an opportunistic interloper or at best a conscientious person adhering to minority philosophy," it said.

The Bench also said the AIADMK itself had chosen not to pursue action against the legislators. "Also look at the burden. If one party could not muster the courage and missed by a very thin margin, if nobody supports, what will be the consequence? There will be fresh elections... Once a political party absolves defection due to political purpose, it will be difficult for us to bind them down in narrow legalistic terms," it said.

The Bench further said that although the legislators may have voted contrary to the party whip and thereby enabled the government to survive the confidence vote, they had not ceased to be members of the AIADMK. The court subsequently dismissed the plea.

The High Court had in August held that the AIADMK general secretary's decision to condone the conduct of 21 legislators brought the disqualification proceedings against them to an end.

The controversy arose after 25 AIADMK legislators defied the party whip and supported the TVK government during the May 13 confidence vote.

The TVK, which had secured 108 seats in the Assembly election, won the trust vote with the backing of 144 legislators in the 234-member House.

# Former DMK Minister E.V. Velu, his son Kumaran seek anticipatory bail in lakebed excavation case

**Mohamed Imranullah S.**
CHENNAI

Former Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) Minister E.V. Velu, 76, and his son E.V. Kumaran, 48, have filed anticipatory bail petitions before the Madras High Court in a lakebed excavation case.

They had allegedly excavated 45,72,058 cubic feet of sand from the Malappambadi Lake in Tiruvannamalai district to level the venue for the party's north zone youth wing conference held on December 14, 2025.

Justice V. Lakshminarayanan on Friday accepted a request made by State Public Prosecutor R. John Sathyan to grant time till October 13 for filing written objections on behalf of the Directorate of Vigilance and Anti-Corruption (DVAC).

E.V. Velu

The judge orally advised the prosecution not to take any coercive action until then, since the first petitioner was a septuagenarian.

The petitioners had chosen to seek advance bail, through their counsel Rahul Balaji, after the judge, earlier this week, rejected their plea for *ex parte* interim relief in two other petitions filed by them, urging the court to quash the First Information Report (FIR).

The DVAC registered the FIR on September 24, 2026, on the basis of a complaint filed by Jayaram Venkatesan of the anti-corruption organisation Arappor Iyakkam.

The complainant had alleged that the excavation was carried out on about eight acres of the waterbody in and around November 2025 to level the land belonging to a private company, of which Mr. Kumaran was one of the directors.

It was claimed that the alleged illegal excavation had resulted in a loss of ₹8.22 crore to the exchequer. However, both petitioners claimed that they were innocent and had not committed any offence as alleged by the complainant.

In his petition, Mr. Velu said there was no overt act attributed to him in the complaint and there was no specific allegation that he had influenced any government official during his stint as the Minister last year.

"The allegation that the petitioner's son, E.V. Kumaran, was responsible for the alleged excavation of gravel/lake-bed material is a hypothetical allegation. The mere fact that unauthorised excavation or mining is alleged to have taken place does not, by itself, furnish any basis to attribute the commission of such offence to the petitioner or his son," his advance bail petition read.

Pointing out that he was the Minister of State Highways, Minor Ports, and Public Works Departments during the previous DMK government, Mr. Velu said that even according to the complainant, the Malappambadi Lake was under the control of the revenue, corporation, and geology and mining authorities, none of whom were under his portfolio.

# Rahul Gandhi to discuss NEET, lack of jobs with students today

**The Hindu Bureau**
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president Manickam Tagore on Friday said Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi would address various issues related to students at Island Grounds in Chennai on Saturday evening.

According to Mr. Tagore, 10,000 to 20,000 students, who registered and received the QR code, will be participating in the event.

Mr. Gandhi will also meet Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at his residence.

"Our leader will address issues related to Tamil Nadu students such as National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test, lack of jobs, education for girls and women, and the Union government's educational policy. It is going to be an interactive session. Though protests are happening in New Delhi, he [Mr. Gandhi] is coming to Chennai because he had agreed to this," the TNCC president further said.

Rahul Gandhi

**Bypoll results**
Regarding the bypoll results, Mr. Tagore said the AIADMK support base could soon shift to the TVK. "In the last 25 years, this is the first bypoll to be held without money being distributed to voters," he claimed.

"It is possible that the AIADMK's support base could shift to the TVK because of the Chief Minister's governance in the last four months," he said.

"I welcome the results. It is a victory for the TVK and its coalition government. He [Mr. Vijay] has brought in significant change," he said.

Ramesh Chennithala and Pinarayi Vijayan. FILE PHOTO

# Kerala HC orders FIR against Pinarayi, kin in CMRL pay-off case

**The Hindu Bureau**
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court on Friday directed that an FIR be registered, incorporating offences under the Prevention of Corruption Act (PCA), against Keralam Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan, his daughter T. Veena, and son-in-law P.A. Mohamed Riyas in the CMRL-Exalogic pay-off case.

The petitioner, K.M. Shajahan, an advocate, had earlier approached the State Police Chief and the Director of Vigilance, seeking registration of an FIR and an investigation into allegations of disproportionate assets and intentional enrichment by Mr. Vijayan, abetment under the PCA, and alleged money laundering by Ms. Veena and Mr. Riyas.

**'Legal steps only'**

Keralam Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala, in response to the High Court's directive, on Friday said the government would take an appropriate decision to register an FIR against Mr. Vijayan and others in the case after examining the order.

Addressing the press-person on the sidelines of c0c0n 2026, an annual cybersecurity conference in Kochi, Mr. Chennithala said the government had so far acted in the case only on the basis of legal advice and that the latest court order was not a setback for the UDF government.

"The petition before the High Court came up even as the SIT was going ahead with its procedures. Now we will go through the order and take proper legal steps," he said.

The Home Minister stressed that the SIT was formed specifically in accordance with the guidelines laid down in the *Lalita Kumari v. Government of Uttar Pradesh* case.

"We have followed the guideline that an FIR should be registered only after a preliminary examination in five types of complaints. If the High Court says otherwise, we will take legal steps after examining the order," he said.

# SC rejects A.P. plea to restore 34% BC quota in local bodies

Court says data from a unified family survey are insufficient to justify the enhanced reservation; State argues the 2026 quota exercise was based on a fresh survey and a dedicated panel's findings

**Aaratrika Bhaumik**
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday dismissed the Andhra Pradesh government's appeal against a High Court ruling that struck down its decision to restore 34% reservation for Backward Classes (BC) in local bodies. The court upheld the October 1 verdict that the State had failed to produce the empirical data necessary to justify breaching the 50% reservation ceiling.

Senior advocate Mukul Rohatgi contended before a Bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu that the State's decision was supported by demographic data and other empirical material, but the High Court had erroneously concluded that it fell short of the requirements previously laid down by the top court for breaching the 50% reservation cap.

The Bench observed that figures drawn from a unified family survey were insufficient to justify the enhanced quota in the absence of a specific empirical assessment of backwardness and representation in local bodies. "You show us how this data can be considered. This is a unified family survey. Under what law is this being made? Very reasonable approach by the High Court," the Bench remarked while dismissing the plea.

The State argued the 2026 quota exercise was based on a fresh survey, local-body data and a dedicated commission's findings.

> You show us how this data can be considered. This is a unified family survey. Under what law is this being made? Very reasonable approach by the High Court
> **SUPREME COURT**

## TDP to give 34% seats to BCs in local polls: Naidu

Reacting to the SC verdict, A.P. CM N. Chandrababu Naidu said the TDP would continue to ensure representation for BCs by allotting 34% seats in the local body polls.

# Assam CM writes to Naidu, seeks probe into student's death in A.P.

**The Hindu Bureau**
GUWAHATI

**Sarma says that he had deputed senior Assam police officer to A.P. to coordinate with local law enforcement**

A 21-year-old female student from Guwahati, Assam, who had called her family from a train to report feeling unsafe amid drunken men in her coach, was found dead beside the railway tracks in Andhra Pradesh's Srikakulam district on Wednesday, October 7.

The railway police suspect she fell from the moving train, while her family alleges "murder".

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma in a letter to his Andhra Pradesh counterpart, N. Chandrababu Naidu, and Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Friday urged them to ensure a "thorough, impartial and timebound" probe into the death of the student.

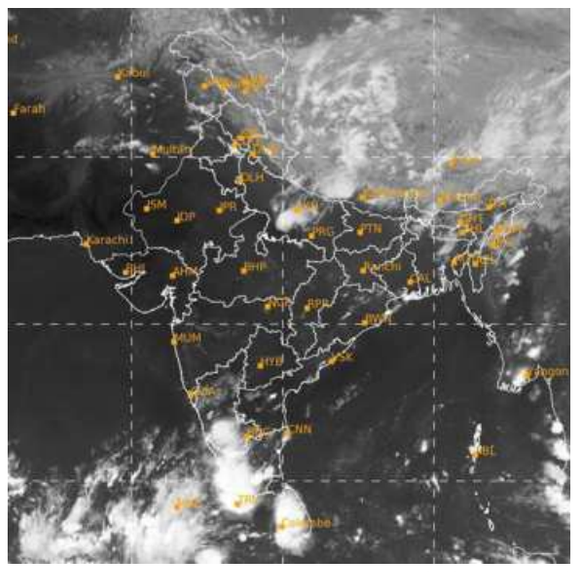
**Suspicion of 'foul play'**

Mr. Sarma said that the student's body was recovered from a jungle area after she had called her family expressing fear over the presence of many men around her in a second-class compartment of the Dibrugarh Vivek Express train. She had boarded the train at Visakhapatnam on October 5. "Her bag was found in the train's S2 coach and her body was later recovered from a forested area near Malayapuram in Srikakulam district. These circumstances raise a serious suspicion of foul play. The incident has caused profound grief and concern in Assam," Mr. Sarma wrote in the letter.

He said that he had deputed a senior Assam police officer to Andhra Pradesh to coordinate with local law enforcement agencies.

## WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

**Forecast for Saturday:** Heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Keralam and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning/gusty winds likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Jharkhand, Odisha and Andhra Pradesh

| CITY | RAIN | MAX | MIN | CITY | RAIN | MAX | MIN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Agartala | 20 | 30.8 | 21.2 | Kurnool | — | 38.1 | 26.0 |
| Ahmedabad | — | 37.0 | 22.6 | Lucknow | — | 31.5 | 22.0 |
| Aizawl | — | 31.5 | 22.2 | Madurai | — | 37.0 | 25.0 |
| Bengaluru | — | 29.8 | 22.4 | Mangaluru | — | 32.5 | 24.6 |
| Bhopal | — | 35.4 | 20.5 | Mumbai | — | 37.8 | 25.8 |
| Bhubaneswar | — | 34.6 | 23.5 | Mysuru | — | 31.2 | 21.0 |
| Chandigarh | — | 32.3 | 23.4 | New Delhi | — | 36.1 | 25.2 |
| Chennai | — | 36.0 | 27.6 | Patna | — | 31.0 | 23.3 |
| Coimbatore | — | 35.5 | 24.8 | Port Blair | — | 31.8 | 25.4 |
| Dehradun | 0.4 | 26.6 | 19.8 | Prayagraj | — | 33.4 | 23.0 |
| Gangtok | 0.8 | 18.5 | 14.4 | Puducherry | — | 34.4 | 26.6 |
| Goa | — | 34.8 | 25.4 | Pune | — | 36.0 | 21.8 |
| Guwahati | 60.8 | 28.6 | 20.9 | Raipur | — | 35.4 | 24.5 |
| Hubballi | — | 34.0 | 21.0 | Ranchi | — | 27.8 | 19.0 |
| Hyderabad | — | 35.2 | 23.0 | Shillong | 0.4 | 21.0 | 15.3 |
| Imphal | 10.6 | 28.9 | 18.0 | Shimla | — | 24.4 | 15.5 |
| Jaipur | — | 36.4 | 24.7 | Srinagar | 1.3 | 26.5 | 9.3 |
| Kochi | 1 | 31.8 | 26.4 | Thiruvananthapuram | 31 | 32.5 | 25.4 |
| Kohima | 1.2 | 20.4 | 15.0 | Tiruchirappalli | — | 36.1 | 26.0 |
| Kolkata | 16 | 30.5 | 24.1 | Vijayawada | — | 34.4 | 25.6 |
| Kozhikode | 6 | 36.0 | 26.7 | Visakhapatnam | — | 34.0 | 26.1 |

*(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)*

**Pollutants in the air you are breathing**

| CITIES | $SO_2$ | $NO_2$ | CO | PM2.5 | PM10 | CODE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ahmedabad | .65 | ..68 | .56 | ...186 | ...201 | |
| Bengaluru | .30 | ..21 | .44 | .....50 | ...122 | |
| Chennai | ....6 | ..10 | .38 | .....69 | ....71 | |
| Delhi | ....4 | ..62 | 128 | ...222 | ...229 | |
| Hyderabad | .12 | ..19 | .28 | ...137 | ...112 | |
| Kolkata | .11 | ..14 | 100 | .....48 | ....56 | |
| Lucknow | ....5 | ..28 | .25 | .....70 | ....95 | |
| Mumbai | ....9 | ..71 | .36 | ...111 | ...122 | |
| Pune | .15 | ..77 | .67 | ...101 | ...128 | |
| Visakhapatnam | .20 | ..90 | .37 | .....74 | ...148 | |

**Yesterday**

In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Baghpat, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 271 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Gadag, Karnataka recorded a healthy AQI score of 19

**Air Quality Code:** Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

**$SO_2$:** Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

**$NO_2$:** Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

**CO:** Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

**PM2.5 & PM10:** Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

# University students call off protest over *Vande Mataram* row

**The Hindu Bureau**
KASARAGOD

The students of the Central University of Kerala (CUK) have temporarily called off their protest following discussions with the university Registrar on Friday. The protest was launched after five students were suspended by the proctor for protesting during a national seminar organised at the university to mark the 150th anniversary of *Vande Mataram*.

Student representatives said the university had agreed to form an inquiry committee to examine their grievances and had accepted their demand to exclude proctor Sreekumar from the panel.

The students protested demanding, among other things, that the suspension orders be withdrawn.

**No final decision**

During discussions with the Registrar, students insisted that they will not accept an inquiry conducted by a panel that included the proctor, who had taken disciplinary action against them. Following their objection, the university agreed to constitute an inquiry committee without the proctor, the representatives said.

However, no final decision has been reached on the students' demands. Student representatives have sought an appointment with the Vice-Chancellor on Monday to discuss suspensions and other related issues.

A delegation of five student representatives is expected to meet the vice chancellor.

# APSRTC driver dies after steering bus to safety

**The Hindu Bureau**
VIJAYAWADA

A 34-year-old Andhra Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation (APSRTC) driver who suffered a heart attack at the wheel steered his Kakinada-Visakhapatnam bus, with around 40 passengers on board, to the side of the road near Tuni on Thursday, parked it and collapsed. The driver was declared dead on arrival at the hospital. APSRTC chairman Konakalla Narayana Rao paid tribute to him on Friday. In a statement, the chairman expressed deep sorrow over the incident and said [he] had shown exceptional presence of mind and a strong sense of responsibility by bringing the bus to a safe halt.

**National Highways Authority of India**
(Ministry of Road Transport & Highways)

**EXPRESSION OF INTEREST**

National Highways Authority of India invites Expression of Interest (EOI) in the first phase from Indian Institutes of Technology (IITs), Indian Institute of Science (IISc) for empanelment with NHAI for independent proof checking of major bridge designs and associated hydrological/hydraulic studies for National Highway/Expressway projects.

The broad scope shall include independent review/proof checking of structural design calculations, drawings, relevant geotechnical aspects, hydrological and hydraulic studies, and other associated technical documents, as specified in the detailed EOI document.

The empanelled institutions shall have appropriate technical expertise, qualified faculty/experts and requisite institutional infrastructure in the relevant fields. The detailed scope of services, eligibility criteria, empanelment procedure, deliverables, timelines and other terms & conditions shall be as stipulated in the EOI document.

**Last Date for Submission of EOI: 20.10.2026 (upto 6:00 PM)**

The detailed EOI document and further information may be accessed from the official NHAI website:
**https://nhai.gov.in/#/empanelment-technical-institutionsfirms**

NHAI reserves the right to accept or reject any/all EOIs and to modify, withdraw or cancel the EOI process, as deemed appropriate.

critique

***BUILDING A NATION, NOT JUST ROADS***

**WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY, JABALPUR**
**Engineering Department, Open tender (E-Tender)**

E-Tender on behalf of the President of India acting through Sr. Divisional Engineer (Co-Ordination), Divisional Railway Manager (Works), West Central Railway, Jabalpur for the following work :- **NIT No.** : DRMW-JBP-195-2026 Dated:30.09.2026, **Name of work with location** : Construction of drains in yards in connection with yard improvement works on Satna -Manikpur and Satna - Rewa section under Divisional Engineer (North) Jabalpur jurisdiction. **Approx. Cost of the work** : 9,65,51,147/-, **Earnest Money** : 19,31,000/-, **Completion Period** : 18 Months, **Last date & time for submission of tender (Upto 15:00 hrs. on)** : 27.10.2026. **Tender to be opened at 15:15 hrs.** : 27.10.2026. **NIT No. :** DRMW-JBP-196-2026 Dated:30.09.2026, **Name of work with location** : Miscellaneous Left over works in Govindgarh (GGWT) - Bhagwar (BGWR) - Rampur Naikin (RPNN) section on Assistant Divisional Engineer (North) Satna sub division under jurisdiction of Senior Divisional Engineer (North) Jabalpur. **Approx. Cost of the work** : 5,53,26,701/-, **Earnest Money** : 11,06,500/-, **Completion Period** : 12 Months, **Last date & time for submission of tender (Upto 15:00 hrs. on)** : 27.10.2026. **Tender to be opened at 15:15 hrs.** : 27.10.2026. **NIT No.** : DRMW-JBP-197-2026 Dated: 01.10.2026, **Name of work with location** : Welding of 60Kg/90UTS/R260 rails in-situ with single shot crucible fitted in connection with various track renewal works under Senior Divisional Engineer (North) Jabalpur section. **Approx. Cost of the work** : 1,07,38,981/-, **Earnest Money** : 2,14,800/-, **Completion Period** : 12 Months, **Last date & time for submission of tender (Upto 15:00 hrs. on)** : 27.10.2026. **Tender to be opened at 15:15 hrs.** : 27.10.2026. **NIT No.** : DRMW-JBP-198-2026 Dated: 01.10.2026, **Name of work with location** : Katni - Manikpur & Jukehi - Kymore - Provision of toilet and drinking water arrangement at level crossing gates. **Approx. Cost of the work** : 65,64,331/-, **Earnest Money** : 1,31,300/-, **Completion Period** : 12 Months, **Last date & time for submission of tender (Upto 15:00 hrs. on)** : 27.10.2026. **Tender to be opened at 15:15 hrs.** : 27.10.2026. **NIT No.** : DRMW-JBP-199-2026 Dated:01.10.2026, **Name of work with location** : Supplying, stacking and loading of 65mm machine crushed hard and durable track stone ballast as per Rly's specification for track ballast IS/RDSO-GE/0001:2023 including all lead, lift, taxes, royalties, duties etc. at Damoh depot under Assistant Divisional Engineer Damoh Sub division. **Approx. Cost of the work** : 6,34,80,480/-, **Earnest Money** : 12,69,600/-, **Completion Period** : 18 Months, **Last date & time for submission of tender (Upto 15:00 hrs. on)** : 27.10.2026. **Tender to be opened at 15:15 hrs.** : 27.10.2026. The complete information of the above e-tender' is available on website **https://ireps.gov.in** and also placed on notice board of the Divisional Railway Manager (Works) Office, West Central Railway, Jabalpur. Tenders other than in the form of e-bids shall not be accepted against above tenders.

**(SD.)**
**Divisional Railway Manager (Works), Jabalpur**

स्वच्छ भारत अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर

**Office of the Principal**
**Government Polytechnic, Katihar**
Govt. of Bihar
**E-mail ID –principal124gpkatihar@gmail.com, Website-www.gpkatihar.ac.in**

NIT NO. – GPK/2026-27/02-05

**NOTICE INVITING for TENDERS**

**(Through e-procurement mode only – www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)**

1. Government Polytechnic, Katihar has been established under the Department of Science, Technology and Technical Education, Government of Bihar to cater to the needs of technical education. The institute is providing technical education as per the norms set by the All-India Council for Technical Education (AICTE). The Government Polytechnic, Katihar intends to supply and installation of Electrical, Mechanical, Computer Science and Engineering and Electronics Engineering Lab Instruments in Government Polytechnic, Katihar and invites bids from eligible entities/vendors through the two-bid system as per the requirements and terms and conditions mentioned in the tender document.
2. To participate in the e-tendering process, the bidder/agency is required to get registered with eproc2.bihar.gov.in.
3. **Schedule of Events:**

| Sn. | Event Description | Timeline |
|---|---|---|
| 3.1 | Last date & time of downloading the RFP | Till 31 October 2026 up to 03:00 PM, on eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 3.2 | Pre-bid meeting | 16 October 2026 at 11:00 AM |
| 3.3 | Submission (upload) of online bidding document. | 31 October 2026 till 05:00 PM, on eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 3.4 | Submission of EMD | Bank Guarantee, Internet Payment Gateway (IPG)and Demand Draft submission Offline/Online by 31/10/2026 till 05 PM to Government Polytechnic Katihar and eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 3.5 | Opening of Technical Bid | 02 November 2026 on the eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 3.6 | Opening of Finacial Bid | 06 November 2026 on the eproc2.bihar.gov.in |
| 3.7 | Pre- bid meeting venue | Government Polytechnic Katihar, Bheria Rahika, BMP -07, Katihar |
| 3.8 | Contact person | Principal Government Polytechnic Katihar<br>Mobile no-9473035353<br>Email ID- principal124gpkatihar@gmail.com |
| 3.9 | Method of Selection | Least Cost Selection (LCS) |

**Note: Interested bidders may obtain further information about this Notice Inviting Tender (NIT) from the office of Government Polytechnic, Katihar No tender will be accepted after the closing date and time in any circumstances.**

4. Bidders/Agencies may also download the tender documents available from eproc2.bihar.gov.in and submit the tender by using the downloaded document.
5. The tender shall be accompanied by an Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in the shape of Bank Guarantee, Internet Payment Gateway (IPG) and Demand Draft from any Schedule Bank in favour of Principal, Government Polytechnic Katihar, Account No-32303978456, IFSC Code-SBIN0000203, Bank Name-SBI Katihar.
6. Government Polytechnic, Katihar reserves the right to accept or reject any tender & may change the terms and conditions of NIT, or cancel the NIT without assigning any reasons at any stage and time.
7. While reading the tender document if you identify any error or omission, please advise the Government Polytechnic, Katihar in writing, within 11 calendar days from the date of publication of the tender by giving a brief description of the problems, its location in the document along with your contact details.
8. Bidders upload only requisite paper on respective tab of e-proc portal, no any extra paper uploaded on respective tab. In case of bidder do not upload requisite paper in given tab of e-proc portal the bid will not be considered and the bidder shall be responsible for rejection of bid.

**Confidentiality**

This document contains privileged and confidential information pertaining to the "supply and installation of Electrical Mechanical, Computer Science and Engineering and Electronics Engineering Lab Instruments" in Government Polytechnic, Katihar. The access level for the document is specified above. The addressee should honour access rights by preventing intentional or accidental access outside the access scope.

**Principal**
**Government Polytechnic Katihar**

PR- 013384 (Science & Tech.) 2026-27

For further details please visit : www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar

**नशे से बचने का है एक ही उपचार, दृढ़ संकल्प और परिवार से प्यार**

**TAMIL NADU STATE MARKETING CORPORATION LIMITED**
CMDA TOWER-II, IV FLOOR, GANDHI IRWIN BRIDGE ROAD, EGMORE, CHENNAI – 600 008,Phone: 044- 28521970, 044-28524589

**NOTICE INVITING TENDER** (For publishing in the Website) **Tender Reference No.I-2/TASHO/2665/2026-27**

Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Ltd (TASMAC) invites online tenders/bids in two cover system (Cover I-Technical bid and Cover II-Financial Bid) Tender for Fire(Declaration) Policy, Burglary, Money in Transit, Money in Safe and Fidelity Guarantee Insurance Policy for the period from **01.11.2026 to 31.10.2027.** The filled in tender documents shall be uploaded in the website:**https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app**.

| Office of issue | Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation Limited, Corporate Office, Egmore, Chennai-600008. | |
|---|---|---|
| Date and Time of Issue/Publishing | 10-10-2026 | 09:00 A.M. |
| Document download start date and time | 10.10.2026 | 09:00 A.M. |
| Seek Clarification start date | 12.10.2026 | 11.00 A.M. |
| Seek Clarification end date | 14.10.2026 | 17.00 P.M. |
| Bid submission start date and time | 16.10.2026 | 10:00 A.M. |
| Bid submission last date and time | 26.10.2026 | 09:00 A.M. |
| Date and time of opening of Technical bid | 26.10.2026 | 10:00 A.M. |
| Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) | Nil | |
| Bid validity | The Bid remain valid for a period of not less than 120 days from the last date of submission of the bid. | |
| Place of opening of technical bid | TASMAC, Corporate Office, Egmore, Chennai-8. | |

1. The tender document can be downloaded from the portal /nicgep/app. 2.Tenderers are advised to follow the instructions provided in the Tender document for the e-submission of the bids through online e-procurement system of Government of Tamil Nadu website. **https://tntenders.gov.in.**

**Note:** If any of the dates mentioned above is declared as Government Holiday or unplanned shutdown by the State, the due date will be postponed to the next working day at the same scheduled time. To enable TASMAC to meet the target dates, bidders are expected to respond promptly to any clarifications requested during the evaluation process. TASMAC will adhere to the above schedule to the best of its ability, but reserves the right to modify it. Notification of any changes will be provided to all bidders.

DIPR/3092/TENDER/2026

**Managing Director**

**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA**
**HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT**
**Lokaseva Bhavan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001**
**Phone: 0674-2954600 | Website: https://dhe.odisha.gov.in | Mail: rusa.odisha@gmail.com**

**CORRIGENDUM - II**

Higher Education Department, invites sealed tenders from eligible bidders for the following work :

| Name of the Work | Tender No. & Date |
|---|---|
| **Selection of a Consulting firm/ entity for establishment of State Technical Support Group (STSG) for supporting implementation of Pradhan Mantri Uchchatar Shiksha Abhiyan (PM-USHA) in Higher Education Department, Government of Odisha.** | **PM-USHA : 05/2026 dated 17.09.2026** |

The complete set of Corrigendum-II documents are available at **https://dhe.odisha.gov.in.**

Last date for receiving of bids : **26.10.2026 up to 5:30 PM**
Opening of technical bids : **28.10.2026 at 3:30 PM**

**Sd/-**
**Joint Secretary-cum-SPD (PM-USHA)**

11001/367/2627

OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0072

**METROPOLITAN TRANSPORT CORPORATION (CHENNAI) LIMITED**
**PALLAVAN ILLAM, ANNA SALAI, CHENNAI - 600 002.**

**TENDER NOTICE**

On behalf of Metropolitan Transport Corporation (Chennai) Limited, tenders are invited for issuing licence for Display of advertisement on exterior left, right side of bus body & rear panel on designated area only.(Except Passenger View Glass, Front Wind screen Glass and Rear Wind screen Glass), in MTC buses from the eligible tenderers who shall submit the documentary evidence as indicated below:

| Sl. No. | Issuance of Licence for | EMD Amount in Rs. | Eligibility Criteria |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Display of Advertisement on Exterior left & right side of the Bus body and rear panel on designated area only (except passenger view glass, front & Rear wind screen glass, windows, Front body) (Except Foot board and Foot board door glass) (Except Small bus, New Low Floor Bus(ULE) & Electric Bus) in 1000 Buses - **Adyar, Adambakkam, Ayanavaram, Anna Nagar (East), Ambattur, Basin Bridge, K K Nagar, Kilambakkam, Padiyanallur, Poonamallee, Semmanchery & Tambaram** | **11,00,000** | Registered establishment and the registered company must possess at least five years of experience in providing advertising services in State Transport corporations |
| 2. | Display of Advertisement on Exterior left & right side of the Bus body and rear panel on designated area only (except passenger view glass, front & Rear wind screen glass, windows, Front body) (Except Foot board and Foot board door glass) (Except Small bus, New Low Floor Bus (ULE) & Electric Bus) in 875 Buses – **Anna Nagar, Avadi, Chrompet-1, Ennore, Iyyappanthangal, Kundrathur, Kannagi Nagar, Mandaveli, Saidapet & T. Nagar.** | **9,50,000** | |

The Tender document and EMD details are available at Government e-procurement portal **https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.** Bidders are requested to upload their tender documents through the above portal only.

Tender submission start date : **10.10.2026 at 11.00 Hrs.**
Tender submission end date : **16.11.2026 upto 15.00 Hrs.**
Tender will be opened on : **17.11.2026 at 15.30 Hrs.**

Any modification (if any) in tender terms and tender invitation period will be uploaded in the website and the tenderers are requested to go through the above website periodically.

MTC (Chennai) Ltd. reserves the right to accept / reject any tender without assigning any reason thereof.

DIPR/3091/TENDER/2026

**MANAGING DIRECTOR**

Govt. of Uttarakhand

# Devbhoomi Uttarakhand

## Sewa | Sushasan | Samarpan

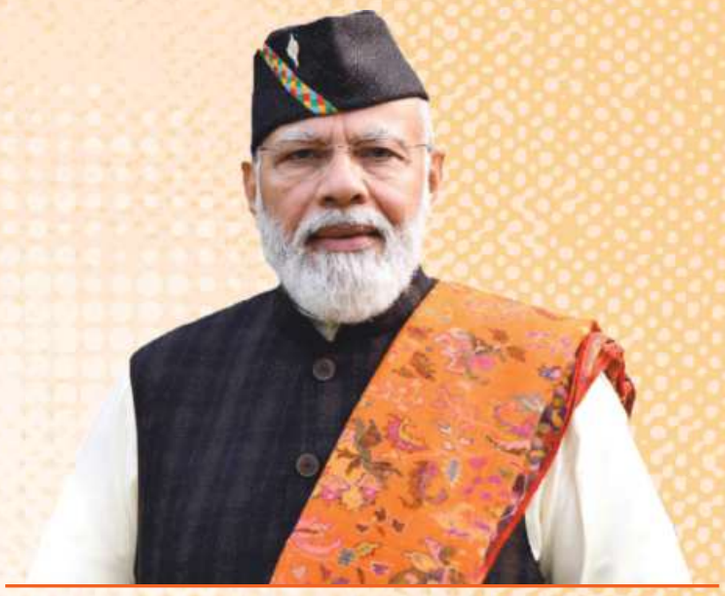
### Jan-Jan ki Sarkar, Jan-Jan Ke Dwar

"The energy, innovation, and talent of our youth are the greatest forces driving the creation of a developed India. The State Government is fully committed to securing the future of young people and providing them with opportunities to grow and progress."

**Pushkar Singh Dhami**
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand

# Youth Empowerment

**New Opportunities, New Dreams, A New Uttarakhand**



"The construction of a developed India in the 21st century rests on two main pillars: first, pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both these pillars. This decade is the decade of Uttarakhand."

**Narendra Modi**
Prime Minister

## Dedicated to Youth Empowerment and a Brighter Future

- A strict anti-cheating law has been implemented in the state. With greater transparency in the recruitment process, talented youth are now being selected for positions across multiple departments. Over the past five years, more than 34,000 youth have secured government jobs.
- The number of people employed under MSMEs increased to 456,605 in 2025, up from 343,922 in 2022.
- The State Government launched the CM Skill Upgradation & Global Employment Scheme. Its budget was increased from ₹75 lakh to ₹3.3 crore. So far, 147 young people have received foreign-language training, and 92 have secured employment in different countries.
- Uttarakhand became the first state in the country to implement the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020.
- The Chief Minister's Higher Education Promotion Scholarship Scheme was launched to support students in higher education.
- The National Games were hosted in Uttarakhand for the first time. At the 38th National Games, Uttarakhand athletes won a record 103 medals.
- Under the new Sports Policy, a historic decision has been taken to provide government employment to national & international-level medal winners.
- The daily diet allowance for state athletes has been increased from ₹250 to ₹480 per athlete per day, on the lines of the Sports Authority of India (SAI).
- Under the Uttarakhand Film Policy, scholarships are being provided to youth who graduate from FTII. Based on course expenditure, 75% scholarship is provided to ST, SC and OBC candidates and 50% to General category candidates.
- Under the Chief Minister's Emerging Players Upgradation Scheme, around 3,900 promising athletes aged 8–14 years across the state are being provided a sports scholarship of ₹1,500 per month.
- Athletes who win medals or participate in national and international competitions such as the Olympics, Asian Games and Commonwealth Games will benefit from a 4% sports quota in government services.

## Empowered Youth, Stronger Uttarakhand

*Vikas bhi, Virasat bhi*

**Issued in Public interest by Department of Information & Public Relations, Uttarakhand, Dehradun**

www.uttarainformation.gov.in | DIPR_UK | UttarakhandDIPR | UttarakhandDIPR

## Delivery completed

### With the latest reforms, GST might finally become a 'good and simple tax'

The decisions taken by the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council in its 57th meeting on Thursday reveal two distinct changes in the attitude of the tax administration: increased trust in the taxpayer, and reduced anxiety over tax revenues. This is a big change from the system in place so far, where taxpayers have been bogged down by compliance requirements, and the tax enforcement has used this complexity to try to extract every rupee it can. The data show gross collections have not often deviated significantly from the mean over the last two years. After nine years, taxpayers have also become familiar, if not comfortable, with the tax filing system. The previous meeting also rectified most rate-related issues in GST and even reduced the number of slabs, a major driver of the complexity of the tax system. The time was ripe for a significant overhaul of the processes and administration of GST, and the Council has delivered. Thursday's reforms address complications in the entire chain of GST paperwork, from registration and return filing, to refunds and litigation. The thrust is to reduce human discretion in these processes by automating registrations, reducing the number of times small businesses have to file returns, handling refunds through computer-based verification, and significantly reducing the powers of GST officers. In essence, trust the taxpayer to comply, and crack down only when non-compliance is demonstrable. That is the way it should be, instead of a 'guilty until proven innocent' approach.

While all the simplification measures are welcome, some specific ones deserve special mention as they will substantially ease areas of major discontent. So far, taxpayers were denied input tax credits (ITC) until their suppliers had filed their returns. This meant that thousands of genuine businesses that had received supplies and paid taxes on them were denied ITC, leading to a drying up of crucial working capital. The GST Council has tasked a committee to find a solution that can be implemented by April 1. Removing the arrest powers of GST officers is another step that will significantly reduce harassment, as will tightening the rules around inspection, searches, and seizures of consignments. The Centre has also used this opportunity to introduce a faceless assessment system for Central GST registered companies, along the lines of the popular faceless system in income tax. The decision to review rates only once a year, and implement rate changes only at the start of financial years, removes significant uncertainty that usually arises each time the Council meets. In its 10th year, GST is finally starting to look like what it should have at the time of rollout.

## Beyond forms

### The Nobel for Anne Carson celebrates experimentation and imagination

Every year, before the announcement of the Nobel Prize in Literature, there is strong speculation among literary critics about the possible contenders. The Swedish Academy, which keeps its nominations secret for 50 years, has often sprung surprises. But this year, it has chosen a bookmaker's favourite in Anne Carson, the 76-year-old Canadian poet, essayist, translator, and dramatist. It has also kept in tune with its decade-old trend of recognising women writers every two or three years – Carson is the 19th woman among the 123 Nobel laureates in literature. The Academy praised her "bold and inventive oeuvre that, in playful dialogue with the classical tradition, has created new forms for contemporary literature". Known for continually dismantling the boundaries between poetry, prose, and scholarship, Carson seamlessly brings the classical in conversation with the contemporary and personal, often through strange juxtapositions. She has also frequently collaborated with theatre directors, choreographers, and visual artists, expanding our understanding of what constitutes literature.

A scholar of classics and ancient Greek, Carson's works explore love, desire, mysticism, antiquity, and despair. Her first book, *Eros the Bittersweet* (1986), a reworked version of her PhD thesis on Sappho, examines the pleasure and pain of desire through the Greek idea of lack. *Short Talks* (1992) is a series of brief, lyric prose poems, each approaching its subject through fragments and shifts in voice. In *Autobiography of Red* (1998), perhaps her best-known work, she reimagines the ancient Greek myth of Geryon and Heracles as a queer coming-of-age story, combining poetry and prose. *The Beauty of the Husband* (2001), a semi-autobiographical work of narrative verse about the painful disintegration of a marriage, borrows its imagery from tango while opening its sections with lines from John Keats; she became the first woman to win the T.S. Eliot Prize for it. Her later works – *Nox* (2010), which is at once a book, an elegy, and an art object; *Red Doc* (2013), a sequel to *Autobiography of Red*; and *Float* (2016), which takes the form of 22 chapbooks housed in an acetate case – all resist easy categorisation. The Prize is thus not just a recognition of an outstanding poet or classicist, but also a celebration of literary experimentation and a reminder of the limitless possibilities of human imagination and creativity at a time of AI slop. In an age of polarised debates, her writing never simplifies the complexities of human experience or forces them into neat conclusions. By reworking classical traditions in unexpected ways, she makes the ancient feel startlingly contemporary while retaining a sense of its historical specificity. The Academy has chosen a writer who belongs in no category in particular, and everywhere at once.

# BRICS in a fragmented world order, a test of relevance

**M.K. Narayanan**

A former Director, Intelligence Bureau, a former National Security Adviser, and a former Governor of West Bengal

The 18th BRICS Summit, held in New Delhi on September 12-13, 2026, was an extravaganza of sorts. The summit's New Delhi Declaration has been widely hailed as a major achievement for reconciling the divergent views of the 11-member grouping. Its unanimous adoption is again a major achievement in a world often works at cross purposes.

Achieving this consensus under India's chairmanship, is an excellent example, at one level, of India's standing within BRICS and its importance in the councils of the world

The Declaration covered matters such as reform of global governance, trade, finance, energy, climate, technology, health and agriculture. The decisions taken were unanimous, involving aspects such as mutual respect, sovereignty, equality, openness and consensus. It proposed that the BRICS group should work towards local currency trade and inter-operable cross-border payment systems, extend support for the BRICS Economic Partnership Strategy 2030; a Global Value Chain Action Plan for 2026-2030; seek a more representative United Nations (UN) and international financial system with greater regard given to developing countries, and supporting de-escalation in West Asia as also humanitarian access in Gaza.

**The message, the approach**

The political message conveyed was that global institutions no longer adequately reflected contemporary economic and demographic reality. This underlined the need for a stronger voice for emerging markets and developing economies. This in turn called for a broader effort to promote multi-polarity, reform of the Bretton Woods institutions, underline preference for dialogue, diplomacy and political solutions, and on trade, defend the World Trade Organization (WTO) and the rules-based multilateral trading system, including a two-tier WTO disputes settlement mechanism. It supported the Palestine people's rights to determination as well as a just and lasting settlement based on international law.

The Summit contained a detailed reference to Artificial Intelligence (AI), acknowledging its potential to stimulate economic growth, improve public services and accelerate sustainable development. The Declaration supported international cooperation on AI governance, including wider access to computing resources, research, skill and innovation. Over all, the Declaration appeared to adopt a pragmatic approach to issues concerning energy, health, climate and food security.

In his inaugural address, Prime Minister Narendra Modi urged BRICS leaders to draw up 10 global governance reform proposals, adding that the message from the BRICS Summit should be that 'if our future is shared, then the right to shape the future must also be assured'.

Despite diplomatic consensus at the New Delhi summit, BRICS faces internal tensions and imbalances

Among the many comments on the New Delhi Declaration, the broad consensus was that it was in keeping with India's policy of strategic autonomy, multi-alignment, and multi-vector engagement. The optics were excellent. The presence of Chinese President Xi Jinping and Russian President Vladimir Putin lent gravitas to the proceedings, and the fact that the United Arab Emirates and Iran participated without indulging in mutual recriminations was also significant. All this seemed to suggest that BRICS is beginning to make some progress on matters of substance, rather than merely being a diplomatic spectacle. Among other highlights was the atmosphere of bonhomie that seemed to prevail and, at the very least, appeared to reflect an Indian approach to BRICS, *viz.*, cooperation and consensus and for consultation and discussion on dispute settlement.

**What a more sober assessment shows**

Notwithstanding all this, it is important to acknowledge that this is the age of 'variable geometry' and not of 'deep seated' alliances. Given the state of the world, this is the grim reality of today. While, this BRICS Summit might seem to have 'bucked' this trend, a more sober and realistic assessment would seem to suggest that this is not the case. It may perhaps be too radical or drastic to cast BRICS as outdated; perhaps BRICS could possibly hope to become something in the nature of Europe's 'coalition of the willing' which has been contrived in the wake of the near demise of the North Atlantic Treaty Organization in Europe.

The fault may not lie entirely with the leaders of BRICS, for evidently no one could have predicted or anticipated the shifts and changes that have taken place in the international order since the first BRIC summit in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in 2009. *Ad hoc* cooperation rather than firm alliances is the order of the day at present, alongside pragmatic coalitions built around shared 'interests', rather than true values and intentions.

This is often justified as pragmatism that is often needed during difficult periods, wherein multilateralism is replaced by plurilateralism in different corners of the globe. To expect that BRICS would remain unaffected given the many iterations taking place across the globe, and amidst the virtual collapse of the international economic and political order, would hence, be too much to hope for.

Each of the demands made by the original BRICS countries – Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa – meanwhile remain unfulfilled to this day, including aspects such as reform of the International Monetary Fund, the World Bank, and the UN.

Also unfulfilled is the strengthening of cooperation among developing countries, to reduce dependence on western financial systems so as to create a more multipolar world.

Notwithstanding the creation of better opportunities for trade, BRICS has failed to become a well-integrated economic bloc that could stand up to the tyranny of the Bretton Woods Twins, let alone become a highly integrated economic bloc.

**The China factor**

Apart from its failure to promote multilateralism, or extend strong support to a more democratic and just multipolar world (combined with other weaknesses such as the failure to strengthen global South-South Cooperation), is another reality that cannot be ignored. In the nearly two decades since Yekaterinburg, China's economic preponderance has far eclipsed that of all other BRICS members, and has, in the process, achieved a political heft that is leading to a serious imbalance within the BRICS community.

The spectacle of United States President Donald Trump's kowtowing to Mr. Xi, during Mr. Xi's visit to Washington DC in September 2026, demonstrates that China can no longer be regarded as a member of the Global South, and hardly (any longer) championing many of the demands espoused by the BRICS nations such as the tyranny of the Big Powers. A fledgling economic power in 2009, China's heft threatens to derail the stance that BRICS has consistently held, *viz.*, that of opposing the hegemony of the West.

Tensions remain between China and India, which are the leading members of BRICS. While no serious conflict has taken place since 2020 (Galwan), thanks to diplomatic efforts at all levels, relations remain uneasy notwithstanding the present diplomatic calm. This in turn does affect the future trajectory of BRICS and how far it can succeed in achieving its objective.

Hence, notwithstanding the surface calm evident at the New Delhi Summit, the reality is that the ability of BRICS to act in unison in a world that is in disarray is strictly limited. As far as India is concerned, while it does not have to fear the so-called Thucydides Trap or be concerned about U.S. economist Charles Kindleberger's theories, it must face the reality that membership of BRICS hardly gives it any additional political or economic strength. The increasing imbalance in BRICS – in terms of political and economic strength and influence – perhaps contains the seeds of its irrelevance in the years ahead, notwithstanding the hopes expressed during the New Delhi Declaration.

# India's 'WorldSkills' medals reflect patient investment

**Jayant Chaudhary**

Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, and Minister of State for Education, Government of India

The *Bhagavad Gita*, in verse 18.46, says *sva-karmana tam abhyarchya siddhim vindati manavah* – a person attains perfection by worshipping through their own work. This implies that a workbench, a kitchen or a workshop floor can be a place of devotion, and a craft practised with care is a virtue in itself, not merely a means of livelihood. Prime Minister Narendra Modi recently met India's medal winners at the 48th WorldSkills Competition, which was held in Shanghai, China (September 2026). These champions included bakers, welders, dental technicians, car painters and retail professionals. Their achievements placed India among the world's top 10 for the first time. By welcoming them, the Prime Minister has nudged Indian families to look again at skilling, a path that deserves the same honour as any other.

**Skilled talent on world stage**

Held every two years, WorldSkills is the Olympics of skills. More than 1,400 young people from about 70 countries and regions complete practical tasks, set and judged by international experts, in trades from welding and wiring to robotics and cyber security. Indian families know the podiums of education well – toppers' lists, merit ranks and classroom gold medals. Skilling has had no such place in Indian public life. These winners are changing that. As their numbers grow, more families will recognise that skill-based careers are no less worthy and that a podium earned at the workbench stands as tall as one earned in the examination hall.

India's WorldSkills story began in a humble way and has climbed steadily. India was placed 39th in 2011 and 19th in 2017. It reached the 13th spot in 2019 and held that place in 2024, with the best results being four bronze medals. In Shanghai, India finished 10th, with six silver medals and 20 medals for excellence – 26 medals in all, and its largest haul ever. This came from India's largest team of 70 competitors across 63 skills. Not only has the medal tally grown, but India's best medals have also moved from bronze to silver.

'Skill-Ex' is the investment in the people behind India's medal-winning performance at the 48th WorldSkills Competition in Shanghai, China

India competed in 11 skills for the first time, winning three of its six silver medals in these categories: Mohammed Salam in dental prosthetics, Kovid Gangrade in digital interactive media design and Saniya Joshi in retail sales. Smriti Nambiar bagged silver in bakery, alongside Parth Vohra in industrial design technology and Mehrunissa Begum in logistics and freight forwarding.

**Humble beginnings to excellence**

Behind these numbers are young people whose journeys began in very ordinary places. Kaif Khan of Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, learnt his craft while working in a private car company's workshop after class 10. He won gold in the State, regional and national rounds of IndiaSkills, trained with Maruti Suzuki and Axalta, and gained exposure in Germany and Denmark, before he earned a Medallion for Excellence in Car Painting in Shanghai. From the south, Mohammed Salam of Cuddalore, Tamil Nadu, won silver in dental prosthetics, a discipline judged on how precisely a crown or bridge fits, and one in which India had never competed before. All they needed was a fair test, comprehensive training, and an ecosystem that considered their skill seriously.

Kaif Khan, Mohammed Salam, Saniya Joshi, Smriti Nambiar and their teammates did not reach Shanghai by chance. They are the fruits of a patient investment in people. Medallions for Excellence also went to Md. Seraj in automobile technology, Pavan Bhadravati Suresha in additive manufacturing, Mallinath and Suhan Mascarenhas in Industry 4.0, and Abhishek Somanna Shignalli and Vinay Muttayya Hiremath in robot systems integration.

All of them climbed a ladder that begins in the districts and rises through State and regional rounds to the national finals. More than 3.65 lakh young people registered for IndiaSkills across 63 skills in this cycle. Five regional competitions narrowed the field to about 650 national finalists in Greater Noida (Uttar Pradesh), where 70 were chosen to represent India. A team from the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, the National Skill Development Corporation and the States, working with industry experts, has toiled to find, hone and polish these young people for the international stage. This is the whole-of-government approach at work, and marks a deeper shift.

Nations have long measured progress in Capex, the roads, ports and factories they build, and in Opex, the cost of keeping them running. India has built on both, and now adds a third discipline, Skill-Ex – deliberate investment in the people who make every asset work. The recent Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU) scheme is Skill-Ex at scale. This ₹60,000 crore scheme is upgrading 1,000 government Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs) as 200 hubs and 800 spokes, with industry partners managing the clusters.

**There must be a focus on 'Skill-Ex'**

Industry must join this effort. A factory is only as good as the people who run it, and employers should spend on Skill-Ex as seriously as they spend on Capex and Opex. Capex gives India its assets, and Opex keeps them running; only Skill-Ex develops the manpower to keep assets productive. A nation is built not only by those who design and govern, but also by those who weld, bake, paint and wire with care. That care is a virtue, and the *Gita* reminds us that it is also a form of worship. If we value skilling as much as degrees, India's young people will only ask how well they can walk their path, and India's next generation will make India the skilling capital of the world.

## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

**Safeguarding the voter**

Rectifications, revisions and reforms are a *sine qua non* for every dynamic society. But in making such revisions, the sovereignty of the nation must take precedence over the interests of the ruling regime. The quintessence of democracy lies in listening to and giving voice to every eligible citizen. It was with this aim that the *Magna Carta* was sealed at Runnymede in 1215. "*Vox populi, vox Dei*" — I heard this in my childhood. Today, I understand how the meanings of *populi* and *Dei* have shrunk to refer to partisan voters and political rulers. Moreover, exclusionary exercises can never lead to cohesive societies; inclusive ones can. When lakhs of eligible voters risk being arbitrarily denied their right to vote, amid concerns about possible wrongful exclusions and alleged *mala fide* actions, a miscarriage of justice calls for urgent corrective measures (Editorial page, October 9). The entire Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise should be halted until these concerns are adequately addressed. The nation's anxieties must be allayed through cordial and focused debates. Developing a framework is our task. Caution is the watchword.

**Rakesh Mohan Sharma,**
Pathankot, Punjab

**Jeffrey Archer**

Jeffrey Archer's human drama reminds us what narrative truly demands: pulse, grit, and visceral friction. His handwritten drafts and lived tensions demonstrate that polished algorithms can never duplicate the raw, erratic heartbeat of genuine craft.

**Harsh Pawaria,**
Rohtak, Haryana

**A destination for talent**

The reported suspension of green-card filings in the U.S. is a reminder that professional success abroad does not always guarantee long-term security. Skilled workers deserve clear rules and predictable processes. India, meanwhile, must strengthen its research institutions, workplaces and career opportunities so that returning home becomes a genuine choice, not a reluctant last resort.

**K.R. Gagan,**
Tumkuru, Karnataka

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The protest site in Pune. EMMANUAL YOGINI

# The long wait for a government job

In Pune, hundreds of students are protesting leaked exam papers that qualify people for State government service jobs. In public, they demand accountability, a transparent process, and fixed dates for exams; in private, they fear police notices that could jeopardise their chances at future interviews. At the protest site, **Chinmay Gaikwad** speaks to students, who wonder how they will build a future in uncertainty and economic hardships

At 2 p.m., the protest site in Pune is close to empty. An hour later, around 200 people gather, many grouped under trees flanking Pune's S.M. Bridge. The crowd comes with the evening, as does a breeze. With the ebb of the day's studying, women and men in their 20s begin to arrive. By night, Rushikesh Dhode, 25, estimates that between 500 and 700 students have gathered on the bridge over the Mutha river.

Students sit and stand on one half of the bridge, facing a stage, where seven people are on hunger strike. Many of the women don't want to be photographed or quoted. "Our families do not know we are here," says one, asking not to be named.

Two or three people say plainly: if a photograph is published, and they go on to clear the Maharashtra Public Service Commission (MPSC) entrance exams and reach the interview stage, an officer on the panel might recognise their face from a protest. That would be "very, very problematic," says a man.

Aspirants to the MPSC-conducted entrance exams, which are a gateway to government jobs, are here to protest against corruption in the recruitment process. They began protesting on October 1. "We are demanding the resignation of the MPSC chairman (Vivek Bhimanwar) on moral grounds, just as Nipo Nabam in Arunachal Pradesh had given his resignation on moral grounds," says Akshay Kamble, one of the protest organisers. He speaks of the chairman of the Arunachal Pradesh Public Service Commission who had resigned after a paper leak in the State in 2022. Kamble is one of the 15 organisers against whom the Pune Police has filed first information reports citing laws related to unlawful assembly and being a public nuisance.

The protesters also demand that 70,000 vacancies be filled, and that Maharashtra adopt a system like Rajasthan, which allows applicants to take four exams for ₹100.

Every year, MPSC conducts exams for jobs in various departments and different levels in the Maharashtra government. In 2026 alone, three exam papers have been leaked: two for 5,707 Group C posts (clerk, peon, havildars in the Home Guard or Maharashtra Police) and 109 medical drug inspector posts (Group B). In the Group B exam, all three levels of exams had been taken and the results declared, when students came to know of the paper leak.

Across the world, student protests are on the rise: in France, students are voicing dissent against failing school systems; in Argentina, students are demanding a reversal of funding cuts to public universities; in Chile, students and teachers are marching against education budget cuts.

In India, protests in June and July took place against paper leaks, demanding Education Minister, Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation, which took place. This was followed by school children across the country, predominantly in Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh, and Rajasthan, demanding better schools. In Maharashtra, this August, students from Scheduled Tribes asked for humane hostels.

> I am a single mother's child, and I feel we will be financially stable only when I get a government job. Whatever the salary, at least it will be regular
>
> **RUSHIKESH DHODE**
> STUDENT

### The arithmetic of a shared room

"Fifty study centres got notices from the police via (social media platform) Telegram, telling them to ask students not to take part in the protest. They said this is now anti-social activity, as permission for the protests had only been obtained for three days," says Vivekananda Patil, one of the students at the protest.

Once darkness descends, people let their guard down. Where protests around the country have seen sloganeering and tongue-in-cheek commentary, here, life is a ledger of accounts: of rent and mess fees, of years spent studying for the exam, of what a family can, but more importantly, cannot afford. The anger on the street, they say, had two sources: a leaked paper and a calendar that shifts each time there is a paper leak. This shifting calendar of exams means more money must be spent.

Drought, say students, has thinned incomes in the villages that send them to Pune. It has raised the price of a plate of food in the cluttered lanes where they live. The protest sits where governance, politics, and household economics meet.

Amol, 24, is from Akola in Vidarbha. He came to Pune in 2022 and has since lived the way many aspirants here do: three to a room, on a budget that has to be redrawn every few months. When he arrived, he needed ₹8,000 to ₹9,000 a month for all his expenses. Now, he says, with inflation it is ₹11,000 to ₹12,000.

His mess fee has risen from about ₹2,800 to about ₹3,200. "I study for MPSC full-time. I don't have a part-time job," he says, which means that money has to come from home. Home is a railway family. His father, once a porter, was made permanent in the railways in 2011 and now works as a trackman (in the Group D employment category). Amol is the last of five children, with four older sisters, all married.

In his first year he took classes from a teacher who charged him ₹50,000 for that year. Now, he studies on his own, primarily because it's just too much money to spend, but also because he understands the pattern now. He got a degree through an online course, studying for the MPSC exam side by side, but wasn't able to pass it. Now he says, *"Mala kamit kami ek post kadhaychi aahe, angavar khaki vardi hech they dheyya aahe* (I want to get at least one post, but my ultimate goal is to wear the uniform)." Amol avoids using his surname so he is not easily identified. He says this has been his dream since he was a young child.

Many aspirants treat jobs such as havaldars as stepping stones to officer-level posts. Anyone with a degree can sit for the examination, but for many, entering technical universities was not an option, because they could not pay for the science stream at the junior-college level. Maharashtra's schooling system takes students from class 10 to junior college for two years, before they enter their degree courses. These are the students who flock to Pune to study.

### Night shifts and a library floor

Dhode's story begins with less. He lost his father when he was in the fifth standard. His mother, a farmer, raised him alone, and he worked beside her on the farm. He says he did the rest of his schooling on his own. He was eligible to sit for the MPSC examination in the final year of his degree, and decided to come to Pune in 2022. He brought with him savings of ₹80,000 and moved into a one-room-kitchen flat with five other students. Six students, one room, one kitchen.

The savings lasted two years. After that, he had nothing in hand. He stopped taking classes for the MPSC and began working nights at a clothing store, cleaning and organising stock for ₹4,000 a month. At night he stays in a library, cleaning it in exchange for shelter. "I am a single mother's child, and I feel we will be financially stable only when I get a government job. Whatever the salary, at least it will be regular," he says, also hinting at a rise in social status in his village.

His mother owns 3 acres of land in Maharashtra's Latur district, where she sows soybean every kharif season. This year, with the drought across the State, he does not expect much. "I expect only about half the usual harvest," he says.

Vaishnavi Jadhav, a farmer's daughter from Marathwada, came to Pune in 2024 and has been preparing for the MPSC since. She was among those who spoke on stage at the protest. "While preparing for the exam, the paper was leaked," she says. "Marathwada is in trouble," she says, contextualising her worry. "A transparent examination is the one route by which ordinary people like us can enter the administration. If the process is flawed at the start, how will we get selected?" She worries about her future and India's future.

"We are a country of youth," she says. "If we have to protest like this, when will we study?" She appeals to the government to treat students as a responsibility, not a liability. "Whatever work you do, do it for the students," she hopes, from them.

Pune Police Commissioner Amitesh Kumar says all the students' demands had been met, yet they continued with their protest. "In their letter dated September 24, the students had put forth four main demands. We facilitated a meeting with the Chief Minister on September 30, and all the demands submitted to us were fully met. The students gave us a letter saying their planned agitation on October 2 stood postponed. Suddenly, on October 1, a crowd gathered and began marching to S.M. Joshi, where they started an agitation." He says the police issued a letter informing the students that the agitation was illegal, but they chose to ignore the instructions.

The matter subsequently went to the High Court. Kumar says the students' advocate had told the Court that they would seek an alternative venue that would not cause traffic congestion and that the agitation would remain within the legal framework. The police subsequently rejected their application to hold the protest at S.M. Joshi and suggested two alternative locations. "In complete disregard of these lawful instructions, they have continued with the agitation," he says. "We did not want to set the law in motion, but a week has passed and we had to. We have noticed multiple violations," he says, adding that some people were inciting the students to continue their protest.

### Politics at play

Abhijeet Dipke, founder and convener of the Cockroach Janta Party, extended his support to the agitating MPSC aspirants in Pune, demanding the removal of the State recruiting body's chairman and asking for comprehensive reforms for fair examinations, while urging students to remain firm.

Accusing Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis of "pretending to be deaf" to their demands, Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut alleged that the government is attempting to create a division among the protesters instead of holding a dialogue with their representatives. Initially three factions emerged in the protest. Each had slightly different demands, but it is predominantly a single faction on ground now. He warned that the agitation could intensify and spread across Maharashtra, making it difficult for the Chief Minister to leave his official residence.

Chief Minister Fadnavis has proposed to Governor Jishnu Dev Varma that a committee headed by a retired High Court judge be set up to examine the conduct of former and incumbent chairpersons and members of the MPSC.

Rohit Pawar, an MLA from the NCP (Sharadchandra Pawar), who is part of the Opposition, and with the students, says "Mr. Bhimanwar was a friend of Mr. Devendra Fadnavis from college... He was directly promoted as IAS officer on the recommendation of Devendra Fadnavis." He implies that this is a conflict of interest. He also alleges that when Bhimanwar was transport commissioner, corruption charges against him were to the tune of ₹2,200 crore. "We are asking for the government not to keep the person on this post when the investigation is on."

Students protest against MPSC Chairman Vivek Bhimanwar in Pune. EMMANUAL YOGINI

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## From Page One

### Delhi turns a fortress ahead of protest

Joint Commissioner of Police (New Delhi Range) Nupur Prasad said the organisers had failed to comply with undertakings given during a previous protest. "Because of not following the conditions as part of undertaking during the past protest, this time, the permission has been denied," she said.

Police officials also noted that the request for permission had been submitted at short notice. According to them, CJP leaders informed the Delhi Police about the proposed demonstration through a letter on October 7, seeking arrangements for law and order and traffic management. However, applications for such events are ordinarily expected to be made at least 10 days in advance, the officials said.

Several members of civil society and political workers in Delhi, Madhya Pradesh, Goa, Andhra Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh claimed they were visited by the police and asked not to participate in the protest. A Delhi resident was allegedly physically stopped from leaving his residence. In Uttar Pradesh's Bijnor, police camped at the residence of Students Federation of India (SFI) leader Abhishek.

According to police officials, a district-wise security strategy has been drawn up to prevent protesters from reaching central Delhi. Dedicated detention centres have been established in all 15 police districts, while over 30 blocking points have been identified across the New Delhi district.

The strategy marks a departure from previous deployments, where personnel from multiple districts were concentrated at a few locations. This time, authorities plan to intercept protesters within their respective jurisdictions before they converge on central Delhi.

The Delhi Police have also requested the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) to shut 57 Metro stations from 9 p.m. on Friday until Saturday.

### Blanket transit ban in Delhi 'over-reaching': SC

In fact, the court even suggested that the government ought to find an open, spacious site for protesters to "peacefully and lawfully" protest in the capital. The protest is expected to happen at Jantar Mantar, the designated site for voicing dissent in the national capital. However, the court remarked that central Delhi was usually cramped with no washroom, medical and drinking water facilities. The government found the court's proposal for an alternative protest site welcome, and promptly agreed to take a decision.

The hearing began with an impromptu oral mentioning by senior lawyers before the Bench. They urged the court to step in, saying the capital has been "heavily barricaded", making free movement virtually impossible.

A writ petition filed by Communist Party of India (Marxist) general secretary M.A. Baby said express trains to Delhi, from as far away as Keralam, were cancelled on Friday from 2 p.m. onwards. Travellers to Delhi have reportedly been intercepted and detained in several States. Activists were released only on the condition that they would not leave their city of residence.

The lawyers said the coordinated, pre-emptive and indefinite prohibitions by the capital's police force, controlled by the Home Ministry, have caused grave hardships to commuters, patients, students, workers, litigants and travellers who have no connection whatsoever with the protest.

"You can't shut down an entire city because you cannot handle a bunch of protesters," senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan submitted. Senior advocates Nitya Ramakrishnan, Sanjay Hegde, Prashant Bhushan, and Subhash Chandran pointed out that 57 Metro stations across Delhi have been shut down.

Justice Bagchi stressed that freedom of association was indeed a fundamental right, but it had to be verified whether permission for the protest had been obtained. The judge said that if not, the protest may prove to be illegal.

Mr. Sankaranarayanan said peaceful protests, even without permission, were not illegal unless an offence was committed during the protest. Senior advocate Kapil Sibal said forcible, coercive and restrictive measures cannot be put in place by the state even before anything illegal has been done.

### BJP wins bypolls in West Bengal, Assam

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma posted videos of celebrations even before the formal declaration of results in Nagaon. All India United Democratic Front leader and former MP Mohammed Badruddin Ajmal finished second in Nagaon, while Congress candidate Sivamoni Bora came a distant third.

In Nagaon, the bypoll was called after Pradyut Bordoloi, who won the seat in 2024 on Congress ticket, quit the party and joined the BJP. In Nandigram, the bypoll was necessitated by the resignation of Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, who won two seats in the last Assembly election. He had defeated former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee from Bhabanipur and decided to retain the seat. In that election, Aam Janata Unnayan Party leader and former Minister Humayun Kabir won Rejinagar and Nowda seats. He retained Nowda, necessitating a bypoll in Rejinagar.

# Govt. slams J.D. Vance over his 'indentured servants' remark

Ministry reminds Trump administration that U.S. is 'shaped by generations of immigrants', following Vance's comment on IT professionals; economic ties between the two countries may see more strain

**Suhasini Haidar**
NEW DELHI

> Such descriptions are unwarranted and ignore the fact that Indian professionals in the United States are highly educated and skilled contributors to its economy and innovation ecosystem
>
> MINISTRY OF EXTERNAL AFFAIRS

The Ministry of External Affairs on Friday slammed as "unwarranted" and "deeply offensive" U.S. Vice President J.D. Vance's comments in which he called foreign workers, including Indian IT professionals, "indentured servants".

Hitting out at the U.S. government for its decision to suspend "labour certifications" from several Indian technology firms based in America, the Ministry said the steps would not "advance the shared ambitions of both countries", indicating further trouble in the already difficult economic relationship between the two countries.

On Thursday, Mr. Vance and U.S. Labour Secretary Keith Sonderling announced the suspension of the Permanent Labour Certification (PERM) programme for eight IT outsourcing giants, including five Indian IT multinationals operating in the U.S., and accused them of visa fraud. The list included Infosys, Tata Consultancy Services, Wipro, Cognizant, and HCL from India, often called the Big 5, as well as Capgemini, Microsoft, and Adobe.

"Such descriptions are unwarranted and ignore the fact that Indian professionals in the United States are highly educated and skilled contributors to its economy and innovation ecosystem," the Ministry said in a strongly worded statement that reminded the Trump administration that the U.S. had been "shaped by generations of immigrants."

"Resorting to terminology that carries painful historical and colonial legacy connotations is deeply offensive," the Ministry added, pointing to the use of indentured labour by American and European colonial settlers in the 19th century, including in the U.S. and nearby islands to work on their farms.

**'Pernicious system'**

The PERM programme allows companies to certify professionals who are not U.S. citizens for essential skills, qualifying them to be sponsored for a Green Card of Permanent Residency status in the country. The U.S. government said this process benefitted more than 2,30,000 H1B visa approvals and 1,00,000 permanent residencies since 2009, claiming that the eight companies had brought in hundreds of thousands of foreign workers at lower wages through a "pernicious system" that "defrauded the American worker". About 70% of all H1B visa holders are Indian.

"You [the Companies] bring in indentured servants from outside the country. You lay off American workers. And if you're a corporation, you make a ton of money by undercutting the wages of American workers, replacing them with people who frankly shouldn't be in the United States of America to begin with," Mr. Vance said.

The PERM programme enables a company to sponsor a foreign employee for permanent residence in the U.S., and it must prove to the Labour Department that it tried and failed to find a comparatively qualified American for the job.

Mr. Vance's announcement came when economic ties between India and the U.S. were under strain over the lack of progress in the Free Trade Agreement talks, despite months of negotiations in Delhi and Washington and calls between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and U.S. President Donald Trump.

# Appeals for return to voter list should be heard first: SC

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday orally suggested that lakhs of voters seeking inclusion in the West Bengal electoral roll deserved to be heard first, while appeals for exclusion pending before the Appellate Tribunals could be heard last.

An affidavit filed by the Election Commission of India (ECI) in the Supreme Court in September 2026 revealed that more than 22 lakh voters purged from the electoral roll during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) in West Bengal, on grounds such as "logical discrepancies", had filed appeals challenging their exclusion.

The EC affidavit had said that 16.10 lakh appeals had been filed against inclusion. The poll body had said a total of 38.31 lakh appeals were filed in the tribunals in the State.

The 19 Appellate Tribunals are struggling under a massive backlog, with 37.05 lakh of the 38.31 lakh appeals currently stuck in limbo. At the present pace, clearing the backlog will take more than 12 years, one of the petitioners, Congress leader Prasenjit Bose, has argued.

So far, the Appellate Tribunals, according to ECI statistics, have disposed of only 3% of the total appeals filed.

In an oral mentioning, senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for Mr. Bose, and advocates Prashant Bhushan and Neha Rathi, representing five disentitled voters, said these voters should be allowed to cast their vote in the Municipal elections scheduled for November 2026.

"We are already working on the issue of the pending appeals. We will find a via media [middle path] solution. There are appeals by persons seeking inclusion. They will be taken first," Chief Justice Surya Kant said orally.

# Congress attacks Modi govt. for 'promoting' monopolies

**Sandeep Phukan**
NEW DELHI

Targeting the Narendra Modi government for "promoting" monopolies, the Congress on Friday said India needs a level playing field where every business has a fair chance to compete.

Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, said the Congress was committed to breaking the chain of crony capitalism.

His remarks came a day after his exchange on X with U.S. billionaire Elon Musk, who asked whether Reliance Industries chairman Mukesh Ambani was the "real boss" of India.

Mr. Musk's comment came amid reports that his company, Starlink, was yet to receive the required security approvals to operate in India.

Responding to Mr. Musk's post on Thursday, Mr. Gandhi said: "Wait till you discover the other guy."

While the BJP criticised the Opposition leader for what appeared to be an endorsement of Mr. Musk's comments, Mr. Gandhi issued a fresh statement.

"The Congress party and I are committed to breaking this chain of crony capitalism and building an economy driven by innovation and hard work – not political patronage," Mr. Gandhi said in a Facebook post accompanying an earlier video. "I am not anti-business; I am anti-monopoly," he had said in the video.

**'Economic terrorism'**

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge accused the BJP of implementing "economic terrorism" .

"The objective of Modi ji's economic policy is to hand over control of the economy to his favoured capitalist cronies, so that, in return, the BJP maintains its share in the profits. By ending competition and imposing monopolies and duopolies, they have only worked to fill the BJP's coffers and have ruined the foundation of economic liberalisation," Mr. Kharge said. He alleged that the BJP government had weakened competition across sectors.

# BJP hits back at Musk's claims on spectrum allocation policy

**Devesh K. Pandey**
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Friday criticised SpaceX founder Elon Musk for his remarks on India's spectrum allocation policy, while taking a jibe at the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, over his exchange with Mr. Musk on X.

"What is more surprising is that Mr. Rahul Gandhi, who earlier always used to accuse us of surrendering before the American leadership, is now championing the cause of Mr. Musk," BJP national vice-president Ram Madhav told the media.

"What happened for him to become 'surrender' Gandhi. His own advisors, like Mr. Jairam Ramesh himself, had tweeted in the past that Elon Musk's Starlink can be a national security risk," he said.

**'Not a banana republic'**

"Elon Musk must remember that he is not dealing with a banana republic. He is dealing with a big country that is respected, whose leadership is respected globally. You should also be respectful towards this country and its leadership," he added.

Stating that India had a proper, non-discriminatory system in place to allocate spectrum, he said: "Who was he [Mr. Musk] seeking to ridicule as oligarchs? Mr. Musk was seeking to ridicule some of our business leaders as oligarchs. Even Jio and Airtel, along with Starlink, are also waiting. In a very non-discriminatory way, the Government of India will take its decision at an appropriate time."

"This is Modi government. Everything will happen in a transparent and non-discriminatory way," Mr. Madhav said.

In a post tagging Mr. Musk, BJP leader Rajeev Chandrasekhar said, "...it seems to me that the government has made it clear: all three satcom licensees are at broadly the same stage of ensuring security clearance by verifying its safety and trust first, then spectrum," adding that satellite IP services had several security implications.

# Live-streamed proceedings cannot be exploited: SC

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Friday stood firm by its decision to ban the unauthorised use and circulation of livestreamed judicial proceedings on social media and digital platforms, saying "anything meant for public good" cannot be "exploited" commercially for personal gain.

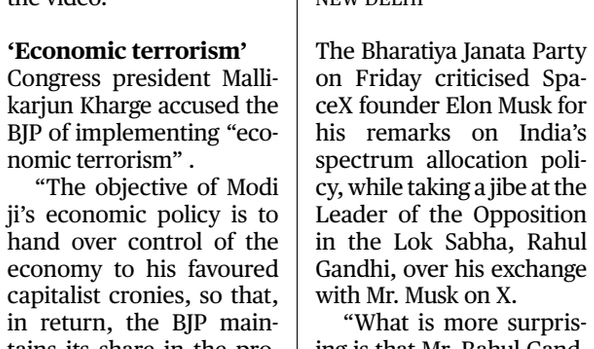
Chief Justice of India Surya Kant clarified that the explicit bar did not amount to a gag or restriction on viewing live-streamed proceedings or court reportage.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench, pointed out that court proceedings are live-streamed 24x7 in the United Kingdom and the United States, but the access was subject to strict guidelines against commercialisation.

The court gave the parties and other stakeholders time to file pleadings, along with suggestions.

# Suvendu thanks minority voters after BJP's victory in Nandigram, Rejinagar

**Shiv Sahay Singh**
KOLKATA



**Jubilant mood:** BJP workers celebrate party candidate Hasi Rani Rath's victory in the Nandigram byelection on Friday. ANI

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari, who had urged Muslims to vote for the BJP in the bypolls, thanked minority voters of both Nandigram and Rejinagar after the BJP won both seats. He said the BJP received support of 80% Muslims in Nandigram and that over 60% Muslim electorate voted for the party in Rejinagar.

"The Muslims have voted for us because they want to stand with the government. Muslims were told that they will be put in detention centres and they will not be allowed to practise their religion. All of this has turned out to be false in the past five months. This is the reason why they have voted for us," Mr. Adhikari told mediapersons at the State Secretariat.

The ruling BJP on Friday won both Nandigram and Rejinagar Assembly seats in West Bengal by huge margins, in the byelection held on October 6. In the Nandigram Assembly seat in Purba Medinipur district, BJP candidate Hasi Rani Rath won by a record margin of over 1.22 lakh votes. BJP candidate Shankharavh Sarkar won the Rejinagar seat in Murshidabad district by a margin of over 75,000 votes.

While it has been a tradition for the party in power in West Bengal to win bypolls, the significance of this victory is that a majority of the Muslim electorate voted for the BJP both in Rejinagar and Nandigram. About 70% of the electorate in Rejinagar belongs to the minority community, while Muslims account for 27% of voters in Nandigram.

With the results, the ruling party's tally in the State Assembly has increased to 209 seats. The House has a total of 294 seats.

# BJP wrests Assam's Nagaon Lok Sabha seat after seven years

**The Hindu Bureau**
GUWAHATI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) won the Nagaon Lok Sabha constituency in central Assam after seven years, with its candidate Devasish Sharma bagging almost 50% of the votes polled on October 6.

The last time the BJP had won Nagaon constituency was in the 2014 Lok Sabha polls.

After that, the seat was held by Pradyut Bordoloi (then a member of the Indian National Congress) from 2019 to 2024, and again from 2024 to March 2026, after which he vacated the seat to join the BJP and contest the 2026 legislative assembly elections in Assam.

The underlying narrative of the BJP's bypoll victory on Friday was its inroads into areas dominated by Muslims, mostly of Bengal origin, who became a majority in the constituency after the 2023 delimitation.

Mr. Sharma, a former bureaucrat, polled 7,13,662 votes, which was 1,41,916 more than his nearest rival and chief of the minority-based All India United Democratic Front (AIUDF) Mohammed Badruddin Ajmal. Congress candidate Sibamoni Bora, a former MLA, finished a distant third with 1,29,363 votes.

Congratulating Mr. Sharma, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said his party's Nagaon victory shattered the myth that Muslims do not vote for the BJP.

"We improved in four Assembly segments held by us and got more votes in the remaining four. We secured a substantial chunk of the religious minority votes. This is mainly because of our development politics under Prime Minister Modi's leadership. This victory is a tribute to his leadership and a reflection of the growing public support for him," he said.

**High alert:** Security increased in New Delhi, ahead of the CJP protest near Jantar Mantar on Saturday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

**Eyes on the site:** A worker installs CCTV cameras near the Jantar Mantar protest site. AFP

**Gearing up:** Police personnel being briefed ahead of the Cockroach Janta Party protest in Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

**Taking a stand:** Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi Vadra during a protest at Vijay Chowk in Delhi. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

## Social media firms told to drop content on request

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

As authorities gear up to tackle Saturday's protests against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar at Jantar Mantar, the capital is set to face stringent curbs on communication.

The Delhi Police have imposed a 24-hour Internet shutdown around the protest site from 10 p.m. on Friday, while the Information Technology Ministry has urged social media platforms to quickly take down content referred to them by government Ministries and departments.

The Internet shutdown order will be in effect in a four-kilometre radius of the Janpath-Kartavya Path intersection, says a notification by the Special Cell.

The IT Ministry's advisory urges social media platforms to limit the reach of content "likely to cause public disorder or incite the commission of a cognisable offence relating to public order". The order further told them to "accord priority to reports/complaints received from authorised government agencies regarding content having potential implications for public order, and take appropriate action."

# Annul recent Assembly polls, INDIA bloc urges President

Memorandum alleges large-scale 'vote theft', seeks CEC's resignation, suspension of SIR exercise, and return to paper ballots; Rahul says sustained Opposition pressure could bring down govt.

**Sobhana K. Nair**
NEW DELHI

**Joint appeal:** President Droupadi Murmu meets an INDIA bloc delegation on Friday. PTI

The Opposition INDIA bloc on Friday urged President Droupadi Murmu to "repeal" all Assembly elections held over the last two years, saying they have "incontrovertible proof" of "vote chori" (theft).

Before their meeting with the President, the Opposition leaders gathered at the central hall of Samvidhan Sadan, where according to sources, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi claimed that the government is "rattled" and if the Opposition continues its campaign, the government could fall without completing its full term.

**Elections 'stolen'**

"We have incontrovertible proof that vote *chori* has taken place on a massive scale in election after election. Assembly elections in Haryana, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Delhi and West Bengal have been stolen," the memorandum said.

The Opposition bloc is also scheduled to meet Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Monday with a similar memorandum.

The memorandum reiterated the Opposition's demands seeking Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar's resignation and repeal of the 2023 law that provides life-long immunity to the CEC and ECs.

They have also sought suspension of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls that has led to "illegal" deletions of 13.30 crore voters, and a return to paper ballots for all elections, replacing the electronic voting machines (EVMs).

Addressing the media after the meeting, Mr. Gandhi said he was "shocked and surprised" that the President had neither "denied" nor "questioned" the Opposition's allegations of vote theft.

"We clearly said that the Prime Minister, Amit Shah and Gyanesh Kumar have conspired to destroy Indian democracy. The President in no way questioned or denied what we said. She accepted our statement and asked us to bring the proof, which we are happy to provide," he said.

The memorandum underlined that the Opposition represents over 60% of the Indian electorate. "The people of India look to the Office of the President as the final guardian of that covenant. We appeal to your conscience, to your sense of justice, and to your abiding duty to the people of this Republic. Do not let their voice be silenced," it concluded.

The delegation included Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, NCP (SP) leader Supriya Sule, CPI(M) general secretary M.A. Baby, CPI general secretary D. Raja, SP leader Rajeev Rai and VCK president and Lok Sabha MP Thol. Thirumavalavan.

Earlier, Mr. Gandhi said the issue went beyond the Chief Election Commissioner and required a broader political response.

"There is a much deeper problem than Gyanesh Kumar and it requires the termination of this current government. It is something worth fighting for and worth dying for," Mr. Gandhi said.

## Rahul's version of meet with Murmu not factual, says BJP

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Sudhanshu Trivedi

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) has accused the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, of misrepresenting what transpired when leaders of the the Indian National Developmental Inclusive Alliance (INDIA), met President Draupadi Murmu on Friday evening, to raise allegations of "vote chori (theft)".

Rajya Sabha MP Sudhanshu Trivedi alleged that Mr. Gandhi, in his statement after the meeting, twisted what had occurred. "The President of India is not just an individual but an institution," Mr. Trivedi said, adding that Mr. Gandhi's version of events after the meeting was "politically motivated rather than factual".

Mr. Gandhi had said after the meeting that he was "shocked and surprised" that the President had neither "denied" nor "questioned" the Opposition's allegations of vote theft.

Against the backdrop of the results of the bypolls to five Assembly seats and one Lok Sabha seat being declared on Friday, Mr. Trivedi asked whether the Congress had checked the voters' list, or whether its election and counting agents had found any discrepancies in the process. "First, the Congress said electronic voting machines (EVMs) were being hacked; then alleged that the special intensive revision (SIR) was cutting out voters. Both cannot be true. The Congress has 45 days within which to appeal the results; will they be doing so in the light of their accusations?" he asked.

He said that the statements and demands made by Mr. Gandhi regarding the conduct of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, and "misrepresenting" what transpired in the meeting with President Murmu made him "dangerous" for democracy in India.

The INDIA bloc has been protesting the SIR exercise and demanding Mr. Kumar's resignation.

## Chirag backs youth protest, calls for talks to solve crisis

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Union Minister Chirag Paswan has thrown his weight behind the youth protest scheduled for Saturday, while adding that dialogue is needed to resolve the crisis. He also accused Opposition parties of politicising the issue.

Responding to questions about the government clampdown ahead of Saturday's protest, Mr. Paswan said, "These are the youth of India. Nothing can stop them." He was speaking to the media at the National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management, Kundli in Sonepat, Haryana, on Friday.

He asked, "How many trains can be stopped and for how many days, how many roads can be blocked? Can it really hold them [youth protesters] back?"

The young, Mr. Paswan said, must be heard. Citing his ongoing campaign, '*Youth Bole Toh*', he said he provides a platform for all shades of opinion, and listens to Gen Z's concerns.

"I may agree or disagree, but we engage in dialogue so that we can ultimately arrive at a solution...," he said.

## Amid bulk filing, ECI sets limit on Form 7 submissions

**Sreeparna Chakrabarty**
NEW DELHI

The Election Commission of India (ECI) on Friday capped the number of Form 7s a voter can submit to contain bulk applications seeking deletion of voter names during the special intensive revision (SIR) in many States.

The maximum number of applications during the period of claims and objections an individual elector can file has been capped at 10, while applications during the continuous updation of electoral rolls has been fixed at five per month. These will apply to both online and physical forms.

Till now, there was no limit prescribed on the number of physical Form 7s a voter can file.

*The Hindu* has reported from Rajasthan, Gujarat, West Bengal, and Karnataka on the submission of bulk Form 7s in the name of BJP leaders.

For the SIR period, the Commission has already allowed booth-level agents (BLAs) of the recognised political parties to file applications in bulk, subject to the condition that the BLA shall not submit more than 50 forms per day to the booth-level officer before the draft publication of electoral rolls, and 10 forms per day thereafter.

For an individual elector of a constituency, applications are filed as per para 11.3.2 (ii) of the Manual on Electoral Rolls, 2023, which provides that claims and objections presented in bulk, including those sent by post, by an individual should not be entertained. It also provides for personal cross-verification by the electoral registration officer (ERO) where the same person is the objector in more than five cases.

**Inconvenience to voters**

The ECI said bulk Form 7 applications by individual voters on unsubstantiated grounds inconvenience the elector objected upon and increases workload on field-level functionaries. According to the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960 (RER, 1960), any claim or objection not lodged within the period or in the form and manner specified in the rules shall be rejected by the ERO.

"Accordingly, the ERO should ensure that full details are filled in the Form 7 and the form is signed by the objector at appropriate place...," the directive said.

It said if the complaint is false or fabricated, the ERO will take action against the applicant.

## Congress cites *The Hindu*, says genuine voters deleted

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Friday cited an opinion piece published in *The Hindu* to allege that the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls was resulting in the deletion of genuine voters and undermining the constitutional guarantee of adult suffrage.

Sharing the article on X, Congress general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh said: "Here is a thorough analysis of how SIR is destroying the letter and spirit of Article 326 of the Constitution and deliberately disenfranchising crores of Indians."

"SIR has been a mischievous instrument wielded by the CEC (Chief Election Commissioner) to perpetuate the rule of the Diabolical Duo," he added.

In a separate post, citing a report by the Reporters' Collective, Mr. Ramesh claimed that 2.96 crore voters were removed from Uttar Pradesh's electoral rolls during the SIR, the highest number among the States where the exercise was conducted. He also questioned the addition of 16 lakh voters through Form 6, alleging that their details had not been made public despite requests.

Mr. Ramesh further alleged that 85,854 pre-filled copies of Form 7 were generated through the ERONet software after the deadline for claims and objections had expired.

***On the draw***

## Cong. quotes *Sholay*, mocks protest curbs

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

From using an iconic dialogue from the 1975 Hindi film *Sholay* to writing a letter to Prime Minister Narendra Modi urging him to keep Jantar Mantar open for protests, Opposition leaders targeted the Centre over unprecedented curbs and an "undeclared emergency" in Delhi.

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge played on the iconic movie dialogue, delivered by actor Amjad Khan in the role of Gabbar Singh, – *jo dar gaya samjho mar gaya* (one who is afraid is considered dead) – to take a dig at the government over the restrictions in place ahead of the youth protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar.

In a joint statement, Left parties, including CPI(M), CPI, CPI(ML)-Liberation, Revolutionary Socialist Party (RSP) and All India Forward Bloc, demanded that the Delhi Police and the Union government stop intimidating prospective protest participants.

# Railways cancels 245 trains ahead of CJP stir

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

The Railway Ministry has also stated that passengers will receive a 100% refund for the cancelled train ticket. ANI

The Indian Railways has cancelled 245 trains terminating at or originating from Delhi stations ahead of the CJP protest in the national capital. This includes 75 Mail/Express trains including Rajdhani, Tejas, Shatabdi, and 170 passenger trains.

The Railway Ministry, in a letter to all zones, said it ordered these cancellations because of expected severe road traffic congestion. The Railways has ordered the cancellation of trains in anticipation that massive crowds will surround the stations.

The Railway Ministry has also said that more than 5,000 passengers missed their trains on October 8 due to severe traffic jams and road blockades caused by political protests in the national capital. Affected passengers missed trains like the Dibrugarh Rajdhani, Mumbai Rajdhani and Vande Bharat, among others.

The decision covers Mail and Express services – including major trains like the Sealdah-New Delhi Rajdhani Express, CSMT-Hazrat Nizamuddin Rajdhani Express, Ranchi-New Delhi Garibrath Express and Howrah-New Delhi Rajdhani Express – departing from their original stations, according to a public statement issued by CPRO, Northern Railways Himanshu Shekhar Upadhyay.

**Thousands affected**

Cancellation of trains has led to inconvenience amongst passengers. For instance, the cancellation of the CSMT-Hazrat Nizamudin Rajdhani Express has impacted close to 1,200 passengers. The Railway Ministry has also stated that passengers will receive a 100% refund for the cancelled train ticket.

Affected trains also include two Delhi-bound trains from Indore in Madhya Pradesh – the Indore-Hazrat Nizammudin Express and the Indore-New Delhi Express, and two trains plying from Lucknow to Delhi – Lucknow Mail and Lucknow-New Delhi AC SF Express.

Among the trains that are cancelled are Udaipur City-Hazrat Nizamuddin and Shri Ganganagar-Tilak Bridge, which were departing earlier on Friday, and Hazrat Nizamuddin-Udaipur City and Tilak Bridge commuter services linking Sirsa, Bhiwani, and Shri Ganganagar, earlier scheduled for departure on Saturday.

"Passengers are advised to verify their live train running status via official NTES (National Train Enquiry System) platforms," railway officials have stated.

Trains arriving at Anand Vihar Terminal (ANVT) and Old Delhi Railway Station (DLI) will function as usual, officials stated.

## INBRIEF

### Judge recuses from hearing Punjab's plea against HC order

Supreme Court judge, Justice Sheel Nagu, on Friday recused himself from hearing an appeal filed by the State of Punjab against a State High Court order for a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into corruption allegations linked to Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann's office. Justice Nagu was the Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court immediately before his appointment on the Bench of the Supreme Court. The court conveyed to the assembled courtroom that the case would be reassigned to another Bench by the Chief Justice of India. The State of Punjab, in its appeal has argued that the High Court's direction suffered from errors.

### U.P. govt. moves to rename Noida airport after Modi

The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet on Friday approved a proposal to rename the Noida International Airport at Jewar as 'Narendra Modi International Airport, Noida-Jewar', Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said. "The Uttar Pradesh Council of Ministers is grateful to the respected Prime Minister, Shri Narendra Modi Ji , for gifting Uttar Pradesh with the Noida International Airport, Jewar. It is the state's largest airport and is poised to become the nation's largest aviation hub in the future. Therefore, the Council of Ministers has also passed a resolution to rename Noida International Airport as "Narendra Modi International Airport." said Mr. Adityanath.

### Government to tighten rules on ads for prescription drugs

The Union Health Ministry has proposed extending restrictions on advertisements of prescription medicines to drug retailers, wholesalers and distributors, seeking to close a regulatory gap in the Drugs Rules, 1945. A draft amendment notified through a Gazette notification on September 28 proposes to prohibit holders of licences to sell, stock, exhibit, offer for sale or distribute drugs listed under Schedules H, H1 and X from advertising these medicines without prior sanction. The proposal follows recommendations made at the 93rd meeting of the Drugs Technical Advisory Board (DTAB) on February 16.

### Kashmir-born filmmaker freed after detention in U.S.

Kashmir-born filmmaker and movie 'Saffron Kingdom' director Sheikh Arfat, 42, was released after 14 days of detention in the U.S., the family said on Friday. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) detained the filmmaker on September 24 pending an immigration application. "Mr. Arfat was released on October 8 by the ICE," a family member told *The Hindu*. Mr. Arfat continued to be held after the bond was granted on October 6, for an additional 48 hours, a U.S.-based advocacy group said. Mr. Arfat was en route from San Francisco to Washington, DC, for the 'Art as Resistance' event at Busboys and Poets on September 24 when he was detained.

# House panel asks NTA to hold entrance exams in CBT mode

Committee moots central registry to permanently bar blacklisted exam vendors; it says long-term defence against recurring leaks is investing in large, diverse, continuously updated question banks

**Maitri Porecha**
NEW DELHI

Recognising the scale of examinations like NEET, the panel suggested exploring multi-session CBT schedules. FILE PHOTO

The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Education, tasked with reforming the National Testing Agency (NTA), tabled a report in the Rajya Sabha on Friday recommending the transition of flagship entrance examinations to Computer-Based Test (CBT) mode, the establishment of stringent logistical precautions, and the creation of a centralised national registry to bar compromised vendors.

To eliminate handling risks associated with traditional pen-and-paper formats, the committee strongly recommended shifting major national entrance tests, specifically NEET-UG, to an online, CBT format.

The panel emphasised that the most viable long-term defence against recurring leaks is investing in large, diverse, and continuously updated question banks. Drawing on advanced domain knowledge, these banks should generate dynamic, randomised question sets for CBT formats. The committee stated that repeatedly relying on standard question sets or static preparation methods creates a severe integrity risk.

The panel also noted that in the proposed CBT format, question papers are to be securely transmitted via hybrid encrypted delivery mechanisms right up to the start of the examination.

Recognising the scale of examinations like NEET-UG, the panel suggested exploring multi-session CBT schedules across independent shifts.

"To maintain fairness and public trust, any normalisation methodology applied across multi-session tests must be independently audited, mathematically robust, and clearly explained to students well before implementation," the panel stated.

The committee urged the NTA to rely primarily on renowned academic institutions such as the Indian Institutes of Technology, All India Institutes of Medical Sciences, and Indian Institutes of Management to curate content.

"A strict background check system must be established to track the record and integrity of paper setters to rule out conflicts of interest, such as faculty linkages with private coaching academies or commercial interests," the panel said.

The panel warned against over-reliance on unverified private vendors. To address digital connectivity gaps, particularly in Tier-2, Tier-3, and rural regions, it recommended using mid-sized IT labs (100-200 nodes) available at public universities, government engineering colleges, polytechnics, and accredited schools.

The panel flagged severe workforce constraints within the agency, highlighting a vacancy rate of over 40% among key permanent posts.

The panel also highlighted that security measures must not turn test centres into high-stress, hostile environments. It advised against invasive physical search procedures that cause undue anxiety to candidates.

The panel flagged the necessity of establishing a centralised, inter-agency digital registry of blacklisted and penalised vendors. Presently, vendors penalised, suspended, or blacklisted by one testing body or State often secure lucrative contracts with other autonomous educational bodies or recruitment boards due to isolated records, the panel noted.

# Centre rejects MP's claims on 'sharing' of NEET protesters' data

**Krishnadas Rajagopal**
NEW DELHI

The Union government has opposed Rajya Sabha MP A.A. Rahim's "sweeping" assertion that the biometric data of "thousands of protesters" have been enrolled on national criminal databases.

An affidavit filed by the Home Ministry through the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) said blanket allegations of indefinite retention, storage and sharing of biometric information were not based on foundational facts.

The NCRB said allegations of violation of fundamental rights to privacy, free speech and expression must be based on factual foundation of the alleged infringement.

The government said the MP has not identified a single biometric record of any person which was unlawfully collected at Jantar Mantar, transmitted to NCRB, which had in turn processed or retained the information in breach of any law. An "omnibus" assertion that biometrics of the NEET-UG protestors were captured and stored cannot substitute for proof that it was actually done, the Home Ministry said.

Mr. Rahim had challenged the alleged use of Facial Recognition Technology (FRT) and biometric surveillance by law enforcement agencies during public demonstrations, particularly at Jantar Mantar. He had alleged that the biometrics of the protesters were illegally retained and passed on to third parties.

"The petitioner's prayer seeking deletion and erasure of biometric information from NAFIS, CCTNS and every allied database is in its present form wholly omnibus. It would necessarily require the identification of the particular category of record, the database in which the record is maintained, the authority responsible for creating and transmitting the record, the criminal proceedings, if any, to which the record relates and the statutory regime governing its retention or destruction," the NCRB affidavit pointed out.

A nodal officer would also consider the plea for destruction of the record and verify if the biometrics were linked to any other active cases. The NCRB said the allegations that it had an interface to share biometric information with private entities were at best vague.

# SC takes exception to Patna HC's observations on what constitutes attempt to rape

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

**Top court issues notice to the accused, who had been acquitted of the charges against him**

The Supreme Court on Friday took exception to a recent Patna High Court judgment, which held that removing a woman's salwar and pressing her chest did not amount to an attempt to rape. The court issued notice to the accused, who had been acquitted of the charges against him.

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant was hearing a *suo motu* case concerning the High Court ruling, which had held that such acts could, "at best", constitute assault or use of criminal force with intent to outrage a woman's modesty under Section 354 of the Indian Penal Code (IPC).

**'Insensitive language'**

Senior advocate Shobha Gupta, who had brought the High Court judgment to the Supreme Court's attention, questioned the use of the word "preparation" in judicial orders to describe sexual acts falling short of penetration. She also drew the court's attention to other recent High Court rulings which, she submitted, contained objectionable and insensitive language while referring to victims of sexual offences.

The trial court had convicted Pathak under Sections 376 read with 511 of the IPC for attempting to commit rape and sentenced him to three years' rigorous imprisonment along with a fine of ₹5,000. The High Court, however, found an "absence of any evidence of penetration, even to the slightest extent, or any overt act unequivocally constituting an attempt to commit rape."

**2008 case**

According to the prosecution, the incident occurred on January 19, 2008, when the woman accompanied her father to Chhaya Studio in Amarpur to have her photograph taken. The accused, who owned the studio, allegedly asked her father to wait outside. He allegedly locked the door, tried to remove her salwar, undressed himself and sexually assaulted her. Hearing her cries, her father broke open the door, after which the accused escaped.

# Playing loud music on trains can attract fine, imprisonment

**S. Vijay Kumar**
CHENNAI

The Indian Railways has warned of punitive action, including imprisonment, against passengers who play audio/video on speaker mode, causing inconvenience to others on trains and at railway premises.

Calling for a more responsible use of mobile phones to ensure a peaceful and comfortable journey for fellow passengers, the railways appealed to passengers to use earphones and keep phone conversations at a low volume.

The move seeks to address the issue of passengers using their mobile phones or other gadgets to play music or videos during the journey, often causing inconvenience to fellow travellers.

"Loud and prolonged phone conversations and disturbing ringtones can [cause] inconvenience [to] others, particularly in enclosed spaces such as AC coaches," the railways said.

**No nuisance**

Going by the provisions under Section 145(2) of the Railways Act, 1989, as amended by the Jan Vishwas (Amendment of Provisions) Act, 2026, conduct that constitutes a nuisance would attract a fine of ₹1,000 in addition to removal from the railway property and forfeiture of the pass or ticket.

The railways said that "if a person continues the nuisance after being directed to stop by a railway servant lawfully authorised to issue such a direction, the punishment may extend to six months' simple imprisonment or a fine of up to ₹5,000, or both."

# Ex-BSF staff denied nod for protest at Jantar Mantar

**Vijaita Singh**
NEW DELHI

More than 400 former Border Security Force (BSF) personnel were denied police approval for their protest despite having applied for it a month earlier.

The former BSF personnel, who had allegedly fallen victim to a cyber fraud scheme, eventually held the demonstration against their dismissal from service on the pavement outside the BSF headquarters in central Delhi on Friday.

They had applied for permission for a "two-day hunger strike" at Jantar Mantar on September 9, but the police termed their request as unlawful citing existing Supreme Court guidelines.

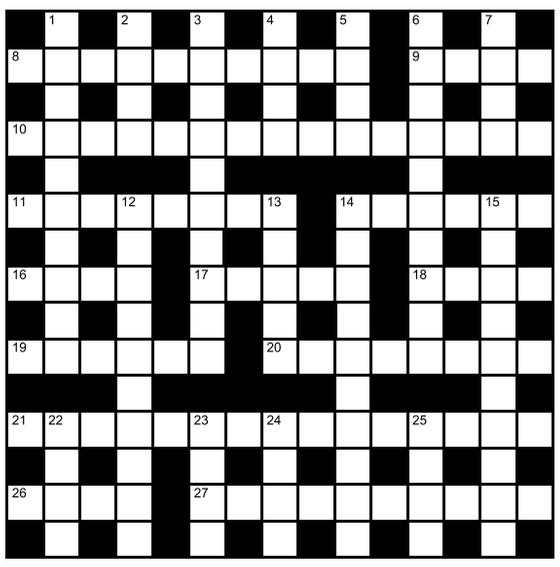
The association has requested the reinstatement of the dismissed staff on humanitarian grounds.

## TH CROSSWORD + 14920

(set by Vidwan)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



**Across**

**8** Dressed and scented, one who succeeds (10)
**9** Going past one time (4)
**10** Pressure on borders of Turkey! Turkey in revolt and distressed! (15)
**11** Official is bit earnest and ardent (8)
**14** Upset about party position on the ground (3-3)
**16** Fair fellow Peter, after robbing banks (4)
**17** Large creature like gorilla with large fold (5)
**18** Shreds of oddly plain note (4)
**19** Showing no interest, committed theft, mostly Identity Card! (6)
**20** A US market index study with Judge operating on English system originally (3,5)
**21** Progressive leaning district going to fine royal man (15)
**26** Dread female attention (4)
**27** British secure China's new data security technology (10)

**Down**

**1** Extradition Office gaining nothing for Leader of America (10)
**2** Hurt every head to tail (4)
**3** Native American lost heart, called out dead and signed (10)
**4** Acts funny! Was chasing First Lady! (4)
**5** Father mostly checking time to move (4)
**6** Ice-cold lap dancing is wrong (10)
**7** Mention it in church (4)
**12** Born fool donning most loose embroidery (10)
**13** Cheated fellow pushed back date over suspicion of permissiveness (5)
**14** My walk, this alters! (4,6)
**15** Good restricted by good, complain about new digital growth (10)
**22** Done in open mainly (4)
**23** Polish unknown gem (4)
**24** Time to run to love? Yes! To Paris and Hector's place! (4)
**25** Legendary goalkeeper Harry Hank (4)

## SUDOKU

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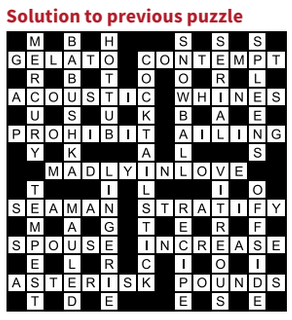
DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

**Solution to previous puzzle**



**Solution to yesterday's Sudoku**

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| 8 | 3 | 4 | 7 | 9 | 5 | 6 | 2 | 1 |
| 6 | 7 | 1 | 3 | 8 | 2 | 4 | 5 | 9 |
| 2 | 9 | 5 | 1 | 4 | 6 | 7 | 3 | 8 |
| 5 | 8 | 7 | 4 | 2 | 1 | 3 | 9 | 6 |
| 1 | 4 | 3 | 8 | 6 | 9 | 5 | 7 | 2 |
| 9 | 6 | 2 | 5 | 7 | 3 | 8 | 1 | 4 |

## FAITH

### Spirituality in daily life

It is recommended that one perform certain basic rituals in the name of the divine, daily, as one goes about one's chores. There are other ways by which one can connect with Perumal. Waking up with a prayer to God to bless one with a good day, paying obeisance to the Sun, plucking flowers, cleaning the prayer space and performing the daily service such as Sandhyavandana, reciting of prayers and following it up with offerings of flowers, milk and condiments are activities that help one focus one's mind on the Supreme Being, said Damal S. Ramakrishnan. In the Kali Yuga, if everyone follows daily rituals, God will be immensely pleased: it is one of the important *margas* for getting His blessings.

Human mind is fickle and it is not always possible to do everything in life in order to attain the ultimate goal of reaching God. Spiritual literature state that bhakti marga is the most practical way of attaining this goal. The lives of saints such as Andal prove this. With her infinite faith, she is able to beckon god and His entourage to Srivilliputtur through her spiritual outpouring (Tiruppavai). Scholars, interpreting her verse *Ongi Ulagalandha Uttaman Per Paadi*, say, being omnipresent, He transcends all boundaries to reach and redeem the atma.

Bhakti does not call for academic achievement but is doable by all. Meera Bai found Him through her bhajans; the shortest way to reach Vittala is to engage in nama sankirtan. In Brindavan, all the residents greeted everyone as 'Krishna' and He was never far from them. One can cruise the material world as one pleases, but one should cultivate latent bhakti in order to truly succeed in life.

## INBRIEF

### RBI raises daily cash reserve ratio requirement for banks

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Friday said banks will need to maintain 99% of the required cash reserve ratio (CRR) daily starting October 16, up from 90% at present. The move follows a review of the current liquidity condition in the banking system and will help reduce the banking system liquidity, which stood at a surplus of around ₹3.88 lakh crore as of October 8. PTI

### German machinery exports to India rose 11% in H1 2026

India is emerging as a strategic partner for German and European mechanical and plant engineering industry, due to efforts to diversify supply chains away from China, according to the German Engineering Federation (VDMA). German machinery exports to India rose 11% to €2.2 billion in the first half of 2026. A VDMA survey found 65% of engineering firms operating in India expect order intake to increase, while 56% expect improvement in business situation.

### Policy on critical minerals stockpiling in a month

The government is likely to announce a policy on stockpiling of critical minerals within a month, a move which is expected to ensure the supply of these resources to strategic sectors like defence, aerospace and energy, according to Mines Secretary Keshav Chandra. The government is also working on four dedicated critical minerals processing parks across Gujarat, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha to fast-track value addition for key battery materials, he said. PTI

# India's share of global greenfield investments more than double China's during 2020-25

A report by the UN Conference on Trade and Development says greenfield investments are increasingly taking place in strategic sectors; It added that India remains the fastest-growing major economy, even though domestic consumption is starting to show signs of strain due to higher prices

**T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan**
NEW DELHI

India's share in global greenfield investments during 2020-25, at 5.7%, is more than double China's share in such investments during the same period, according to the latest report by the UN Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD).

However, it also said investment in strategic sectors still remains concentrated in Europe and North America, highlighting the integration challenges for the Global South.

The latest Trade and Development Report 2026 report by UNCTAD, released on Friday, said that greenfield investments were increasingly being made in strategic sectors. Greenfield investments refer to those made by companies in new ventures in another country.

**Strategic investments**

According to the data in the report, India accounted for 5.7% of global greenfield investments during 2020 to 2025, followed by Malaysia (4%), Indonesia (3.8%), and China (2.8%).

"From 2020 to 2025, strategic sectors grew from 16% to 44% of global greenfield investment, which captures both their rapid progression and current importance," UNCTAD said in the report.

**Lion's share:** Among these strategic sectors, AI infrastructure and related technologies attracted the largest share. REUTERS

Among these strategic sectors, artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure and related technologies attracted the largest share of 12.4% of the $845.7 billion of overall global greenfield investment that took place within this period. AI infrastructure was followed by the semiconductor value chain (8.1%) and energy transition technologies and services (7.8%).

"The geographic disparity in strategic investment underscores the growing integration challenges for the Global South, especially for the least developed countries," the UNCTAD report said.

It pointed out that Europe accounted for 28.4% of strategic investment and North America captured another 28%.

"Even among developing economies, capital is primarily funnelled into developing Asia (26.5%), with China, India, Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore as leading jurisdictions for new investments," the report said.

The report also shows that India ranks high in terms of the number of industrial policies it has implemented over the last two decades or so. During 2008-21, India implemented 1,416 industrial policies, behind only China (4,201) and the U.S. (4,025).

# Coal supplies to power utilities rise 36% from September lows

**The Hindu Bureau**
NEW DELHI

Daily coal supplies to the power sector have risen 36% from their post-monsoon lows in September and are averaging about 9% higher in October than in the preceding month, the government said on Friday, signalling an improvement in fuel availability for power generation.

Rail-based supplies have also been strengthened, with an average of 465 rakes dispatched daily in October, the government said, adding that road-based supplies had improved as well.

**An average of 465 rakes via rail is being dispatched daily in October, the government said**

Last month, state-owned Coal India and its subsidiaries offered power plants with existing supply agreements the option to lift additional coal beyond their annual contracted quantities through road transport, supplementing their regular rail-based supplies.

The Coal Ministry expects daily rail loading of 465–475 rakes to be sufficient to meet power demand, which is expected to moderate by mid-October in line with historical trends.

The ministry said the depletion of coal stocks – the difference between consumption and incoming supplies – had slowed from 0.243 million tonnes (MT) a day in September to 0.116 MT in October.

# PERM pause for Indian IT majors raises talent-retention concerns

**Mini Tejaswi**
BENGALURU

The Trump administration's decision to suspend access to the Permanent Labour Certification (PERM) programme for major Indian IT companies has raised concerns over the long-term retention of experienced Indian tech professionals in the U.S.

Peter Bendor-Samuel, founder and executive chairman of Dallas-based Everest Group, said that the move would constrain how many employees the affected companies could sponsor for green cards and how quickly they could do so.

However, given that permanent residency is a multi-year process, a delay of several months would be more frustrating than consequential for most employees.

Avinash Vashistha, chairman and CEO of Tholons, an AI reinvention company, said the disruption could be severe for affected employers because pending applications, as well as new applications, would be affected.

However, data cited by ICICI Securities suggests that the direct exposure of Indian IT companies to the PERM route is limited.

Of the 1,17,849 PERM applications filed between October 2024 and September 2025, Indian IT companies accounted for less than 2%, according to the brokerage.

Infosys had no PERM cases since 2022, while Wipro, TCS and HCLTech received 523, 513 and 393 permanent-residency approvals, respectively.

# Differences over ownership issues cloud TVS' Venu Srinivasan, family

**Kunal Shankar**
CHENNAI

Significant differences have emerged over the interpretation of ownership and succession plans within the family of Venu Srinivasan, involving his wife, Mallika Srinivasan, daughter Lakshmi Venu and son Sudarshan Venu, in relation to their interests in TVS Motor Company and its holding firm, TVS Holdings Limited. They are the third and fourth generations of TVS Group founder TV Sundaram Iyengar.

The differences came into the fore in April 2025, *The Hindu* learned, when TVS Holdings disclosed Sudarshan Venu, the 37-year-old CMD of TVS Motor Company was named Significant Beneficial Owner (SBO). Shareholding disclosure records April 16, 2025, as date of acquisition of the SBO via the VS Trust, in which his father, Venu Srinivasan, is a trustee and the Srinivasan Trust.

The disclosure has drawn attention to the succession of ownership of TVS Motor, the flagship of the TVS Group, valued at over ₹1.80 lakh crore.

The differences centre on the interpretation of a memorandum of understanding (MoU) among the four family members executed on March 21, 2024.

Its salient features were disclosed to the bourses on March 22. The MoU lays non-compete obligations and curbs on the use of the TVS brand and trademarks in specified businesses. TVS Holdings said it was not a party to the pact.

Under the disclosed terms, Mr. Sudarshan and persons controlled by him agreed not to use certain trademarks, including TVS, in specified die-casting businesses and not to compete for a defined period in agricultural machinery, including tractors and self-propelled farm equipment. Ms. Mallika and Ms. Lakshmi, in turn, agreed not to use certain trademarks in businesses including two- and three-wheelers, financial services and real estate, and not to compete in specified vehicle-related businesses.

Dispute is about Significant Beneficial Ownership.

An executive with direct knowledge of the dispute said the MoU did not discuss ownership transition.

"Could we say because N. Chandrasekaran is chairman of Tata Sons, he owns the firm as well?" the executive asked, drawing a distinction between managing and owning a business. The executive said attempts to seek clarity on the April 2025 SBO declaration was met with 'silence.'

**Amicable resolution**

Ms. Lakshmi is learnt to have the support of her mother, Ms. Mallika, in seeking an amicable resolution. "She wishes to sit across and settle differences," the executive said, adding Ms. Lakshmi sought an equal share of the business as the division in disclosures and MoU was considered "very unfair".

The dispute also brought charges of gender bias into focus. An executive said Ms. Mallika and Mr. Venu raised children to believe in equality as a value, and that the present arrangement was at odds with this principle.

**Amalgamations Group**

"What Ms. Lakshmi is asking for is equality in ownership, and Ms. Mallika supports her on this, but has emphasised on an amicable resolution," the executive said. Ms. Lakshmi and Ms. Mallika are also understood to be concerned about the inclusion of the Amalgamations Group in the succession discussions.

"Ms. Mallika is herself only a 10% owner in that group, so how can she speak for herself without even consulting other shareholding members of the family? She is running TAFE only as a custodian of the firm," the executive said, describing the inclusion of the Amalgamations Group in the ownership tussle as "mischievous".

**Family arrangement**

The wider family arrangement provides crucial context. The Memorandum of Family Arrangement, dated December 10, 2020, covered four branches of the TVS family and sought to align ownership of businesses with the branches managing them and reduce cross-holdings.

The arrangement was disclosed to the bourses in December 2020, with further details provided in January 2021. Its implementation involved subsequent corporate restructuring, with February 4, 2022, marking an important date in the process.

The restructuring left Mr. Venu's branch with control of the group's flagship automotive interests through TVS Holdings, which was formed out of the restructuring of the erstwhile Sundaram-Clayton. TVS Holdings now holds 50.26% of TVS Motor Company. The separate Sundaram-Clayton entity houses the die-casting business. The ownership structure of these entities is central to the dispute as the family settlement aligned the ownership of businesses with the branches managing them.

**₹2,000-cr. obligations**

The settlement also involved obligations of about ₹2,000 crore payable to other family branches. According to TVS Holdings' information memorandum, Sundaram-Clayton diluted about 7% of its stake in TVS Motor in FY2022, raising about ₹2,100 crore. The company's disclosures also describe financing arrangements connected with the settlement obligations. Subsequent reports have attributed the funding and settlement of the dues to Mr. Venu Srinivasan and Mr. Sudarshan Venu.

Lawyers told *The Hindu* a SBO declaration, by itself, should not be construed as a transfer of ownership. Corporate lawyer Karthik Sheshadri, who practises in Madras High Court, said the primary document underlying the declaration must be examined.

"A primary document can be a trust deed, an arrangement, a transfer document, that may not necessarily be disclosed as that is not a requirement, but it has to be the basis for an SBO disclosure," he said.

"Regulatory filings can be unilateral, which is why it irked a party. And often, such filings are done at a corporate secretarial level, and they will do it on behalf of the person who controls the firm. This is where disputes arise," he said.

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Applications are invited in prescribed format for Procurement of CTS 2010 Standard MICR grade paper, from IBA approved manufacturers.
**BID NO: GEM/2026/B/8135603 Due Date: 30.10.2026**
The above GEM Tender document is available and can be downloaded from **www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in**
Bank reserves the right to change/modify the terms & conditions, which will be displayed above Websites only.
**Deputy General Manager**

**KERALA WATER AUTHORITY e-Tender Notice**
Tender No: 12/2026-27/KWA/PHC/TVLA(RT-1), 16/2026-27/KWA/PHC/TVLA JJM-1) RWSS to Chittar-(8MLD Plant)-Construction of 8 MLD plant with 7 LL capacity sump at Arattukudukka-2) Eraviperoor GP-Final Phase-Full Coverage-Laying of Pipe Lines & Providing 6247 FHTCs in Eraviperoor GP - Final Phase - Package I. **EMD**: Rs. 200000, 500000. **Tender fee**: Rs. 13010, 19518. **Last Date for submitting Tender**: 05-11-2026 02:00:pm. Phone: **8547638027.**
Website: **www.kwa.kerala.gov.in**, **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**
**Superintending Engineer**
**KWA-JB-GL-6-344-2026-27** **PH Circle, Pathanamthitta**

**KSEB KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE**
**Office of the Chief Engineer (Commercial &Tariff), Vydyuthi Bhavanam, Thiruvananthapuram**
**Inviting Short term tender for the procurement of Power during 1st January 2027 to 15th May 2027**
**DEEP portal reference no - KSEBL/Short/26-27/ET/89, dtd 08.10.2026.**
**Last Date for submission of queries - 12.10.2026**
**Submission of RfP (on line digitally signed non financial technical Bid and IPOs) - 23.10.2026, 02.00 Pm**
For more details visit **www.kseb.in** **Ref: PR/MC1/F-403/2026**

**OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER WATER RESOURCES ZONE, BANSWARA**
Mahi Colony, Near New Court Campus, Banswara, E-mail-cewrbsw@gmail.com
No.-F()/CE/WR/BSW/ACCTTs/2026-27/7593 Date: 30.09.2026
**e-NIB No - 06/2026-27**
On behalf of the Governor of Rajasthan, bids are invited from eligible bidders for the work of "Construction of Kamlakudi Anicut on Hamardot Nallah at Khuntgarh and Kaniyakudi Anicut Village GP Samali Pathar Tehsil Dhamotar District Pratapgarh" **(Estimated Value of Work - Rs. 660.68 Lakh with GST)** Last date of submission of Bid is 29.10.2026 Detailed Bid & Bid document can be seen on & downloaded from official website (http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, & http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in)
**NIB Code No.:- WRD2627A0362**
**UBN No.:- WRD2627WLOB00730**
**DIPR/C/17339/2026** **Chief Engineer**

**KERALA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD**
(DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH & FAMILY WELFARE, GOVT. OF KERALA)
Head Office : Thycaud, Thiruvananthapuram-14,
(Telephone No. 0471-2337353, FAX No. 0471-3045647),
E-mail : edrugs.kmscl@kerala.gov.in,
website : www.kmscl.kerala.gov.in, CIN No. U24233KL2007SGC021616
No.KMSCL/ED/15/2026 Date: 08.10.2026
**E-TENDER NOTICE**
Online bids are invited for the procurement of Anti Haemophilia Drugs vide e-tender no KMSCL/ED/HEAM/RC/2026/025 dtd. 08.10.2026 for Department of Health & Family Welfare, Govt. of Kerala.

| Sl. No. | Name of Item | Last Date & time of Uploading of tender | Date & time of Technical Bid opening |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1. | Human Anti Haemophilic factor IX 500 IU / 600 IU | 22.10.2026 5.00 pm. | 24.10.2026 11.00 am. |

Tender documents can be downloaded from the website **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in**.
**(S/d-) MANAGING DIRECTOR** (Tender Inviting Authority)

**TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS, TIRUPATI**
**SRI VENKATESWARA ANNA PRASADAM TRUST, TIRUPATI**
**Roc. No. TTD-26022/48/2026-MTVAC SEC-TTD**
**Name of the work:** Providing Manpower - 547 Nos., of Unskilled Workers for a period of 24 months (02 years) to work in Annaprasadam Units, Tirumala. **Tender ID No.:1002016** NIT download starting date: 10.10.2026 @ 5.00 PM. NIT download ending date: 26.10.2026 @ 1.00 PM. For further details including terms and conditions please log on to the website http://www.tirumala.org and http://tender.apeprocurement.gov.in. For enquiry, please contact Phone No:0877-2263035/2263031/9885721203,
**TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.211),Date: 09.10.2026** **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

**KMML Spreading Splendour** **The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd**
(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking),Sankaramangalam,Kollam 691583
Phone : 0476-2651215 to 217, E-Mail :md@kmml.com
**TENDER NOTICE**
For more details, please visit E-Tendering Portal, https://etenders.kerala.gov.in or www.kmml.com

| Sl No | Tender Id | Items |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2026_KMML_877028_1 | Supply, Erection and Commissioning of vertical Steam Turbine |
| 2 | 2026_KMML_876131_1 | Fabrication & Supply of Vessel for Bag Filter S304-305 |
| 3 | 2026_KMML_877443_1 | Support Roller with Shaft (in Assembled condition) for Roaster/Calciner) |
| 4 | 2026_KMML_877070_1 | Supply of FRP Tank |
| 5 | 2026_KMML_876381_1 | Installation of Hot Bag filter with associated piping at Micronizer A of U400 |

Chavara 09.10.2026 Sd/- Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

**कार्यालय मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार**
**फोन नं. 01334–224457 E-mail: procure.kumbhmela2027@gmail.com**
Letter No. 1585/K.M./Mela/2027 Date: 09/10/2026
**राष्ट्रीय प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक (ई-टेन्डरिंग)**
मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला 2027, हरिद्वार द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ई–टेण्डरिंग (टू–बिड सिस्टम) के अन्तर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचना **https://uktenders.gov.in** पर **दिनांक 10.10.2026** से उपलब्ध होंगी। कार्य का विवरण निम्नानुसार है :–
1. Empanelment of Event Management Agencies for Kumbh 2027, Haridwar.
2. Submission of Miscellaneous items for Haridwar Kumbh Mela-2027
3. Selection of an Operator for Setting Up, Operation and Maintenance of a Canteen/Cafeteria at Mela Bhawan, Har Ki Pauri, Haridwar for Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027

ई–निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें एवं ई–निविदा प्रपत्र वेबसाइट **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर उपलब्ध हैं।
**उप मेलाधिकारी,**
**कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार।**

**BESCOM BANGALORE ELECTRICITY SUPPLY COMPANY LIMITED**
**(Wholly Owned by Government of Karnataka Undertaking)**
**(CIN-U04010KA2002SGC030438)**
**TENDER NOTIFICATION** (Through KPP portal)
BESCOM invites tenders through KPP portal platform from eligible Bidders for **"Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract (CAMC) of Passive Components at BESCOM Data Center, HSR Layout, Bengaluru for 2 years".**
**Tender Enquiry No: BESCOM/2026-27/SE0469-Call-2**
(1)Availability of Bid documents: **12-10-2026** onwards.
(2) Last date for bid submission: **22-10-2026 @ 17:00** Hrs.
(3) Opening of Technical Bids: **23-10-2026 @ 16:00** Hrs.
(4) Pre-Bid meeting: **15-10-2026 @ 15:00** Hrs.
**Venue :** O/o General Manager (ICT&MIS), Conference Hall, 3rd Floor, BELAKU BHAVANA, Corporate office, BESCOM, K.R Circle, Bangalore-560001.
The bid documents can be downloaded and necessary assistance can be obtained through the Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (KPPP) from the website. **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**
KPP Portal Help Desk: Phone No: **+91 9240214000 / +91 9240214001 / +91-8046010000 / +91-8068948777**
E-mail: **support@eprochelpdesk.com**
Aspiring bidders needs to be registered on Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (KPPP). Bidders can take the assistance from the KPP during office working hours.
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ASHGABAT

## Talks with Iran can only succeed without threats, says President

AFP

Peace negotiations with Iran would only succeed without "pressure and threats", Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said on Friday. "Dialogue holds meaning and a chance of success only when based on mutual respect and mutual commitments, and when devoid of pressure and threat," Mr. Pezeshkian said. AFP

WASHINGTON

## U.S. imposes sanctions on ICC hours after ex-judge wins Nobel

AP

U.S. President Donald Trump's administration imposed sanctions on the International Criminal Court on Friday, hours after one of its former judges, Navi Pillay, won the Nobel Peace Prize. The ICC's deputy prosecutor, Nazhat Shameem Khan, condemned the sanctions and said they would not halt the tribunal's work. REUTERS

DUBAI

## Omani flydubai co-pilot planned suicide attack on Israel flight: UAE

REUTERS

An Omani flydubai co-pilot had planned to seize a Dubai-Tel Aviv flight and crash it into a terminal at Israel's Ben Gurion airport on September 30 in a suicide attack before he was thwarted by his fellow pilot, the UAE attorney general said on Friday. The plan was inspired by the September 11, 2001, attacks on the U.S.. REUTERS

JUBA

## At least 71 killed in South Sudan violence, say govt. and witnesses

REUTERS

Inter-communal violence killed 71 people early on Friday in South Sudan's central town of Rumbek, the interim government and witnesses said. Several witnesses said that ethnic and community conflict was behind the latest violence in the world's youngest country, which won independence from Sudan in 2011. AFP

## Saudi officials say 3 killed in strikes on Riyadh airport

**Associated Press**
BEIRUT

An airline pilot was among three Saudi citizens killed in attacks targeting Riyadh's King Khalid International Airport and a Saudi aircraft, the kingdom's civil aviation authority said on Friday. Several people "of different nationalities" were wounded.

The attacks on Thursday were the deadliest in Saudi Arabia since the kingdom and allied forces in neighbouring Yemen launched a major military offensive against Yemen's Houthi (Ansar Allah) rebels last weekend.

By Friday afternoon, at least 124 flights to and from Riyadh had been cancelled after hundreds more were cancelled a day earlier.

# 'Pak. has substantial forces deployed in Saudi Arabia'

Pakistani personnel won't cross into another territory to attack the Houthis, but will defend Saudi territory, says Foreign Ministry; deal signed in August vows mutual help if any member is attacked

**Agence France-Presse**
ISLAMABAD

Pakistan has a "substantial" number of forces deployed in Saudi Arabia acting in a defensive capacity, Pakistan's Foreign Ministry spokesperson said on Friday.

"From Pakistan already we have substantial number of forces as well as resources in town, in Riyadh," Foreign Ministry spokesperson Sajjad Haider Khan told presspersons, without specifying whether the deployment had grown under a major defence pact inked this year with Turkiye and Saudi Arabia.

**Show of support:** Military leaders of Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkiye during a meeting in Riyadh in September. REUTERS

He added Pakistani military personnel in the kingdom "would not be crossing the borders of the other side for an attack on the Houthis, but of course [is acting] in the defence of the territory".

Pakistan signed a defence agreement with Saudi Arabia and Turkiye in August committing the three countries to come to each other's aid in the event one was attacked.

The conflict between the Houthis (Ansar Allah) and Yemen's Saudi-backed government has widened, with the militant group staging repeated attacks on Saudi targets since they began a lightning offensive just across the border.

Mr. Khan declined to say whether new Pakistani deployments had been made since Saudi Arabia's conflict intensified and said "how much and when and where" forces would be deployed would be up to the trilateral alliance, which is headquartered in Riyadh.

# U.S. military to livestream execution by firing squad

**Agence France-Presse**
WASHINGTON

The execution by firing squad of convicted military base shooter Nidal Hasan will be livestreamed, a Pentagon official said, drawing sharp condemnation on Friday of the plan to broadcast the killing.

Hasan's execution, set for December 3, is poised to be the first that the U.S. military has carried out by firing squad since the Second World War.

"It will be livestreamed. Details will follow," the Pentagon official, speaking on condition of anonymity, said of the death sentence imposed on the U.S. Army psychiatrist who shot dead 13 people at Fort Hood in 2009.

Pentagon chief Pete Hegseth said in a video

Nidal Hasan

posted on X by official Pentagon accounts earlier on Thursday that Hasan is "going to get a firing squad of soldiers, as it should be, and we'll make sure that people are able to watch it, that it's public."

"People need to understand that... there's serious consequence for these types of things," he said.

The UN condemned on Friday the plan to livestream the execution, saying it would amount to torture.

"The livestreaming of an execution is tantamount to a public execution and would breach the absolute prohibition of torture," the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights said.

Mr. Hegseth noted that it would be the military's first firing squad execution since the Second World War – a reference to the case of Eddie Slovik, who was put to death for desertion in 1945.

"I kind of like the mentality we had in the Second World War, which was win, which was understand when the enemy attacks you, you need to stand your ground," he said.

The last U.S. military execution was carried out in 1961.

## Two million in Gaza face a grim winter without shelters: UN

**Agence France-Presse**
GENEVA

Virtually all of Gaza's two million population will go through winter without adequate shelter as the Palestinian territory enters a fourth year under heavy Israeli war restrictions, the United Nations said on Friday.

The International Organisation for Migration (IOM) said nearly 1.8 million people in the territory "are facing a fourth winter without adequate protection from rain, flooding and cold".

The UN agency called for international funding for humanitarian aid and for Israel to ease the "constraints" on the entry of critical supplies.

Tents sheltering displaced people in Gaza City. AP

More than half of all the tents and makeshift shelters are in poor condition and should be replaced, the IOM said. "With few alternatives available, many families are living in war-damaged buildings that pose serious risks to life."

## Ukraine's military says it hit 3 missile facilities in Russia

**Reuters**
KYIV

Ukraine's military said it hit three facilities involved in missile production across Russia overnight, including a factory in Tver region making missile components and a centre for disassembling intercontinental ballistic missiles in Nizhny Novgorod region.

In a statement on Telegram, Ukraine's General Staff said the Russian facility for "liquidation of intercontinental ballistic missiles" was hit to degrade Russia's ability to source explosives and rocket fuel.

Ukraine has been hitting Russian oil refining and military production facilities with a growing fleet of domestically produced drones, and sometimes with missiles.

The governor of Nizhny Novgorod region said that one serviceman was killed repelling the attack and drone debris caused "minimal" damage to infrastructure.

The governor of Tver region said on Friday morning a drone attack had caused a fire at a plant in Redkino, but that it was extinguished.

Meanwhile, Russian strikes killed three people and wounded at least eight across Ukraine on Friday, officials said, a day after a glide bomb killed 30 people at a bus station.

## Sri Lanka appeals to Saudi Arabia to overturn migrant worker's death penalty

**Meera Srinivasan**
COLOMBO

Sri Lanka is preparing to petition Saudi Arabia's Supreme Court to overturn a recent Court of Appeal ruling sentencing a migrant worker to death.

"We are working on an appeal and are hoping to file it today or tomorrow at the Supreme Court," President's Counsel Upul Kumararapperuma told *The Hindu* from Riyadh on Friday. He is part of a team of senior lawyers and officials from the public prosecutor's office sent by the Sri Lankan government to Saudi Arabia.

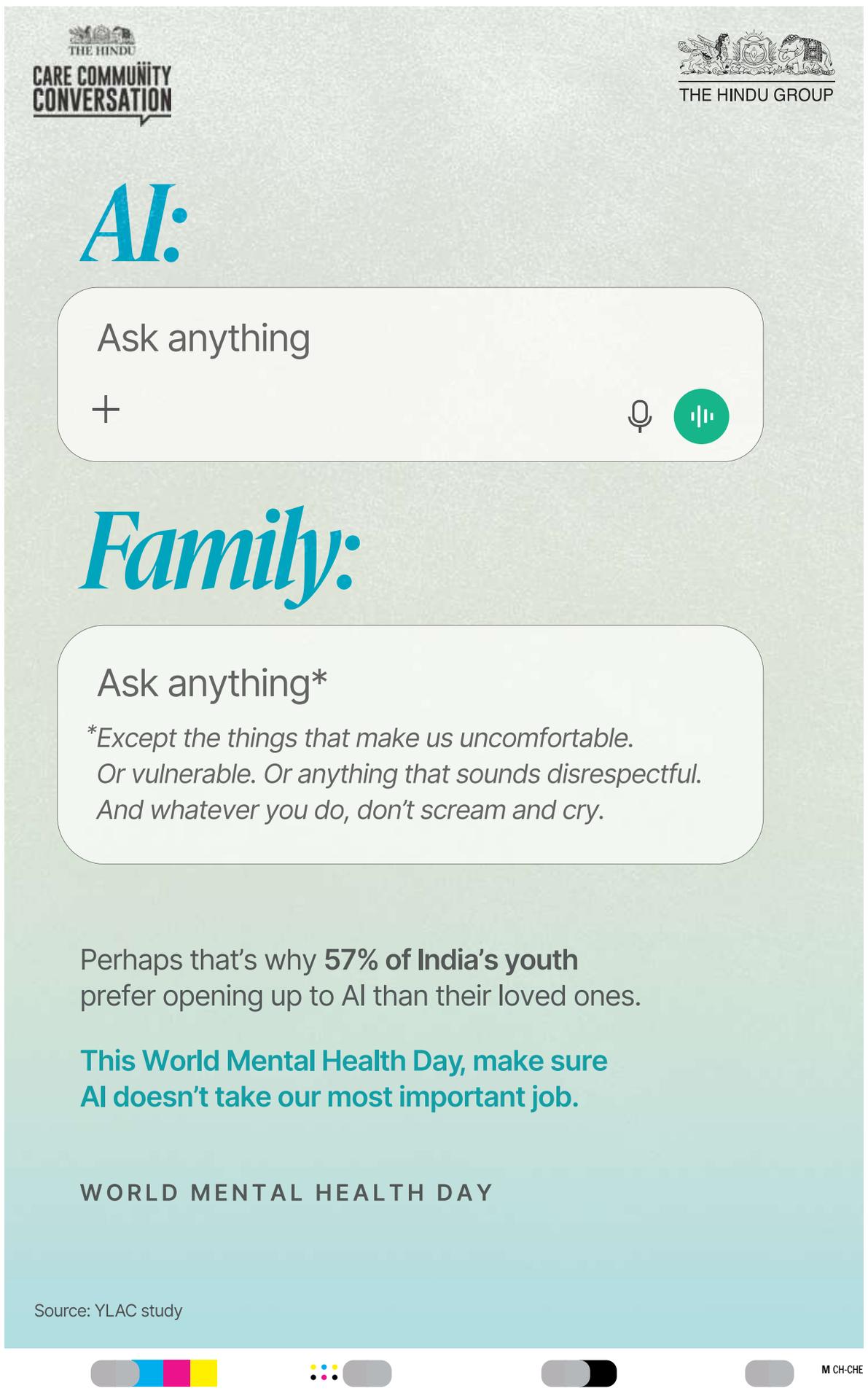
The case, which has brought concerns about freedom of expression, migrant workers' precarity, and the death penalty to the fore, stems from a social media comment posted in late June this year by Sivarasa Anojan, an engineer in his mid-twenties, employed in Saudi Arabia.

President Anura Kumara Dissanayake meeting Sivarasa Anojan's family in September in Colombo. PRESIDENTIAL MEDIA DIVISION

The incident occured around the annual pilgrimage to Kataragama or the Kathirgamam temple in southern Sri Lanka. According to local media reports, a Muslim man was filmed attacking a dog – named Subramani, after the temple's presiding deity – which had followed Kataragama pilgrims for hundreds of kilometres. The man, who was arrested on charges of animal cruelty, was subsequently granted bail but the video went viral on social media, provoking outrage.

Mr. Anojan too had weighed in with a comment referring to Prophet Muhammad. Although it was swiftly deleted and Mr. Anojan posted an apology, Saudi courts deemed it blasphemous, sentencing him to five year's imprisonment at first, and later increasing the punishment to death.

Separately, Amnesty International urged Saudi Arabia's authorities to "urgently overturn the death sentence" issued against Mr. Anojan.



BLITZKRIEG

## Samson equals Kohli's record for India's fastest fifty against Windies

K.R. DEEPAK

Sanju Samson equalled Virat Kohli's record for hitting India's fastest T20I fifty against the West Indies (21 balls). Samson's ninth T20I half-century was also his second-fastest after the 20-ball effort against Afghanistan last month. Quinton de Kock holds the record for the fastest T20I fifty (15b) against the Caribbean team.

DOUBLE BLOW

## Chapman and Foulkes ruled out of T20I series against Team India

FILE PHOTO

New Zealand's Mark Chapman, *in pic.*, and Zak Foulkes have been ruled out of the upcoming five-match T20I series against India. **The squad:** Santner (Capt.), Allen, Bracewell, Clarkson, Conway, Duffy, Ferguson, Henry, Jacobs, Jamieson, Milne, Mitchell, Phillips, Seifert, Smith, and Tickner.

FIRST BLOOD

## Farhan plays a captain's knock as Pakistan beats Lanka in opener

AFP

Sahibzada Farhan led from the front with a 53-ball 89 as Pakistan beat Sri Lanka by four wickets in the first T20I at Rawalpindi on Friday. **The scores:** Sri Lanka 182/8 in 20 overs (Udara 91, Naseem 3/36) lost to Pakistan 187/6 in 18.5 overs (Farhan 89, Sadaqat 50, Malinga 2/33, Theekshana 2/36). **Toss:** Lanka; **PoM:** Farhan.

TOUGH LOSS

## Sindhu goes down fighting to Intanon, bows out of Arctic Open

FILE PHOTO: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

P.V. Sindhu lost to Ratchanok Intanon in the quarterfinals of the Arctic Open in Vantaa, Finland. The 31-year-old slumped to an 11-21, 21-19, 18-21 defeat, stretching Intanon's head-to-head record to 11-4. The two had last met in the Indonesia Masters in 2022, where the Thai shuttler had won 21-12, 21-10.

# Hope, Rutherford dazzle as West Indies draws level

The former hits an unbeaten 102 off just 45 deliveries while the latter smashes a 37-ball 84 as the Men in Maroon pull off their highest chase in the shortest format; Samson's knock goes in vain

WI IN INDIA

**Sankar Narayanan E.H.**
RANCHI

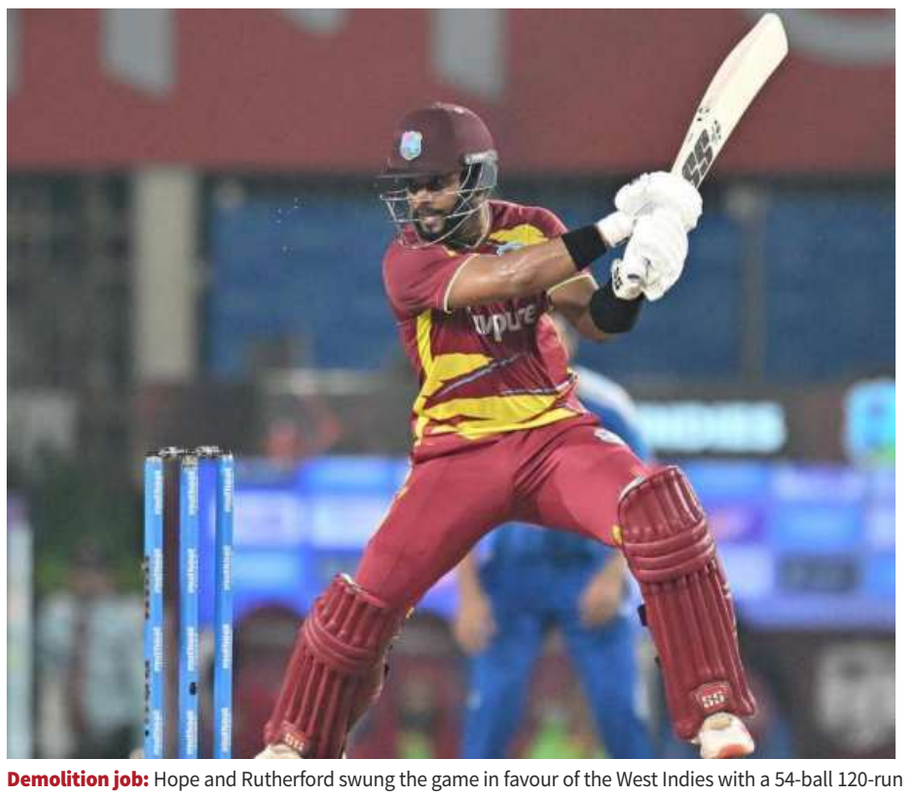
The Indian juggernaut has finally been halted.

Chasing may be the preferred template in modern T20Is, but not when you have to hunt down 250. That was the tall order in front of the West Indies at the JSCA Stadium here on Friday.

Conventional wisdom would've predicted an easy win for the defending team, but not against a marauding West Indian batting line-up.

The Men in Maroon made light work of what looked like an insurmountable task, gunning down the target in 18.3 overs and pulling off a stunning six-wicket victory in the second T20I.

After Mayank Yadav's fiery opening burst (three for 36), Shai Hope (102 n.o., 45b, 6x4, 9x6) and Sherfane Rutherford (84, 37b, 7x4, 7x6) kept up with the asking rate, and then some.



**Demolition job:** Hope and Rutherford swung the game in favour of the West Indies with a 54-ball 120-run stand for the fourth wicket. K.R. DEEPAK

Kuldeep Yadav could have removed Rutherford at the halfway stage had Mayank held on to a regulation catch. The left-arm wrist-spinner eventually got his man when the southpaw was caught behind in the 15th over.

At that point, after the breathtaking 120-run stand off 54 deliveries, West Indies still needed 72 off 35 balls.

Hope and Romario Shepherd (34 n.o., 13b, 3x4, 3x6) then went on to seal a memorable win.

The final six that Hope hit off Axar Patel not only brought up his century but also signalled West Indies' highest successful run chase in T20Is.

Earlier, the Indian willow-wielders sent the visitors on a leather hunt to amass 249 for five, with Sanju Samson (82, 41b, 9x4, 4x6) being the protagonist.

Kamil Pooran dropping a straightforward catch unshackled Samson, who was batting on six.

After getting smashed off a free-hit right after the lost opportunity, Akeal Hosein bore the brunt of Samson's brilliant strokeplay.

Though Samson's trigger movement was almost always to the leg-side, the shots he hit covered the entire ground. Roston Chase – who had earlier dismissed Abhishek Sharma – castled Ishan Kishan (43, 22b, 6x4, 2x6) to break the 97-run stand before removing another left-hander, No. 4 Shivam Dube.

India lost momentum as well as Samson, who holed out to Kamil at third-man off Springer.

Shreyas Iyer (40, 18b, 3x4, 3x6) and Tilak Varma (44 n.o., 18b, 3x4, 3x6), however, built on the foundation.

Tilak was particularly ruthless against Springer after getting a life off a no-ball. Springer's 23-run 20th over took India to 249, which proved nowhere near enough once Hope's men took strike.

SCOREBOARD

**INDIA**
Abhishek Sharma c Motie b Chase 20 *(12b, 2x4, 1x6)*, Sanju Samson c Kamil b Springer 82 *(41b, 9x4, 4x6)*, Ishan Kishan b Chase 43 *(22b, 6x4, 2x6)*, Shivam Dube b Chase 7 (*10b, 1x4*), Shreyas Iyer c Hetmyer b Springer 40 *(18b, 3x4, 3x6)*, Tilak Varma (not out) 44 (*18b, 3x4, 3x6*), Naman Dhir (not out) 4 (*1b, 1x4*); Extras (lb-1, nb-2, w-6): 9; Total (for five wkts. in 20 overs): 249.

**FALL OF WICKETS**
1-42 (Abhishek, 3.6 overs), 2-139 (Kishan, 11.1), 3-158 (Dube, 13.3), 4-162 (Samson, 14.3), 5-245 (Shreyas, 19.5).

**WEST INDIES BOWLING**
Akeal 3-0-46-0, Shepherd 3.4-0-47-0, Chase 4-0-24-3, Motie 2-0-21-0, Shamar 3-0-39-0, Springer 4-0-64-2, Powell 0.2-0-7-0.

**WEST INDIES**
Shai Hope (not out) 102 (*45b, 6x4, 9x6*), Kamil Pooran c sub (Bishnoi) b Mayank 4 (*2b, 1x4*), Shimron Hetmyer b Mayank 0 (*1b*), Rovman Powell b Mayank 24 (*13b, 4x4, 1x6*), Sherfane Rutherford c Samson b Kuldeep 84 (*37b, 7x4, 7x6*), Romario Shepherd (not out) 34 (*13b, 3x4, 3x6*); Extras (*w-4*) 4; Total (for four wkts. in 18.3 overs): 252.

**FALL OF WICKETS**
1-5 (Kamil, 0.3), 2-5 (Hetmyer 0.4), 3-58 (Powell, 5.1), 4-178 (Rutherford, 14.1).

**INDIA BOWLING**
Mayank 3-0-36-3, Arshdeep 4-0-45-0, Axar 3.3-0-63-0, Dube 2-0-30-0, Kuldeep 4-0-53-1, Dhir 2-0-25-0.

**Toss:** West Indies; **PoM:** Hope.

West Indies won by six wickets with nine balls remaining to level the five-match series 1-1.

**Third T201: October 11,** Indore, 7 p.m.

## Pacers are going to play a big role: Ferguson

**S. Dipak Ragav**

Lockie Ferguson expects pacers to play a key role in the limited overs contests during India's upcoming tour of New Zealand. The Men in Blue will play the Black Caps in five T20 Internationals starting October 22, followed by as many ODIs.

"I like to think that they (fast bowlers) are going to play a big part in the series. In New Zealand, this time of year, it's a bit cooler at night, and I'm not sure how the ball will perform off the wicket, whether there's dew, the wicket's a bit soft, or we get some swing. So it's always nice to see bowlers showing their skills off with the white ball," said Ferguson during a media interaction on Friday.

On New Zealand picking a pace-heavy squad, Ferguson said the team has the benefit of good all-rounders, which lets it play an extra quick.

"We're blessed that we've got pretty fantastic spin bowling all-rounders, which allow us to play more fast bowlers. So it depends, sort of year to year, on your squad balance and the players available. But look, if I took a seat in the stands and watched the New Zealand's fast-bowling depth we have at the moment, it's pretty exciting. And you get that extra balance. And if you bowl hard into the wicket, you can get rewards," said the 35-year-old.

Ferguson. FILE PHOTO: K.R. DEEPAK

On the buzz surrounding Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, Ferguson felt that it will be a good challenge for the youngster.

"He's obviously a great talent. We've spoken about him a lot. He's fairly got a lot of praise because of how well he's done. He's a young lad, and he's got a long career ahead of him. It's exciting to see young stars coming through as teenagers and doing well on the world stage. From the New Zealand public's point of view, I imagine they're excited to see that talent live in person."

"I'm sure he'll face some challenges, but it's going to be an exciting series," added Ferguson.

*(Watch India's tour of New Zealand, starting October 22, live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV).*

## Comeback man Hoblidhar storms to victory in 100m

ATHLETICS

**Uthra Ganesan**
NEW DELHI

Last year, Manikanta Hoblidhar became the first Indian man to go under 10.20 seconds in the 100m, setting a new national record and throwing down the gauntlet for the rest of the sprinters.

Cut to March this year and the Karnataka man, hoping to add international success to his growing list of achievements on the domestic circuit, broke down. A Grade-2 hamstring tear during the National relay championships led to the revelation of a blood clot in his tendons as well, throwing his entire year into disarray. He missed the Commonwealth and Asian Games and the World Relays but most importantly, he was left far behind on the track.

On Friday, the 24-year-old took the first steps back to national reckoning, clocking 10.25 seconds to win the 65th National Open Athletics Championships at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium here.

"I had targeted better timing here but an upset stomach since last night didn't help. I also slowed towards the end because after such a long break, you are a little cautious. My biggest regret, however, is that my injury also affected the relay team and India's chances of a medal. But now the body is fine and my aim is to clock 10.00 in the coming season," Hoblidhar said, adding that there was still work to be done before gaining optimum fitness ahead of the next season. Lalu Prasad Bhoi was second in 10.43s and Lukik Melge 3rd (10.45s).

**Fast and furious:** Hoblidhar marked his return to competitive action with an impressive run.
SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

In the women's section, Aichi-Nagoya bronze medalist and national record holder Manpreet Kaur was the only shot-putter to cross the 17m mark, taking the top spot with a best throw of 17.07m. The 21-year-old Anjli, in her first national level event, stunned the field including favourite Priya Mohan to clock a personal best of 53.37s in the 400m.

Moumita Mandal, also returning from an injury layoff, topped the heat before taking the 100m hurdles in 13.48 seconds. However, Servin Sebastian, leading all the way, was pushed to fourth spot in the racewalk half marathon in the morning session after being adjudged of technical violation and penalized two minutes for loss of contact.

**The results (Day Two): Men: 100m:** 1. Manikanta Hoblidhar (Kar, 10.25s), 2. Lalu Prasad Bhoi (RSPB, 10.43s), 3. Laukik Melge (SSCB, 10.45s); **400m:** 1. Akash Raj (TN, 46.24s), 2. Vikrant Panchal (RSPB, 46.26s), 3. Mijo Chacko Kurian (SSCB, 46.45s); **1500m:** 1. Arjun Waskale (RSPB, 3:43.04), 2. Shivam Sharma (RSPB, 3:43.12), 3. Rahul Baloda (SSCB, 3:43.14); **110mH:** 1. Muhd. Lazan VK (SSCB, 13.70s), 2. A. Graceson Jeeva (SSCB, 13.85s), 3. Manav R. (RSPB, 13.97s); **21km race walk:** 1. Suraj Panwar (Utk, 1:30.48), 2. Deepak Gurjar (Del, 1:30.55), 3. Vishvendra Singh (MP, 1:31.32); **Discus throw:** 1. Yamandeep Sharma (RSPB, 40.93m), 2. Neeraj Yadav (Raj, 37.95m), 3. Manoj Kumar R. (TN, 36.67m); **Triple Jump:** 1. Sebastian V.S. (SSCB, 16.54m), 2. Dinesh V (TN, 16.33m), 3. Mohanraj J (TN, 16.29m); **Decathlon:** 1. Stalin Joes S (SSCB, 689 pts), 2. Gokul K.R. (Ker, 673 pts), 3. Jinoy Jayan (ONGC, 657 pts).

**Women: 400m:** 1. Anjli (Har, 53.37s), 2. Priya Mohan (Kar, 53.55s), 3. Priya Thakur (HP, 53.56s); **1500m:** 1. Ankita Dhyani (RSPB, 4:13.18), 2. Lili Das (RSPB, 4:19.05), 3. Komal Jagdale (RSPB, 3. 4:22.67); **100mH:** 1. Moumita Mondal (RSPB, 13.48s), 2. Anjali C (AIPSCB, 13.50s), 3. Nandhini K (TN, 13.53s); **21km race walk:** 1. Mokavi Muthurathinam (RSPB, 1:45.39), 2. Munita Prajapati (RSPB, 1:45.43), 3. Bhawna Jat (RSPB, 1:46.47); **Shot Put:** 1. Manpreet Kaur (RSPB, 17.07m), 2. Srishti Vig (Del, 16.11m), 3. Rekha (RSPB, 15.72m).

**4x100m mixed:** 1. RSPB (42.82s), 2. Delhi (43.75s), 3. Haryana (43.97s).

## Chiefs, Yodhas post wins; Royals stumble

APL

**Anirudh Velamuri**
HYDERABAD

Chola Chiefs defeated Kakatiya Knights 6-2 to register its first win of Archery Premier League season-2 at the People's Plaza here on Friday. Colombia's Alejandra Usquiano, on her APL debut, shot all eight arrows for 10s, with the Chiefs' tactical tweak paying off against Nico Wiener's Knights.

Chiefs' tactic of having their compound archers Rishabh Yadav and Usquiano shoot both their arrows in the first half helped start the contest with a perfect half of 40. Knights, in the end, couldn't recover from the scoreboard pressure.

While the compound archers were on fire, Chiefs' recurve stars Deepika Kumari and Marcus D'Almeida also joined the party to help it clinch the final set 79-76 and the match.

In the second match, Chero Archers got the better of Rajputana Royals. Royals took the first set but couldn't sustain the momentum. Archers' move to substitute in Atanu Das for Yashdeep Bhoge ahead of the second set, proved to be a masterstroke as he and Casey Kaufhold helped the team come from behind to win 6-2.

Later, Prithviraj Yodhas registered its first win, beating Mighty Marathas 6-2. Like Royals before them, Marathas began well but couldn't build on it.

Abhishek Verma-led Yodhas were a whisker away from a perfect 80 in the third set, before the eighth arrow from Matias Grande slipped into the nine zone. But they had done enough by then to get a leg up on Marathas.

**The results: Chola Chiefs bt Kakatiya Knights 6-2** (74-76, 70-76, 76-70, 79-76).
**Rajputana Royals lost to Chero Archers 2-6** (78-69, 66-78, 77-78, 72-78).
**Mighty Marathas lost to Prithviraj Yodhas 2-6** (73-71, 75-76, 77-79, 74-76).

**On target:** Atanu did the star turn for the Archers. APL

## INBRIEF

### Verstappen takes pole position for sprint race

Max Verstappen scorched to Singapore GP sprint race pole position in his Red Bull after a thrilling qualifying session on Friday.

### Afghanistan fights back after a good start by Bangladesh

Afghanistan hit back to restrict Bangladesh to 317 for eight on the opening day of the one-off Test in Abu Dhabi on Friday.

**The scores:** Bangladesh 317/8 in 84 overs (Shadman Islam 67, Tanzid Hasan 83, Litton Das 53) vs. Afghanistan.

### Manav-Manush lose in WTT China Smash semifinals

India's Manav Thakkar and Manush Shah lost 8-11, 6-11, 3-11 to South Korea's Lim Jonghoon and Oh Junsung in the men's doubles semifinals of the WTT China Smash in Beijing on Friday.

### Hyderabad races on October 13 cancelled

The Stewards of the Hyderabad Race Club have resolved to cancel the races scheduled for Tuesday (Oct. 13), due to paucity of acceptors.

# Australia-A seals the series with facile win

Konstas and Philippe lay the foundation with a 101-run stand before Johnson dashes the host's hopes; Patidar's knock goes in vain

AUSTRALIA-A IN INDIA

**Anish Pathiyil**
PUDUCHERRY

Rajat Patidar's solo fight went in vain again as India-A lost the second one-dayer to Australia-A by 69 runs at the Cricket Association Pondicherry Siechem Ground on Friday.

The Madhya Pradesh batter (67, 82b, 3x4, 1x6) held firm through the middle overs to keep the host in contention in the chase of 276, but once he fell, the challenge withered away. India-A was eventually bowled out for 206, handing Australia-A an unassailable 2-0 lead.

After choosing to bat in the morning, the away team's brisk start through Mitchell Owen was cut short by a smart slower ball from Yash Thakur. Sam Konstas and Josh Philippe manipulated the field placements to pick up boundaries fairly regularly in a 101-run second-wicket partnership. But, the older ball proved difficult to score off, and Australia-A folded for 275 off the penultimate delivery.

If brute pace dismissed the India-A openers in the first one-dayer, the lack of it proved fatal this time round. Skipper Ruturaj Gaikwad treated the fans, who braved the sun to fill the stands, to three sumptuous cover drives before a diving catch at deep backward point brought his innings to a sudden halt.

**Key contribution:** Konstas showed both sides of his game. CAP

With three batters back in the hut in the first PowerPlay, it was left to Patidar to stitch crucial partnerships. But he mistimed a pull shot off left-arm pacer Spencer Johnson (three for 35) straight to deep square leg and there ended India-A's hopes.

**The scores:**
Australia-A 275 in 49.5 overs (Sam Konstas 67, Josh Philippe 58) bt India-A 206 in 45.2 overs (Rajat Patidar 67). **Toss:** Australia-A. **PoM:** Johnson.

# India's top-tier league set for a new chapter

ISL

**Ashwin Achal**
BENGALURU

The Indian Super League begins a new chapter on Saturday, with clubs taking charge of the ISL's commercial future and the competition returning to a full-fledged home-and-away format.

The shift marks a departure from the ISL's previous structure. While the All India Football Federation will retain administrative control and oversee key operational aspects, the clubs will hold the commercial rights, giving them a greater stake in shaping the league's future. The change brings both opportunity and responsibility. The clubs' ability to generate revenue and create a compelling matchday experience will have a direct bearing on their financial health.

However, the build-up has been marked by uncertainty, as was the case last year. The announcement of the fixture list was delayed, as was the signing of a new broadcast deal. Jamshedpur FC, owned by Tata Steel, and Diamond Harbour FC both withdrew.

For the 13 clubs that remain, success – both financial and sporting – will depend on what happens on the pitch. Entertaining football and competitive contests will be crucial to attracting new followers and retaining existing ones.

**Still going strong:** The experience of talisman Sunil Chhetri will come in handy for BFC. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

**Double round-robin**

The return to a double round-robin format should help. After a curtailed, single-leg campaign last time, the teams will face each other home and away, restoring the rhythm of a conventional league season. The longer schedule will test squad depth, fitness and consistency while giving coaches more scope for tactical adjustments.

The supporters, meanwhile, will play a crucial role in determining whether the reset succeeds.

Despite the uncertainty that surrounded Indian football last season, strong local following helped clubs such as Mohun Bagan Super Giant, East Bengal FC and Bengaluru FC keep interest in the stands.

As the season unfolds, all stakeholders will hope that a sustainable model takes shape.

Saturday's double-header marks the beginning of that test and another attempt by the ISL to establish a stable footing.

**Saturday's matches:**
Bengaluru FC vs. SC Delhi (Bengaluru, 5 p.m.); FC Goa vs. Chennaiyin FC (Margao, 7.30 p.m.).

## AROUND THE CITY

### Jharkhand u-19 girls defeat Tamil Nadu

Jharkhand scripted a seven-wicket victory over Tamil Nadu in the BCCI Women's u-19 Trophy Elite Group D match at the Alur Cricket Stadium-II in Bengaluru.

**The scores:**
Tamil Nadu 109/3 in 16 overs (K. Hashini 56 n.o.) lost to Jharkhand 110/3 in 13.5 overs (Gurleen Kaur 31). Match reduced to 16 overs per side.

### BBL opener ticket sales begin today

Online ticket sales (phase-I) for the Big Bash League (BBL) opening match between Melbourne Renegades and Perth Scorchers, scheduled to be held at the MAC Stadium on December 12, will begin at noon on Saturday through the District by Zomato mobile application and its official website, district.in.

No tickets will be sold at the venue or through box office counters.

Tickets purchased from other platforms, websites or individuals will be at the buyer's own risk.

**Ticket prices:**
**Sale details (read as stands, price):** F- Lower, ₹1000; I/J/K lower, ₹2500; I/J/K upper, ₹2000; KMK Terrace, ₹3500; C Hospitality (AC), ₹6000.

### Venkatesh scalps six

P. Venkatesh's six for six helped Chrompet CC bundle out Mani Memorial for just 25 and register a 92-run win in a second division 'A' Zone match of the Chengalpattu DCA league recently.

Yashvanth (Little Hearts, 117 n.o.).

Venkatesh (Chrompet, 6/6).

**The scores:**
**I-div:** SKM 154 in 31.4 overs (S. Vigneshwaran 40, Kesav Kumar 32, U. Mukilesh 3/7) lost to Vijay 158/2 in 24.1 overs (Jagadeesh 48, S. Ganesh 92).
Adambakkam 136 in 36.4 overs (Bhuvaneshwar 34, Prasidh Ram 30, Bharath 4/18) lost to Spring Field 137/4 in 26.2 overs (F. Haashid Farhaan 62).
**II-A:** Leo 107 in 23.5 overs (Srikrishna 4/26) lost to Asiatic 108/7 in 26.2 overs (Aravindraj 34); Chrompet 117 in 28.2 Overs (C. Praveen 77, K.S. Pradeep Kumar 3/8, I. Yuvaraj 4/3) bt Mani Memorial 25 in 7.6 overs (C. Praveen 4/15, Ventakesh 6/6).
Selvaganapathy 193/6 30 overs (Salman Khan 67, Sanjay 3/42) bt Gopalakrishnan Memorial 169 in 29.5 overs (Praveen 56, M. Yusuf 38, Sanjay Patel 3/28, Salman 3/19).
Leo 100 in 28.3 overs (Shravan 4/13) lost to Gopalakrishnan Memorial 103/4 in 22.3 overs (B. Dhanush 34 n.o.).
Bharath 202/5 in 30 overs (Porco Ela 44, Mahaendradevan 34, N. Rakshan 66 n.o.) lost to Little Hearts 203/3 in 29.1 overs (Dhiraj 35, Yashvant 117 n.o.).
**II-B:** GE T&D 135/9 in 30 overs lost to KRC 140/4 in 26.3 Overs (Thejeswar Ganesh 48, R. Akash 38).
Prahlad 108 in 29.3 overs (R.M. Saikanna Kanagasabai 32, Vaddinei Dharma Rao 4/5) lost to Phoenix 110/4 in 18 Overs (Laiq Aariz 39 n.o.).
CBI 90 in 28.5 overs (Koushik Ram 3/13) lost to KRC 94/2 in 7.4 overs (Vinoth 53).
M.G. Bhavanarayanan Memorial 116 in 27.2 overs (R. Siddharth 3/14) lost to Prahlad 117/6 in 26.1 overs.
GE T&D 196/5 in overs (Periyasamy 54, Amit Sagar Gowda 67 n.o.) bt Friend XI 109 in 23 overs (Mithilesh 42, B. Ashwin 4/24).

### GHSS-A (Pudur) emerges champion

GHSS-A (Pudur) crushed Nellai Nadar MHSS by nine wickets and clinched the CM Trophy Chennai District inter-school T10 tournament on Friday.

**The scores (final):**
Nellai Nadar MHSS (Kottivakkam) 54/8 in 10 overs lost to GHSS-A (Pudur) 56/1 in 8.3 overs.

### M.O.P. Vaishnav wins title

M.O.P. Vaishnav College for Women thrashed Dr. MGR Janaki Arts & Science College 19-7 and emerged champion in the University of Madras A-zone handball tournament on Friday.

**The results: Winner:**
M.O.P. Vaishnav; **runner-up**: Dr. MGR Janaki Arts & Science; **third:** Sri Sankara Arts & Science College.

### ENGAGEMENTS

**Cricket:** TNCA league, V-A, Triplicane RC vs GTUC, 9.30 a.m.; DCAC league, I div., Vijay vs Venugopal (Fomra-A); Jai vs Syndicate, Nanganallur (Fomra-B), 9.30 a.m.; II-A, Little Heart vs Chrompet (8 a.m.); Shan vs Leo (1 p.m.), SRMIST.

# Nominations for Indian Turf Invitation Cup Weekend races received

Following are the nominations for the Indian Turf Invitation Cup Weekend races to be held on Oct. 24 and 25 at Mysore Race Club (MyRC).

**ZAVARAY POONAWALLA INDIAN TURF INVITATION CUP (GR. 1):**
**RCTC:** Arrived, Superstar and Duke Of Tuscany. **RESERVE:** Gold Empire.
**RWITC:** Fynbos, Sovereign King and Dream Alliance.
**BTC:** Prokofiev, Ranquelino and Redefined. **RESERVES:** Zuccaro, Fynbos, Duke Of Tuscany and Elysium.
**HRC:** Zuccaro, Pyrite and Prokofiev. **RESERVES:** Dyf, Red Bishop, Matisse and Perception.
**MYRC:** Miracle Star, Red Bishop and Matisse. **RESERVE:** Prokofiev.

**MAJ. P.K. MEHRA MEMORIAL SUPER MILE CUP (GR. 1):** **RCTC:** Heart, Arrived and Duke Of Tuscany. **RESERVES:** Casteel and Mahler.
**RWITC:** Kavya, Sovereign King and Kings Gambit. **RESERVES:** Pride's Prince, Once You Go Black, The Milenium Force, Chagall and Namiri.
**BTC:** Mayne Magic, Alfonsine and Shamrock. **RESERVES:** Redefined, Galahad, African Gold, Money Bags, Prokofiev, Promiseofthefuture, Echoes Of Time and Kings Gambit.
**HRC:** Nonpariel, Hanumanmahabala and Perception. **RESERVES:** Echoes Of Time and Truth.
**MYRC:** Echoes Of Time, Money Bags and Prokifiev. **RESERVES:** Once You Go Black, Pride's Prince and Shamrock.

**ZAVARAY POONAWALLA SPRINTERS' CUP (GR. 1):** **RCTC:** Black Eagle and Pantazi.
**RWITC:** Time And Tide, Encino and Miss American Pie. **RESERVES:** Dream Seller and Fourth Wing.
**BTC:** Money Bags, Rieko and Masato. **RESERVES:** Dream Seller, Star Glory, Shamrock, Echoes Of Time, Crown Drive and Efficacy. **HRC:** Gachchhatu and Echoes Of Time.
**MYRC:** Shamrock, Crown Drive and Star Glory. **RESERVES:** Money Bags and Echoes Of Time.

**ZAVARAY POONAWALLA STAYERS' CUP (GR. 1):** **RCTC:** Gold Empire, Arrived and Duke Of Tuscany. **RESERVE:** Superstar.
**RWITC:** Dream Alliance, Chagall and Caccini. **BTC:** Youremanorborne, Victor Hugo and Moon Star. **RESERVES:** Superstar and Duke Of Tuscany.
**HRC:** Pyrite, Dyf and Ramiel. **RESERVES:** Victor Hugo and Red Bishop.
**MYRC:** Moon Star, Red Bishop and Natural Diamond.

**Triumphant:** Men's doubles winners Manish and Nitin and women's doubles champions Samhitha and Lakshmi.

# Nitin stuns top seed Manish to reach final

**Press Trust of India**
NEW DELHI

Third seed Nitin Kumar Sinha stunned defending champion and top seed Manish Sureshkumar 6-7 (6), 6-3, 6-1 to reach the men's singles final of the 31st Fenesta Open National tennis championship here on Friday.

Nitin prevailed after a three-hour battle against his regular doubles partner to set up a title clash against sixth seed Maan Kesharwani. Nitin and Manish later teamed up to win the doubles title, beating Rohith Gobinath and Srikar Doni 6-3, 6-2.

**The results: Men: Semifinals:** Nitin Kumar Sinha bt Manish Sureshkumar 6-7(6), 6-3, 6-1; Maan Kesharwani bt Suraj Prabodh 6-3, 7-5.
**Doubles: Final:** Nitin & Manish bt Rohith Gobinath & Srikar Doni 6-3, 6-2.
**Women: Semifinals:** Vaidehee Chaudhari bt Sonal Patil 6-3, 6-1; Shruti Ahlawat bt Soha Sadiq 6-0, 6-1.
**Doubles:** Lakshmi Arunkumar & Samhitha Chamarthi bt Aishwarya Jadhav & Aakruti Sonkusare 5-7, 6-1, [10-5].
**Under 18: Boys: Semifinals:** Om Ramesh Patel bt Yashwin Dahiya 6-7(3), 6-1, 7-5; Ribhav Saroha bt Srikar Doni 6-3, 6-2.
**Doubles: Final:** Praneel Sharma & Aditya Mor bt Raghav Sarode and Om Ramesh Patel 6-2, 6-1.
**Girls: Doubles: Final:** Sanmitha Harini & Savitha Bhuvaneswaran bt Sree Syleswari Velmanikandan & Riddhi Shinde 6-4, 7-5.

# Renshaw holds firm

**Associated Press**
DURBAN

Bad light stopped play 24.4 overs early with Australia struggling at 187 for six on day one of the first Test against South Africa at the Kingsmead Oval in Durban on Friday. Matt Renshaw was unbeaten on 46.

**The scores:**
Australia 187/6 in 65.2 overs (Renshaw 46 batting) vs. South Africa. **Toss:** Australia.

### LIVE TELECAST

**Afghanistan vs Bangladesh:** Only Test, day 2, FanCode, 11 a.m.
**South Africa vs Australia:** First Test, Day 2, Eurosport & FanCode, 1 p.m.
**Formula One:** Singapore GP (Sprint Race), F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 2.30 p.m.; qualifying, 6.30 p.m.
**Premier League:** SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 5, 7.30 & 10 p.m.
**LaLiga:** FanCode, 5.30, 7.45, 10 p.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Sunday)
**Serie A**: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 6.30, 9.30 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Sunday)
**Bundesliga:** Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 7 & 10 p.m.

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GETTY IMAGES

# Pageant or pillar: what exactly is the Laver Cup?

Where does the tournament, modelled on golf's Ryder Cup, stand in tennis? What does it bring to the sport? And for how long will its carefully engineered success endure?

**N. Sudarshan**

Rod Laver in tennis is like Don Bradman in cricket. The famed left-hander is the only player to have achieved the Grand Slam – the herculean feat of winning all four Majors in a single year – twice. It's like Bradman's astronomical average of 99.94, a measure of greatness unlikely to be emulated or surpassed in a million years.

In 2017, when the inaugural Laver Cup was held in Prague, it seemed like the perfect honour for the legendary Aussie. Modelled on golf's Ryder Cup, the biennial competition with a 100-year history that pits Europe against the United States of America, the Laver Cup broadened the scope – in line with tennis' global footprint – to bring Europe face to face with the World.

## Federer's brainchild

That the tournament was the brainchild of Roger Federer, the winner of 20 Slam titles, gave it enormous legitimacy. The elegant Swiss has often been spoken of as the 'GOAT' (Greatest of All Time), and for him to celebrate and immortalise Laver was the ultimate acknowledgement of who stood at the sport's zenith.

**There is no question that the Laver Cup is of the stars, by the stars and for the stars**

Nine years since that festive September weekend, where does the Laver Cup stand and what does it bring to tennis? Has the association with two of tennis' greatest champions helped it acquire an exalted status?

At the outset, it has all the ingredients that make any modern-day sporting extravaganza tick – participation from the elite (the three highest-ranked players from each region are automatic picks); eye-popping prize money (appearance fee and a $250,000 bonanza for each of the six players in the winning team); a weekend window without competing big-ticket competitions in a calendar that is bursting at the seams.

For the first seven editions, Europe and World were captained by icons Bjorn Borg and John McEnroe, and saw wholesome participation from Federer, Rafael Nadal, Novak Djokovic and Andy Murray, who collectively won an astonishing 69 Majors from 2003 to 2023. Since then, the captaincy has moved on to Yannick Noah and Andre Agassi, and the cream of the present era, led by the irresistible Carlos Alcaraz, has embraced it too.

If the signature black tennis court makes the Laver Cup a tournament apart, the concert-like setting with dark-arena lighting imparts a posh, cinematic look. It showcases both singles and doubles, and has adopted a format that ensures that the tie is alive on all three days.

It helps that tennis, one of the foremost individual sports, has incrementally warmed to team events, ensuring that the idea of the collective isn't limited to just the more-than-a-century-old Davis Cup.

The sense of camaraderie championships like the United Cup – the season-opening joint-venture between ATP, WTA and Tennis Australia – and the Laver Cup evoke, and the tactical back and forth between a star-studded bench and players on court, have made for great viewing.

"I never cared more than winning this one," proclaimed World No. 22 Alexander Bublik, who played the 2026 Laver Cup in London two weeks ago. "I never cared as much in a quarterfinal of a Slam than the doubles that I played [here]."

That Federer brought the curtains down on his storied career at a Laver Cup doubles fixture in 2022 alongside Nadal says it all. Federer and Nadal faced each other 40 times in one of tennis' greatest rivalries. But little would anyone have imagined that their final act would be one of brotherhood, sitting side by side, holding each other's hands, and sobbing uncontrollably.

## Part organic, part pretentious

Yet, for all the grandeur and the theatre, there is an unmistakable feeling that the Laver Cup is straddling the division between a tennis exhibition and a hard-nosed competition. Part of the bonhomie appears organic, but it is also pretentious.

Davis Cup, tennis' premier team championship, is replete with tales of polar opposites featuring in the team for a common cause. The most high-profile example is of the United States team that reached the final in 1984 under the captaincy of Arthur Ashe wherein McEnroe and Jimmy Connors went the whole campaign without speaking to each other.

In contrast, the Laver Cup looks like a pageant. "Players talk in a more friendly way," Casper Ruud told *The Athletic* in 2024. "You can actually get to know your competitors. Daniil [Medvedev] is a father and we can talk about his family and how it is to be a father. Sometimes I forget that we are normal people as well."

There are contradictions galore. The Laver Cup and men's professional tennis' governing body ATP have been partners since 2019, even allowing matches at the event to be counted in players' head-to-head records. But without any ranking points, the Laver Cup is also uncoupled from the pulls and pressures of the rest of the Tour. The grant of official status is in itself debatable, for matches in the Laver Cup aren't full-fledged contests, with the third set just a 10-point tie-breaker.

The scoring system – one point for a win on Friday, two on Saturday, and three on Sunday, with 13 required to lift the trophy – is a masterclass in manufacturing stakes.

When Federer was still an active member of the Tour, there persisted an awkward situation where a player expected to be treated on par with the others by the ATP had a business relationship with that very body. Tennis Australia, which conducts the Australian Open, was one of the original investors in the Laver Cup, another potential conflict of interest involving Federer.

There is no question that the Laver Cup is of the stars, by the stars and for the stars. Will this continue as the tennis world transitions from the era of Federer, Nadal and Djokovic to that of Alcaraz, Jannik Sinner and Alexander Zverev?

Alcaraz is no doubt a big draw, as seen in the way he has electrified the setting in the past three editions. But Sinner hasn't befriended the tournament yet, and but for Zverev's ascent this year, the tennis universe outside of Alcaraz and Sinner has seemed hollow.

**For all the grandeur and theatre, there is an unmistakable feeling that the Laver Cup is straddling the division between exhibition and hard-nosed competition**

It is also a question of sporting purity. The Ryder Cup famously doesn't award prize money, and still Rory McIlroy, the six-time Major winner, once proudly said that he would "personally pay for the privilege to play".

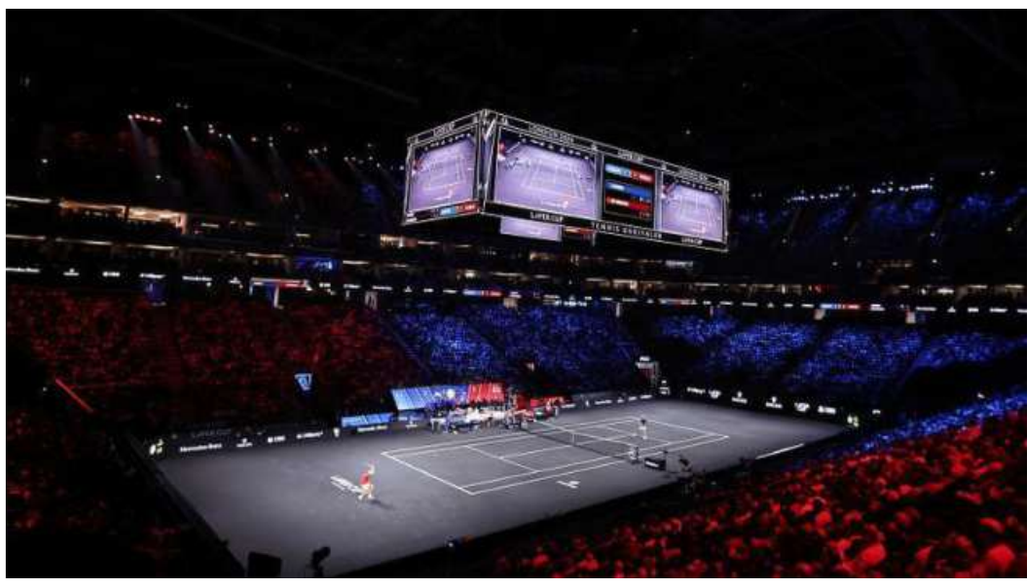
"We'll never get rid of that gap [with the Ryder Cup]," Tony Godsick, Federer's long-standing agent who co-founded the Laver Cup, told *The Athletic* in 2024. "We invest in the brand for the players, for the sponsors, for the fans, for the media."

## Survival of the fittest

The Laver Cup's aspirational zeal has taken root at a time when tennis governance is splintered. With all four Grand Slams, and governing bodies in ATP, WTA and World Tennis, each having a product to shoehorn into a finite calendar, it is about the survival of the fittest.

"There could be too many other tennis events, but this one is working," insisted Godsick. "We have sold-out crowds, the biggest captains, the best sponsors. Every player loves to play. So the question is: Is there too much Laver Cup? No. I think there is not enough Laver Cup."

Laver was – and is – a man of quiet confidence. The Laver Cup is evidently not. The tournament's success has been carefully engineered. But for how long?



## STACKING UP

### ATP Men's Top 15

| # | Player | Age | Points | Events |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Jannik Sinner | 25 | 11,000 | 16 |
| 2 | Alexander Zverev | 29 | 9,720 | 20 |
| 3 | Carlos Alcaraz | 23 | 5,260 | 17 |
| 4 | Ben Shelton | 23 | 4,680 | 22 |
| 5 | Daniil Medvedev | 30 | 4,010 | 24 |
| 6 | Felix Auger-Aliassime | 26 | 3,890 | 23 |
| 7 | Flavio Cobolli | 24 | 3,680 | 26 |
| 8 | Frances Tiafoe | 28 | 3,380 | 22 |
| 9 | Alex de Minaur | 27 | 3,300 | 24 |
| 10 | Arthur Fils | 22 | 3,275 | 19 |
| 11 | Novak Djokovic | 39 | 3,180 | 16 |
| 12 | Taylor Fritz | 28 | 2,880 | 22 |
| 13 | Rafael Jodar | 20 | 2,659 | 22 |
| 14 | Valentin Vacherot | 27 | 2,450 | 22 |
| 15 | Jakub Mensik | 21 | 2,445 | 21 |

**Top Indians ▶**

Sumit Nagal
Rank 253 ▼ 4 spots

Dhakshineswar Suresh
Rank 369 ▼ 5 spots

### WTA Women's Top 15

| # | Player | Age | Points | Events |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Elena Rybakina | 27 | 9,901 | 21 |
| 2 | Aryna Sabalenka | 28 | 7,810 | 20 |
| 3 | Jessica Pegula | 32 | 7,265 | 19 |
| 4 | Coco Gauff | 22 | 7,244 | 19 |
| 5 | Mirra Andreeva | 19 | 5,841 | 21 |
| 6 | Linda Noskova | 21 | 5,328 | 20 |
| 7 | Elina Svitolina | 32 | 4,809 | 17 |
| 8 | Karolina Muchova | 30 | 4,683 | 20 |
| 9 | Iga Swiatek | 25 | 4,119 | 19 |
| 10 | Marta Kostyuk | 24 | 4,040 | 18 |
| 11 | Amanda Anisimova | 25 | 3,363 | 15 |
| 12 | Belinda Bencic | 29 | 2,925 | 19 |
| 13 | Iva Jovic | 18 | 2,841 | 23 |
| 14 | Diana Shnaider | 22 | 2,588 | 23 |
| 15 | Victoria Mboko | 20 | 2,521 | 19 |

**Top Indians ▶**

Sahaja Yamalapalli
Rank 354 ▼ 5 spots

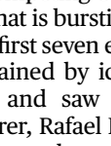
Vaishnavi Adkar
Rank 374 ▼ 13 spots

### F1 Drivers' standings

| # | Driver | Team | Points | Wins |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | A.K. Antonelli | Mercedes | 320 | 8 |
| 2 | G. Russell | Mercedes | 236 | 3 |
| 3 | L. Hamilton | Ferrari | 214 | 1 |
| 4 | C. Leclerc | Ferrari | 191 | 1 |
| 5 | L. Norris | McLaren | 188 | 2 |
| 6 | M. Verstappen | Red Bull | 188 | 1 |
| 7 | O. Piastri | McLaren | 128 | 0 |
| 8 | I. Hadjar | Red Bull | 96 | 0 |
| 9 | L. Lawson | RB | 65 | 0 |
| 10 | P. Gasly | Alpine | 41 | 0 |
| 11 | A. Lindblad | RB | 38 | 0 |
| 12 | F. Colapinto | Alpine | 27 | 0 |
| 13 | O. Bearman | Haas | 20 | 0 |
| 14 | G. Bortoleto | Audi | 10 | 0 |
| 15 | N. Hulkenberg | Audi | 7 | 0 |
| 16 | E. Ocon | Haas | 7 | 0 |
| 17 | F. Alonso | Aston Martin | 7 | 0 |
| 18 | C. Sainz | Williams | 7 | 0 |
| 19 | A. Albon | Williams | 5 | 0 |
| 20 | Y. Tsunoda | RB | 1 | 0 |
| 21 | L. Stroll | Aston Martin | 0 | 0 |
| 22 | V. Bottas | Cadillac | 0 | 0 |
| 23 | S. Perez | Cadillac | 0 | 0 |



A.K. Antonelli



G. Russell

### F1 Constructors' standings

| Pos | Team | Points | Wins |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mercedes | 556 | 11 |
| 2 | Ferrari | 405 | 2 |
| 3 | McLaren | 316 | 2 |
| 4 | Red Bull | 298 | 1 |
| 5 | RB | 90 | 0 |
| 6 | Alpine | 68 | 0 |
| 7 | Haas | 27 | 0 |
| 8 | Audi | 17 | 0 |
| 9 | Williams | 12 | 0 |
| 10 | Aston Martin | 7 | 0 |
| 11 | Cadillac | 0 | 0 |

### Badminton Men's ranking

| # | Player | Points | Events |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kunlavut Vitidsarn | 92,865 | 17 |
| 2 | Christo Popov | 86,632 | 19 |
| 3 | Chou Tien Chen | 85,380 | 26 |
| 4 | Jonatan Christie | 85,031 | 17 |
| 5 | Shi Yu Qi | 84,555 | 14 |
| 6 | Anders Antonsen | 83,655 | 16 |
| 7 | Kodai Naraoka | 78,740 | 19 |
| 8 | Alex Lanier | 76,985 | 15 |
| 9 | Victor Lai | 76,465 | 17 |
| 10 | Alwi Farhan | 73,599 | 17 |
| 11 | Loh Kean Yew | 69,020 | 19 |
| 12 | Lin Chun-Yi | 64,924 | 18 |
| 13 | Li Shi Feng | 64,533 | 16 |
| 14 | Lakshya Sen | 62,813 | 21 |
| 15 | Toma Junior Popov | 62,697 | 19 |

**Top Indians ▶**

Lakshya Sen
Rank 14

Ayush Shetty
Rank 20

### Badminton Women's ranking

| # | Player | Points | Events |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | An Se Young | 1,22,287 | 15 |
| 2 | Wang Zhi Yi | 1,03,989 | 16 |
| 3 | Akane Yamaguchi | 1,03,576 | 18 |
| 4 | Chen Yu Fei | 87,351 | 15 |
| 5 | Ratchanok Intanon | 76,166 | 20 |
| 6 | Putri Kusuma Wardani | 71,603 | 17 |
| 7 | Tomoka Miyazaki | 71,456 | 21 |
| 8 | Han Yue | 69,008 | 12 |
| 9 | Pornpawee Chochuwong | 66,927 | 15 |
| 10 | P.V. Sindhu | 65,951 | 13 |
| 11 | Nozomi Okuhara | 64,160 | 17 |
| 12 | Kim Ga Eun | 59,041 | 16 |
| 13 | Line Christophersen | 57,940 | 21 |
| 14 | Michelle Li | 55,327 | 20 |
| 15 | Mia Blichfeldt | 54,483 | 11 |

**Top Indians ▶**

P.V. Sindhu
Rank 10

Unnati Hooda
Rank 19

### Test Batting

| # | Player | Rating | Career best |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Harry Brook | 861 | 898 |
| 2 | Steve Smith | 840 | 947 |
| 3 | Joe Root | 816 | 932 |
| 4 | Travis Head | 811 | 884 |
| 5 | Temba Bavuma | 775 | 806 |
| 6 | Rachin Ravindra | 740 | 740 |
| 7 | Rishabh Pant | 713 | 801 |
| 8 | Daryl Mitchell | 710 | 804 |
| 9 | Shubman Gill | 709 | 807 |
| 10 | Kamindu Mendis | 706 | 784 |

### Test Bowling

| # | Player | Rating | Career best |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mitchell Starc | 872 | 872 |
| 2 | Matt Henry | 861 | 870 |
| 3 | Ollie Robinson | 856 | 856 |
| 4 | Jasprit Bumrah | 853 | 908 |
| 5 | Pat Cummins | 841 | 914 |
| 6 | Marco Jansen | 825 | 825 |
| 7 | Kagiso Rabada | 807 | 902 |
| 8 | Scott Boland | 804 | 820 |
| 9 | Josh Hazlewood | 783 | 864 |
| 10 | Noman Ali | 777 | 853 |

### ODI Batting

| # | Player | Rating | Career best |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Shubman Gill | 841 | 855 |
| 2 | Daryl Mitchell | 794 | 840 |
| 3 | Virat Kohli | 781 | 908 |
| 4 | Rohit Sharma | 770 | 879 |
| 5 | Ibrahim Zadran | 719 | 756 |
| 6 | Shai Hope | 710 | 782 |
| 7 | Babar Azam | 689 | 894 |
| 8 | Kusal Mendis | 674 | 675 |
| 9 | Joe Root | 660 | 810 |
| 10 | K.L. Rahul | 653 | 676 |

### ODI Bowling

| # | Player | Rating | Career best |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rashid Khan | 714 | 775 |
| 2 | Abrar Ahmed | 675 | 675 |
| 3 | Keshav Maharaj | 667 | 737 |
| 4 | Mitchell Santner | 644 | 656 |
| 5 | Maheesh Theekshana | 622 | 680 |
| 6 | Kuldeep Yadav | 620 | 757 |
| 7 | Jofra Archer | 617 | 682 |
| 8 | Shaheen Afridi | 604 | 691 |
| 9 | Mehidy Hasan | 602 | 722 |
| 10 | Jayden Seales | 591 | 591 |

### T20I Batting

| # | Player | Rating | Career best |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ishan Kishan | 902 | 916 |
| 2 | Abhishek Sharma | 887 | 931 |
| 3 | Sahibzada Farhan | 818 | 848 |
| 4 | Harry Brook | 793 | 793 |
| 5 | Jos Buttler | 789 | 794 |
| 5 | Dewald Brevis | 789 | 806 |
| 7 | Shreyas Iyer | 786 | 786 |
| 8 | Phil Salt | 775 | 881 |
| 9 | Pathum Nissanka | 742 | 796 |
| 10 | Tilak Varma | 719 | 845 |

### T20I Bowling

| # | Player | Rating | Career best |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Rashid Khan | 720 | 828 |
| 2 | Abrar Ahmed | 718 | 757 |
| 3 | Adam Zampa | 700 | 746 |
| 4 | Adil Rashid | 695 | 747 |
| 5 | Nathan Ellis | 675 | 678 |
| 6 | Jamie Overton | 674 | 674 |
| 7 | Axar Patel | 664 | 667 |
| 8 | Nasum Ahmed | 661 | 661 |
| 9 | Mahedi Hasan | 654 | 654 |
| 10 | Jasprit Bumrah | 649 | 783 |

# The World championship match is like an hourglass... it is always the same opponent

SUDHAKARA JAIN

Ian Nepomniachtchi was unsuccessful in two World Championship matches. But he recently got a measure of revenge for one of those losses, beating Magnus Carlsen to help his side win the Global Chess League. In this chat, he talks about the upcoming Gukesh-Sindarov clash, the dynamics of title matches and why the next generation is so much more advanced than his

INTERVIEW

## *Ian Nepomniachtchi*

**P.K. Ajith Kumar**

Ian Nepomniachtchi's victory over Magnus Carlsen of Alpine APL Pipers in the final match of the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League led his team Ganges Grandmasters to an unlikely maiden title in Bengaluru. Back in 2021, he had unsuccessfully challenged Carlsen in the World title match; that would turn out to be the Norwegian's last defence of his crown. One of the most gifted players of his generation, the Russian shared the World blitz title with Carlsen two years ago. Excerpts from an interview Nepomniachtchi gave *The Hindu*:

**You returned to the Global Chess League after missing out on the last two editions.**

I had some visa issues, unfortunately, in 2024, and last year I skipped. Back in 2023, I played in the inaugural edition. I found it interesting. It is really fun for players. Because, sometimes, especially classical chess, it's a little bit too controlled. And it sometimes can be a bit boring, not only for players, but even for the fans, I believe.

The GCL's format brings a lot of different imbalances. You don't know the colour before the game, at least for the first part of the league, as it is decided by the toss, and you have four points for a win with black pieces and three with white. It is all fun and brings in some extra excitement. So, all in all, I think it is a good tournament to have in your calendar.

> Sindarov starts as a huge favourite, but I wouldn't say it is something like 80 to 20. I think it should be more like 65 to 35

**How did you find the response from the Bengaluru crowd? There were full houses for most days and the fans were cheering. That is not something you usually see at a chess tournament.**

Yes. I have played a lot in Dortmund, where you get fans. But normally chess fans there are quite elderly, and sometimes they just start snoring in the first row. So that is a bit funny.

Everyone can hear this, but not arbiters. Jokes aside, I think the audience here is very respectful. I would never hear any sound from them during the games.

**You have played for the World championship twice, against Magnus Carlsen and Ding Liren. How do you view this year's World title match between D. Gukesh and Javokhir Sindarov?**

The World championship match is always very special. It is like an hourglass. It is not like the round of the tournament when you can play one game badly and catch up later by beating another guy. It is always the same opponent. If we analyse the results for the past 16 or 17 months, there is some bad news for the Gukesh fans. He has lost roughly 90 Elo points or so.

**Yes, he has dropped way down from being the World No. 3.**

It is probably a question to him and to his team – What is going on, what is happening? He is just a bit different from what we saw in 2024, especially in Budapest and in Toronto. But, you know, that doesn't guarantee some easy way to the crown for Javokhir. Because, you know, they are both very young and form can be very volatile sometimes.

Of course, as of now, Sindarov starts as a huge favourite, but I wouldn't say it is something like 80 to 20. I think it should be more like 65 to 35. And I believe who wins the first game will be important. If Gukesh manages to win one, especially in the beginning, or at least not lose, the match could become unclear, as he will get some confidence. But if Sindarov starts with a win, it could easily turn into a snowball.

**Before your own World championship match against Ding Liren, I remember talking to Viswanathan Anand, and he had picked you as the favourite in a close match, but you lost in the tie-breaker. How difficult is it to prepare for and play in a World championship match?**

The match is always tough. It is probably not the match itself. Playing itself is the easiest part, because it is what you are used to doing since childhood. But the preparation takes three months or even half a year or so. You basically live a very different life from what you normally do. It is a huge period of time, and you have to be completely focused.

> I had worked quite a bit on my chess and physical condition [for the Carlsen title match]. But I could never predict I wouldn't sleep at all during the match. So, basically, my brain just fried

Back then, watching the last round [of the Candidates], I really wanted [Hikaru] Nakamura to qualify. Okay, I really liked Ding so much more as a chess player. But sadly something happened with him. During the match he was shaky at first. But then in the middle of the match he played a sequence of quite decent games. It is very difficult when it goes down the rollercoaster, like, win-lose-win-lose. Even if you have the upper hand, even when you lead on the score, it drains some extra energy from you.

**Before that, in the Carlsen match, you had drawn the first five games...**

I had worked quite a bit on my chess and physical condition. But I could never predict I wouldn't sleep at all during the match. So, basically, my brain just fried. And in Game Six, I committed a couple of blunders. And I let him into this very unpleasant ending, which I surely didn't want to appear. I could have made as many draws as possible, but playing for a win also brings you to some unknown territory sometimes. And whenever it came down to something, even simple calculation... my brain hadn't rested properly, I started blundering things. It was a big experience, of course, but also he played so well.

**Who are the young players you are currently impressed with?**

Well, now you just blink once, and some young player already becomes a Grandmaster or reaches 2700. [Yagiz Kaan] Erdogmus is quite promising indeed.

It is hard to compare him to a player like me, because now it is so much easier to learn opening in a perfect way because of computers. Now it is a whole new situation.

I was quite impressed when I played a classical game against [Faustino] Oro. He is 12 years old, and he knew so much about the opening.

When I was 12, I knew a couple of lines, here and there. And I had a rating of around 2300 or even 2400. So, I was not completely talentless. But, my opening knowledge was not like this. That is a big difference between players of my generation and this one.

Back home in Russia, we have some hopes about Roman Shogdzhiev. He seems to be promising. And perhaps he could also try to get his GM title, you know, maybe set a new record.

**Because of the Ukraine war, Russia cannot play in tournaments like the Olympiad. You were one of those chess players who signed an open letter to Vladimir Putin demanding an end to the military action.**

As a citizen, I think it is fine to have your position.

## GAME THEORY

### LaLiga: goals vs. expected goals

Barcelona has dominated LaLiga's attacking statistics, generating the most expected goals (xG) and outperforming this metric to lead the goal-scoring chart in the opening rounds of the season. Real Madrid and Villarreal come in next on xG, but have scored fewer goals than expected, based on the shot opportunities they have had. A look at how the teams in the Spanish top division rank on xG and the margin between the goals they have scored and the xG they have generated (xGDiff):

| Rank | Team | xG | Goals | xGDiff |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Barcelona | 28.54 | 29 | 0.46 |
| 2 | Real Madrid | 18.26 | 16 | -2.26 |
| 3 | Villarreal | 17.09 | 12 | -5.09 |
| 4 | Atletico Madrid | 13.29 | 16 | 2.71 |
| 5 | Real Betis | 12.29 | 9 | -3.29 |
| 6 | Racing Santander | 10.54 | 11 | 0.46 |
| 7 | Athletic Club | 10.45 | 6 | -4.45 |
| 8 | Deportivo Alaves | 10.33 | 11 | 0.67 |
| 9 | Espanyol | 10.07 | 9 | -1.07 |
| 10 | Rayo Vallecano | 9.94 | 11 | 1.06 |
| 11 | Real Sociedad | 9.77 | 9 | -0.77 |
| 12 | Osasuna | 9.6 | 6 | -3.6 |
| 13 | Elche | 9.23 | 11 | 1.77 |
| 14 | Levante | 8.43 | 8 | -0.43 |
| 15 | Celta Vigo | 7.54 | 8 | 0.46 |
| 16 | Sevilla | 7.24 | 10 | 2.76 |
| 17 | Valencia | 7.08 | 3 | -4.08 |
| 18 | Deportivo de A Coruna | 7.04 | 8 | 0.96 |
| 19 | Getafe | 6.41 | 4 | -2.41 |
| 20 | Malaga | 5.48 | 3 | -2.48 |

BARCELONA

REAL MADRID

VILLARREAL

SOURCE: whoscored.com

## PICTURE THIS

GETTY IMAGES

### Date night

The sun sets at Pennsylvania State University's Beaver Stadium as a nor'easter storm approaches the region: a beautiful setting for one of America's great romances — its enduring love affair with college ball.

Indeed, in some parts of the US, particularly the south and midwest, the college game is more popular than professional football and was once viewed as more prestigious.

The games draw enormous crowds, with several stadiums accommodating more than 100,000 raucous spectators.

About 20 million fans make it through the turnstiles every season, an average of about 65,000 per game. The games also attract television audiences of up to 9-10 million for certain contests.

So, it's no surprise that the business of college football is considerable. It is estimated to bring in over a billion dollars a year. The college game occupies a special space in American sport. In the absence of official minor league farm organisations, it is considered the game's second tier, one step below the NFL.

Many NFL players graduate from the College Football National Championship.